**CHENNAI** - TUESDAY - MAY 26, 2026

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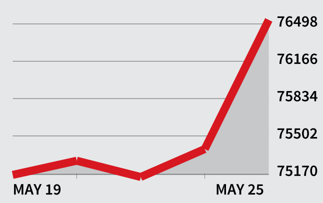
**SENSEX** 76488.96 (+1073.61)




**IN FOCUS**

| | LATEST | CHANGE |
|---|---|---|
| Nifty 50 | 24031.70 | +312.40 |
| P/E Ratio (Sensex) | 20.57 | +0.22 |
| US Dollar (in ₹) | 95.23 | -0.46 |
| Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹) | 158221.00 | +737 |
| Silver 1 kg (in ₹) | 271100.00 | +5100 |

**ASSET LEVERAGE.**
**Agriculture gold loans grow over** 40% as higher prices of yellow metal push farmers towards faster credit **p10**

**EXPANDED IIP.**
**Index of Industrial Production** set for a major overhaul, with new series covering rare earths, gas, water supply **p3**

BENGALURU - CHENNAI - COIMBATORE - HUBBALLI - HYDERABAD - KOCHI - KOLKATA - MADURAI - MALAPPURAM - MANGALURU - MUMBAI - NOIDA - THIRUVANANTHAPURAM - TIRUCHIRAPALLI - VIJAYAWADA - VISAKHAPATNAM

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## QUICKLY.

**FOURTH HIKE IN 10 DAYS**

### Petrol price raised by ₹2.61/litre, diesel up ₹2.71

**New Delhi:** Oil marketing companies on Monday raised the retail price of diesel by ₹2.71/litre and petrol by ₹2.61/litre, making it the fourth hike in 10 days. Petrol now costs ₹102.12/litre in Delhi, ₹113.51 in Kolkata, ₹111.21 in Mumbai and ₹107.77 in Chennai. A litre of diesel sells at ₹95.20 in Delhi, ₹99.82 in Kolkata, ₹97.83 in Mumbai and ₹99.55 in Chennai. **p3**

**EASE OF TRADING**

### SEBI mulls uniform options strike price norm

**Mumbai:** SEBI has proposed a uniform framework for introducing and managing strike prices of options contracts across exchanges, including a mechanism for intra-day addition of new strike prices during periods of volatility. The move is aimed at ensuring "predictability and availability of options contracts in case of heightened intra-day volatility for ease of trading in the derivatives segment," it said. **p6**

Today's issue carries a 4-Page supplement **TEXPROCIL**

# FY27 fertilizer subsidy may top ₹3 lakh cr on price surge

**WAR WOES.** If West Asia tensions persist, the burden could reach ₹3.5 lakh crore

**Prabhudatta Mishra**
New Delhi

The fertilizer subsidy bill could exceed ₹3 lakh crore in FY27, nearly double the Budget Estimate of ₹1.71 lakh crore, as the West Asia crisis drives up global prices of urea, LNG and other key inputs, official sources told *businessline*.

The sharp escalation in the subsidy comes amid concerns over disruptions in the Strait of Hormuz and rising dependence on costly imports.

Officials said the subsidy burden, earlier estimated at below ₹2 lakh crore before the geopolitical flare-up, has ballooned after the surge in global fertilizer and energy prices.

**RISING SUBSIDY BILL**

"If the current situation persists through the kharif season, the subsidy could cross ₹3 lakh crore. If elevated prices and supply disruptions continue into the rabi season, it may even touch ₹3.5 lakh crore," a senior official said.

In the FY27 Budget, Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman had provided a fertilizer subsidy of ₹1.7 lakh crore including ₹1.16 lakh crore for urea (both domestic and imported) and ₹54,000 crore for phosphorus (P) and potash (K) nutrients.

In 2025-26, the fertilizer subsidy was pegged at ₹ 1.86 lakh crore (Revised Estimate).

Speaking at the 37th foundation day event of SIDBI in Mumbai on Monday, Sitharaman said that there has been an "unimaginable jump" in global fertilizer prices after the West Asia crisis.

Echoing Prime Minister Narendra Modi's austerity call, Sitharaman asked the people to focus on '3Fs' — fuel, fertilizer and forex — in the current scenario.

**UREA PRICE SURGE**

Within roughly 40 days of the Gulf crisis, global urea prices reportedly surged by nearly 65 per cent, rising from around $482 per tonne in late February to nearly $795 in early April.

For a recent urea import tender (floated by IPL) prices jumped to $935-959 per tonne.

In the case of liquefied natural gas (LNG), the principal feedstock for urea production, the prices have risen from nearly $10.4/MMBtu in late February to around $17.4 by early-May, after peaking to nearly $25.4/MMBtu in early-March.

**SOLUTION 'MUST NOW'**

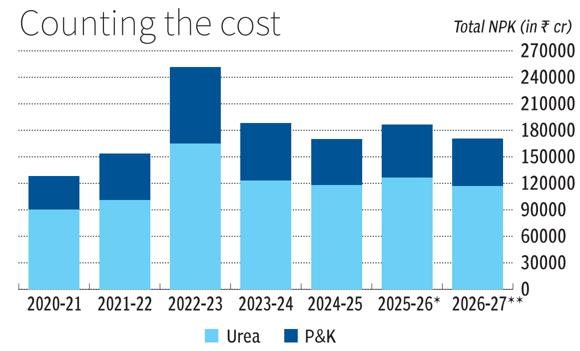
Releasing a paper, titled *Ensuring India's Fertiliser Security Amid Rising Geopolitical Risks*, authored by ICRIER's Ashok Gulati and others on Monday, NITI Aayog Member KV Raju urged the thinktank to suggest an implementable action plan.

"Do not come back in 10 to 12 months saying the government did not do this or that. Kharif sowing is about to start, and recommendations must address this year, this current season," Raju told ICRIER.

The NITI Aayog member also urged the FAO's South Asia representative to be specific with alternatives, adding, "The crisis is now, and a treatment is required now."

He wondered if the suppliers in Russia, Canada, Australia or Africa could effectively replace the disrupted West Asian imports.

**Counting the cost**




*Revised Estimate, **Budget Estimate; Source: India Budget

# Markets recover as crude eases on Gulf peace hope

**Anupama Ghosh**
Mumbai

The markets staged a sharp recovery on Monday, driven by a surge in global risk appetite after US President Donald Trump said over the weekend that a peace deal with Iran was "largely negotiated".

The Nifty 50 ended at 24,031.70, up 312.40 points, marking its first close above 24,000 in recent sessions; the Sensex ended at 76,488.96, up 1,073.61 points.

**WAR PREMIUM GOES**

The prospect of easing West Asia tensions triggered an aggressive unwinding of the war premium in energy markets, pulling down crude prices and reviving broad-based buying.

**RUPEE RISES**

The rupee appreciated for the third straight session and ended at an over two-week high, supported by easing crude oil prices and a potential US-Iran agreement. It was also supported by RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra hinting that the rupee may be actually undervalued rather than overvalued.

The rise in equities also supported the rupee's rise.

**Read more p6**

# US looking for an early trade deal; India wants tariff clarity

**Amiti Sen**
New Delhi

The US is angling for an early interim trade deal with India, aiming to push negotiations towards a final conclusion during the visit of a high-power American trade delegation to New Delhi in the coming weeks.

India, however, is more cautious and is unlikely to take on commitments till the US tariff scenario unfolds, and it is sure of the advantages it gains over its competitors, a source tracking the matter told *businessline*.

"India needs clarity on how American duties will impact both Indian goods and those of its global competitors before a trade deal with the US can be worked out," the source said.

Expressing keenness for the pact, US Secretary of State Marco Rubio announced on Sunday that the US Trade Representative would visit India "very soon". The two sides will "wind up with a trade agreement" that is enduring and mutually beneficial, he said.

**Also read p3**

# Challenges to economy are externally driven: Sitharaman

**Our Bureau**
Mumbai

High and fluctuating global crude oil prices, an unimaginable increase in fertilizer prices and high gold prices amid the West Asia conflict are creating challenges on the external front as payments for all these commodities have to be made in foreign exchange, said Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman.

At an event to celebrate SIDBI's 37th foundation day, Sitharaman urged the audience, which included Special Secretary in the Department of Financial Services Sanjay Lohiya, chiefs of public sector banks and the SIDBI top brass, to understand the context of the three Fs — fuel, fertilizer and foreign exchange; foreign exchange is, in this context, purchase of gold.

The Finance Minister underscored that the domestic economic situation remains positive and resilient even today.

**Read more p7**

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## QUICKLY.

### Fredun Pharmaceuticals Q4 profit jumps 56%

**Mumbai:** Fredun Pharmaceuticals reported 56 per cent growth in net profit for Q4 FY26 to ₹11 crore on the back of good demand. Income increased 27 per cent to ₹213 crore. The company declared a dividend of ₹0.70/share. OUR BUREAU

### Hitachi Energy India Q4 net profit rises 80%

**New Delhi:** Hitachi Energy India posted a nearly 80 per cent rise in net profit to ₹330.5 crore during Q4 FY26, mainly on account of higher revenues, against net profit of ₹183.9 crore in the year-ago period. Revenue rose 46.2 per cent. Its board has approved a final dividend of ₹8 per share for FY26. PTI

# Rising fuel prices push car buyers towards e-scooters and hybrids

**SHIFTING TREND.** Impact visible in showroom walk-ins and fresh bookings, especially in entry-level cars and 2Ws

**Amit Vijay Mohile**
Mumbai

Inflated petrol prices, pushing Delhi fuel rates past ₹100 a litre, are beginning to reshape buying behaviour across the auto market, with consumers reassessing long-term running costs and turning toward electric scooters, hybrids and fuel-efficient vehicles.

Petrol prices in Delhi have risen roughly ₹7.5 since May 15 to ₹102.12 a litre after four hikes in 10 days, while Mumbai prices have crossed ₹111. Parallel CNG hikes are also pressuring commercial operators and shared-mobility fleets, though dealers say wholesale dispatches remain stable because production schedules were locked in earlier.

The first signs of stress are emerging in showrooms, especially in commuter segments where fuel costs directly influence buying decisions.

CS Vigneshwar, President, Federation of Automobile Dealers Associations (FADA), said the industry may not see an immediate fall in demand, but "such events will definitely increase the pace of EV adoption".

Hemal Thakkar, Senior Practice Leader and Director, CRISIL Intelligence, said the cumulative increase is now meaningful enough to alter buyer psychology. "Prices have risen by almost ₹8, which is a meaningful number. It will definitely force buyers to think about EVs before making a purchase decision," he said.

**BUYER SENTIMENT**

That shift is becoming visible across dealerships, where consumers are reconsidering powertrain choices.


**FUELLING CHANGE.** The sharpest divergence is emerging in two-wheelers, where urban scooter buyers are increasingly shifting toward EVs REUTERS

"People are now considering shifting irrespective of the price because they want to use this as a reason to move," said Amar Jatin Sheth, Managing Director, Group Shaman. "What policy could not do through incentives or government push, this has done."

According to Vinkesh Gulati, Director at United Automobiles, the impact is appearing first in retail enquiries rather than wholesale dispatches. "May wholesales may not show a dramatic plunge because production schedules and dealer billing were locked in early in the month," he said. "But the impact is becoming visible in showroom walk-ins and fresh bookings."

**DEMAND FOR 2WS**

The sharpest divergence is emerging in two-wheelers (2Ws), where urban scooter buyers are increasingly shifting toward EVs while entry-level motorcycles remain under pressure in rural markets.

Saket Mehra, Partner and Automotive and EV Industry Leader, Grant Thornton Bharat, said fuel inflation is accelerating the industry's shift toward efficiency and electrification.

Electric scooter maker Emobi expects the trend to strengthen further. "We had already expected the electric two-wheeler market to cross 2 million units this year and with continuing fuel-price increases, that number could significantly exceed expectations in FY27," said Chief Executive Bharath Krishna Rao.

Kunal Mundra, Founder and Chief Executive, Astranova Mobility, said higher fuel prices are also likely to accelerate EV adoption among commercial fleet operators because of direct operating-cost pressures on margins.

# Chemplast Sanmar reports ₹45 cr net loss in Q4FY26 on exceptional charge

**Our Bureau**
Chennai

Chemplast Sanmar on Monday reported a consolidated net loss of ₹45 crore for the quarter ended March 2026 (Q4FY26) due to an exceptional charge of around ₹150 crore. Net loss narrowed from ₹54 crore in the same quarter last year and from ₹119 crore in the quarter ended December 2025, suggesting improvement in operational performance.

Revenue grew 9 per cent to ₹1,256 crore and EBITDA margin grew from 3 per cent to 15 per cent.

**WEST ASIA WAR IMPACT**

Pursuant to the West Asia crisis and challenges in availability of raw materials, Chemplast Sanmar's subsidiary entered into certain non-cancellable procurement arrangements in March that are onerous in nature; this led to an aggregate charge of ₹149.9 crore as exceptional items for the quarter and year ended March 2026, the company said in its financial statements.

For FY26, consolidated net loss was ₹280 crore, up from ₹110 crore in FY25. Revenue was down 3 per cent at ₹4,224 crore. EBITDA margins stayed flat at 5 per cent.

**BOARD MEETING**

The board, at its meeting on Monday, appointed VS Radhakrishnan as Non-Executive and Non-Independent Director, effective May 25.

Further, it has also constituted a committee of three independent directors to examine the strategic priorities for the company.

"The Committee may evaluate potential reorganisation and M&A opportunities, and will table their findings to the board for review and appropriate decision making," Chemplast Sanmar said.

# CPCL reworks ₹45,000 cr Nagapattinam Cauvery Basin project into a petro-chem complex; IOC to hold 75% in JV

**T E Raja Simhan**
Chennai

Chennai Petroleum Corporation (CPCL) has changed the focus of its ₹45,000 crore Cauvery Basin Refinery and Petrochemicals Ltd (CBRL) project in Nagapattinam; it is now envisaged as a petrochemical complex, rather than its earlier plans for a conventional refinery.

The project was originally conceived with CPCL and IOC holding 25 per cent each, and the balance 50 per cent with investors. However, the project is currently structured as a joint venture, with IOC holding 75 per cent and CPCL 25 per cent, CPCL Managing Director H Shankar told *businessline*.

CPCL, along with parent IOC, revisited the project configuration after the originally-proposed refinery-cum-petrochemical complex faced challenges on the internal rate of return, he said.

**TECHNICAL STUDY**

Shankar said technical and feasibility studies are underway and discussions are being held with Engineers India as well as the Tamil Nadu government regarding incentives and project facilitation. CPCL expects preliminary clarity on the revised configuration in about a year.

H Shankar, Managing Director, CPCL

The original project was envisaged as a 9 million tonne refinery integrated with a polypropylene unit.

However, the economics of a fuel-heavy configuration became less attractive over time, prompting the partners to reassess the investment structure and product mix, he added.

According to Shankar, the revised proposal could involve cracker-based petrochemical facilities aimed at catering to India's growing petrochemical demand rather than competing in the fuel market. Despite delays, CPCL said groundwork for the project has advanced considerably. It has invested nearly ₹1,000 crore, primarily towards land acquisition and development activities. The land parcel has been secured with *patta* transfers completed and boundary wall construction under way.

"This project can create an entirely new industrial ecosystem in the Cauvery delta region, with downstream chemical and petrochemical industries coming up around it," Shankar said. He added that the coastal location, road and rail connectivity, and proximity to port infrastructure make Nagapattinam an ideal site for a large petrochemical complex.

# Ashok Leyland, VRL Logistics deepen partnership with order for 715 vehicles

**Our Bureau**
Chennai

Ashok Leyland, a leading commercial vehicle manufacturer, has bagged an order of 715 vehicles from VRL Logistics, a key logistics player in India.

The order includes AVTR 3120 haulage trucks, Boss 1615 trucks and Oyster staff buses.

This milestone marks a significant step in strengthening the partnership between the companies and reinforces Ashok Leyland's position as a trusted mobility partner, says a statement from the companies.

> **The order includes AVTR 3120 haulage** trucks, Boss 1615 trucks and Oyster staff buses

**DELIVERIES ON TRACK**

Deliveries are progressing as planned, with 300 trucks already delivered and the remaining 415 scheduled for execution in the current year, the statement added.

Anand Sankeshwar, Managing Director, VRL Logistics, said the fresh order of 715 vehicles marks a strategic deepening of partnership to drive higher logistics efficiency. "Backed by Ashok Leyland's focus on innovation and our forward-looking transport strategy, the company is confident of sustained success."

Madhavi Deshmukh, National Sales Head–MHCV, Ashok Leyland, said this order win is a testament to the trust VRL Logistics has in Ashok Leyland's technology and performance.

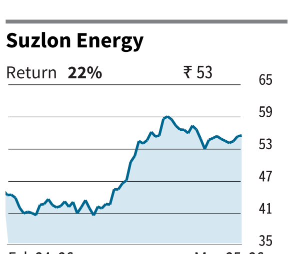
# Suzlon Q4 profit declines 5.75%, but revenues surge 45% on robust wind turbine demand

**Our Bureau**
Ahmedabad

Suzlon Energy reported a 5.75 per cent decline in consolidated net profit at ₹1,114 crore in Q4 FY26, even as revenue from operations rose 45 per cent to ₹5,468 crore, supported by strong execution and robust growth in its wind turbine generator (WTG) business.

The company's consolidated net profit, attributable to its owners, stood at ₹1,114 crore in the fourth quarter (₹1,182 crore). The company said the quarterly impact on profit was primarily on account of a deferred tax asset (DTA) charge.

For the full year, revenue from operations rose 53 per cent to ₹16,841 crore, while consolidated net profit also increased 53 per cent to ₹3,163 crore, reflecting strong execution across the wind energy business.




Revenue growth for the fourth quarter was driven by a 51 per cent rise in WTG revenues and nearly 18 per cent growth in operations and maintenance services, while the foundry and forging segment remained largely flat at ₹168 crore.

**HIGHEST DELIVERIES**

Despite the profit dip, the company posted its highest-ever India quarterly deliveries at 830 MW and annual deliveries of 2,456 MW, underscoring strong execution momentum in its core wind energy business. Its consolidated order-book stood at around 5.9 GW, with 66 per cent from PSU and C&I customers, providing strong revenue visibility for upcoming quarters.

> **Suzlon posted highest-ever India quarterly** deliveries at 830 MW and annual deliveries of 2,456 MW

The company said its S144 platform continues to scale as a key growth driver, with cumulative order intake of around 9 GW. "India is witnessing strong peak power demand growth, increasing the strategic importance of wind energy in enabling reliable FDRE solutions. In alignment with these structural shifts, we have significantly strengthened our financial position to prepare for the next phase of growth. Our flagship S144 platform has already achieved about 9 GW of cumulative order-intake and the WTG business has delivered 55 per cent CAGR growth over the last three years. Together, these factors position Suzlon strongly to capitalise on the large market opportunity ahead," said Girish Tanti, Vice-Chairman.

CEO Ajay Kapur also stated that the company delivered record annual execution, amid strong demand visibility.

# Hindalco says FY27 to be inflection year for Novelis

**Suresh P Iyengar**
Mumbai

Hindalco Industries, an Aditya Birla Group company, expects India to be self-sufficient in copper and stop being import-dependent in the next two years, while for its subsidiary Novelis Inc, FY27 is seen to be an inflection year.

The company is putting up a three lakh tonne per annum (tpa) copper smelter plant and 50,000 tpa copper recycling plant, both in Gujarat. Currently, it has copper smelting capacity of 5 lakh tpa.

Satish Pai, Managing Director, Hindalco Industries, said the country will be self-sufficient in copper in the next two years, just like it is in aluminium, after the company's expansion plans go on stream.

"The public hearing was completed for setting up the three lakh tpa smelter plant and the 50,000 tpa recycling plant is also coming up; besides, the fresh copper capacity of Adani Group has already started production," he said.

Satish Pai, MD, Hindalco Industries

Though the country has to depend on imported copper concentrates, the final metal can be produced in India and meet the Prime Minister's ambition of cutting down on copper imports, he said.

Hindalco has also started exploration in a copper mine near Nagpur and expects to source 20-25 per cent of its copper ore requirement from India in five years against 10 per cent sourced from Hindustan Copper mines now.

The company plans to invest ₹12,000 crore capex in this fiscal against ₹10,000 crore invested in FY26.

**NOVELIS' CAPEX PLANS**

Novelis will spend about $2 billion largely on greenfield project at Bay Minette, while the fire-hit Oswego aluminium hot mill plant is expected to restart operations in a week. The Bay Minette plant should start production by November, while Oswego should commence output by July.

In fact, Pai said, besides India, the US operations will be the major inflection point for the company in this fiscal.

The cost of raw material in India will go up 5 per cent sequentially in the June quarter, largely due to rise in furnace oil and pitch coke. While the company has contained the rise in power cost, the two key raw material are driven globally, he said.

The company expects its aluminium downstream EBITDA to grow more than double-digit this fiscal, given the strong demand.

Hindalco has stepped in to address the short-fall of aluminium supply in Japan, Korea and Taiwan from West Asia. "Though our focus was to tap the domestic markets, the company found increased demand in its key markets to tap amid strong commodity prices," said Pai.

The company's net debt increased sharply to ₹64,841 crore against ₹35,332 crore. The net debt to EBITDA has jumped to 1.83 times (1.06 times). It expects the ratio to come down substantially in the next three years when the capex plans are completed, he added.

# Shriram Properties Q4 net profit up 65 per cent

**Our Bureau**
Bengaluru

Real estate developer Shriram Properties has seen its net profit grow 65 per cent year-on-year in Q4FY26 to ₹78.5 crore. Total revenue grew 55 per cent y-o-y to ₹662.7 crore.

Bookings were at ₹2,354 crore, which equals to 4.2 million sq ft for FY26. For the quarter, sales booking stood at ₹663 crore, and the company projects stronger sales momentum for FY27.

However, the company noted that land costs had gone up 287 per cent to ₹137 crore due to rising prices in high-demand micro markets like Sarjapur, where it acquired four acres in February this year.

**KOLKATA LAND DISPUTE**

Recently, the company resolved its long-standing Kolkata land dispute by returning 42 acres to the State government through its subsidiary, Bengal Shriram Hitech City.

Scorecard (in ₹ cr)

| | Q4 FY26 | Q4 FY25 | % chg |
|---|---|---|---|
| Total revenue | 662.7 | 427.5 | 55 |
| Net profit | 78.5 | 47.7 | 65 |

Murali M, Chairman and Managing Director, Shriram Properties, said, "FY26 marks a defining year for the company, demonstrating the strength of our business model, execution capabilities and resilience in navigating external challenges."

On a full-year basis, the company posted operating cash flows of ₹271 crore and free cash flow before new project investments of ₹224 crore in FY26. It invested nearly ₹370 crore towards new project investments during the year. It has over 18 million sq ft of new projects already in the pipeline for launch over the next three years.

# Toyota says Brazil's customer-first formula shows India how to rethink its flex-fuel strategy

**Amit Vijay Mohile**
Mumbai

As rising crude volatility, geopolitical tensions and tighter CAFE III fuel-efficiency norms force India to accelerate alternatives to petrol and diesel, Toyota Kirloskar Motor has made a strong case for India to rethink its flex-fuel strategy around the customer-first economics that helped Brazil build one of the world's largest ethanol vehicle markets.

"You can't have a transition without focusing on the customer," said Vikram Gulati, Executive Vice-President, Corporate Affairs and Governance, Toyota Kirloskar Motor, as the automaker pushes for a more consumer-led approach to India's ethanol and flex-fuel strategy.

Drawing lessons from Brazil, one of the world's largest ethanol-powered auto markets, Toyota argued that India's flex-fuel ambitions may ultimately depend less on engineering capability and more on whether consumers see meaningful savings at the pump.

Vikram Gulati, Executive Vice-President, Toyota Kirloskar Motor

Brazil today sees flex-fuel vehicles (FFVs) account for more than 85 per cent of new vehicle sales, supported by a large ethanol-dispensing network that allows consumers to switch between petrol and ethanol depending on pricing and availability.

**BRAZIL FORMULA**

According to Gulati, the Brazilian market scaled because consumers experienced immediate cost advantages instead of merely responding to regulatory mandates. "There was a 25-30 per cent price difference and tax incentives for FFVs; that is what made the customer move to ethanol," he said.

With India importing nearly 85 per cent of its crude oil requirements, the economy is more exposed to global oil-price shocks. "War or no war, this is a reality we face," Gulati said.

**MULTI-PATHWAY BET**

Toyota believes India's transition will require multiple clean-energy pathways rather than relying only on battery electric vehicles, particularly given uneven charging infrastructure and a coal-heavy electricity mix.

"India will need clean technologies that minimise the use of fossil fuels," Gulati said.

Toyota has already commercialised hybrid FFVs in Brazil and showcased the Innova Hycross FFV-SHEV prototype in India. Analysts believe Maruti Suzuki's Fronx FFV platform could become strategically relevant for Toyota through shared SUV platforms such as the Urban Cruiser Taisor as ethanol-compatible vehicles scale in India.

However, Toyota indicated commercial launches would depend on how quickly the E100 ecosystem and policy framework mature. "We have showcased our global flex-fuel technology capabilities. Which products eventually come to India is something we will be able to share as the policy ecosystem around E100 matures further," Gulati said.

# TVS Supply Chain Solutions reports Q4 PAT of ₹18 crore

**Our Bureau**
Chennai

TVS Supply Chain Solutions reported a consolidated net profit of ₹18 crore for the fourth quarter ended March 31, 2026, as against a net loss of ₹4 crore for the corresponding quarter last year.

Revenue rose 12 per cent to ₹3,032 crore (₹ 2,499 crore). Other income was at ₹11 crore (₹13 crore).

In FY26, the company reported a net profit of ₹117 crore against a net loss of ₹10 crore for the corresponding last year. Revenue rose 10 per cent to ₹11,003 crore (₹9,996 crore). Other income was at ₹38 crore (₹33 crore).

**PROJECT ONE**

During FY26, the group implemented 'Project One', a strategic transformation initiative undertaken to streamline operations, rationalise cost structure and consolidate business activities across the UK and Europe.

**TRANSITION PLAN**

As part of the transition plan announced in January, the board, at its meeting held on Monday, took note of the resignation of Ravi Viswanathan, who will step down from the role of Managing Director, effective June 30.

The board also approved the appointment of Vikas Chadha, currently Global CEO, as Managing Director, effective July 1, said a release.

## QUICKLY.

### RBI panel to examine potential of quantum tech

**Mumbai:** The Reserve Bank on Monday announced the setting up of an eight-member expert committee to explore and evaluate the potential benefits, risks and challenges of quantum technology in the financial sector. Quantum technology represents a paradigm shift compared to traditional systems as it leverages the principles of quantum mechanics, such as superposition and entanglement. This enables quantum systems to address complex financial problems such as risk assessment, and macro-economic modelling, it said. PTI

### NTPC eyes four States for nuclear projects

**New Delhi:** State-owned NTPC has initiated site selection studies in four States, including Gujarat and Andhra Pradesh, to set up nuclear projects as part of its long-term 30 GW nuclear energy plan. The other two States are Odisha and Madhya Pradesh, according to a post-earnings presentation of NTPC. As part of its energy diversification strategy, NTPC is looking to set up 30 GW of nuclear projects in at least 14 States with investments worth lakhs of crores to contribute to the government's ambitious 100 GW nuclear capacity target by 2047. PTI

# US hopes to clinch deal soon but India wants tariff clarity

**TRADE PUSH.** US team's expected visit likely to put pressure on Delhi to speed up pact

**Amiti Sen**
New Delhi

The US is angling for an early interim trade deal with India, aiming to push negotiations towards a final conclusion during the visit of a high-powered American trade delegation to New Delhi in the coming weeks.

India, however, is more cautious and is unlikely to take on commitments till the tariff scenario in the US unfolds, and it is sure of the advantages it gains over its competitors, a source tracking the matter told *businessline*.

"India needs clarity on how American duties will impact both Indian goods and those of its global competitors before a trade deal with the US can be worked out," the source said.

Expressing keenness for the pact, US Secretary of State Marco Rubio, who is on a four-day India visit, announced on Sunday that the US Trade Representative would visit India "very soon".

**FOR QUICK RESULTS.** US Secretary of State Marco Rubio with wife Jeanette and US Ambassador to India Sergio Gor (right) during their visit to Amer Fort in Jaipur on Monday PTI

The two sides would "wind up with a trade agreement" that is enduring and mutually beneficial, he said.

US Ambassador to India Sergio Gor added that there were expectations the India-US trade deal will be wrapped up within weeks.

Rubio is also using his visit to push for the deal and has discussed it extensively both with Prime Minister Narendra Modi and External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar, the source added.

**BUY FROM AMERICA**

In fact, Rubio stepped up pressure on India to deliver on its assurance of purchasing $500 billion of American goods over five years, through a social media post on Sunday congratulating American diplomats, including Gor, for making it happen.

The post ignored the fact that India's assurance, made in February, was part of a framework deal with no legal tenability.

"Much water has flown under the bridge since the framework to the interim deal was announced in February. The US reciprocal tariffs have been withdrawn. The interim global tariffs of 10 per cent that replace them are valid till about July 24, 2026. Most countries are on an equal footing with just the MFN tariffs," the source pointed out.

Moreover, there is no clarity yet on what the outcome of the Section 301 investigations, against countries including India and many of its competitors, would be and if penal tariffs would be imposed.

"New Delhi will definitely participate in negotiations with the US trade team in good faith. But an outcome would be difficult till India is assured of tariff advantage over other competing countries. And for that a clearer tariff picture has to emerge," the source said.

The US remained India's largest export market in FY26 with exports valued at $87.31 billion, marginally higher than exports of $86.51 billion in the previous fiscal.

However, India's trade surplus with the US, a big reason for discontent in the Trump regime, declined in FY26 to $34.41 billion from $40.88 billion in FY25 as the imports of American goods increased to $52.90 billion, from $45.63 billion.

# Petrol, diesel prices raised by over ₹2.50/litre in fourth hike in 10 days

**Our Bureau**
New Delhi

State-run oil marketing companies (OMCs) on Monday raised the retail price of diesel by around ₹2.71 per litre and petrol by about ₹2.61 per litre, making it the fourth hike in the last 10 days.

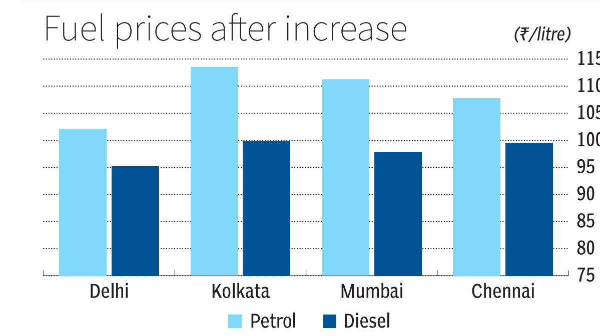
After the increase, petrol costs ₹102.12 per litre in Delhi, ₹113.51 in Kolkata, ₹111.21 in Mumbai and ₹107.77 in Chennai.

Similarly, a litre of diesel now costs ₹95.20 in Delhi, ₹99.82 in Kolkata, ₹97.83 in Mumbai and ₹99.55 in Chennai.

This is the fourth hike in retail prices of diesel and petrol since May 15, when the prices of both fuels were first raised by around ₹3 per litre each.

This was followed by a 90-paise increase on May 19 and May 23. Overall, the prices have now been raised by roughly ₹7.40-7.50 per litre for the fuels.

Sujata Sharma, Joint Secretary in the Oil Ministry, said: "West Asia crisis, our imports are affected, like 40 per cent of our crude import, 90 per cent of our LPG import and almost 65 per cent of our natural gas import, but all efforts have been made to ensure the smooth supplies of petroleum products within the country."




**UNDER RECOVERY OF OMCs**

The government's duty reduction has come at a high fiscal cost, even as the OMCs continue to face losses. The OMCs are still incurring losses (under recovery) of about ₹600 crore per day despite the recent increases in fuel prices. The government will forego ₹14,000 crore as tax revenue due to the excise duty cut on petrol and diesel, she added.

Petrol and diesel prices are now at their highest levels since May 2022. The rates had remained frozen since April 2022 except for a ₹2 per litre cut in March 2024 ahead of the Lok Sabha elections.

The fuel price increases come amid broader government efforts to contain India's oil import bill and reduce fuel consumption.

Prashant Vasisht, Senior V-P & Co-Group Head of Corporate Ratings at ICRA, said, "Despite the latest hike in retail prices of auto fuels, the under recoveries of the OMCs remain stubbornly high due to increasing losses in domestic LPG sales, and high premium to the crude marker."

ICRA estimates that at a crude price of $120-125 a barrel and based on the past 10-year average crack spreads for auto fuels, the OMCs are incurring a daily loss of about ₹700-800 crore on the sale of auto fuels and domestic LPG, even after factoring in the price hikes. This high level of under recoveries is unsustainable, he emphasised.

# IIP set for major overhaul; new series to factor in rare earths, gas, water supply

**Shishir Sinha**
New Delhi

The upcoming series of the Index of Industrial Production (IIP) will expand its scope to include rare earths, gas supply and water supply, according to proposals by the Technical Advisory Committee on Base Year Revision (TAC-IIP).

Aimed at creating a broader, more representative baseline for industrial activity, the government is set to unveil the revamped IIP series on June 1.

The new series will shift the IIP base year to 2022-23 from the current 2011-12.

This marks the third major high-frequency economic indicator to undergo a base-year revision to ensure a more realistic economic reflection, following similar updates to the gross domestic product (base year 2022-23) and the Consumer Price Index-based retail inflation (base year 2024).

According to the Statistics Ministry, TAC-IIP recommended the inclusion of rare earths and minor minerals under mining and quarrying. At the same time, generation of electricity and distribution of gaseous fuels may also be included. Generation of electricity by non-renewable and renewable sources may be disseminated separately.

Further, under 'Water supply, Sewerage, Waste Management', the number of tap connections in rural and urban areas may be considered as the variable for tracking the sub sector.

Similarly, for the sewerage sub sector, the number of sewerage/septage connections (reported in 500 AMRUT cities) may be considered as the variable. For waste management, waste collected and processed in urban areas may be taken as the variable, it said.

The Committee recommended that the six use-based classification categories adopted in the IIP with base year 2011-12 continue in the IIP with base year 2022-23. These include primary goods, capital goods, intermediate goods, infrastructure and construction goods, consumer durable goods and consumer non-durable goods.

**SECTOR INCLUSION.** According to the Statistics Ministry, the TAC-IIP has recommended the inclusion of rare earths and minor minerals under mining and quarrying

In terms of price deflator, TAC-IIP recommended that the output PPI (producer price index) should be adopted as the preferred deflator for the new IIP series (base year 2022-23) once it becomes available.

Until then, the WPI may continue to be used as an interim measure. It may be noted that PPI measures the average change over time in the selling prices received by domestic producers for their output.

**INDEX COMPILATION**

In addition, methodological enhancements have been proposed in index compilation. These include the substitution of factories that are permanently closed or have significantly altered their production lines with comparable units, as well as the augmentation of the panel of the factories by incorporating newly-commissioned largescale facilities that begin producing relevant items during the currency of the IIP series. The new series will adopt the geometric mean method for linking the 2011-12 series with the new 2022-23 series. The linking factors will be computed at aggregated levels, namely for the General Index and the Sectoral Indices.

The first release will present index values starting from April 2023 onwards, including quick estimates of April 2026. Along with the All-India General Index of the IIP, the release will also include sector-wise indices for mining and quarrying, manufacturing, electricity & gas supply and water supply, sewerage & waste management.

# Piped natural gas customers barred from buying LPG cylinders

**Reuters**
New Delhi

India has barred piped natural gas customers from buying liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) cylinders with immediate effect, a government order dated Monday showed.

India has cut LPG supplies to some industries due to the shortage caused by the closure of the Strait of Hormuz due to the US-Israeli war on Iran. New Delhi is pushing customers to use piped gas. India consumed 33.15 million tonnes of LPG, mostly used as cooking gas, in 2025.

# ONGC ropes in BP arm to up production across western offshore fields

**Our Bureau**
New Delhi

State-run ONGC said it has selected BP Exploration Services (India) (BPXS), a wholly-owned step-down subsidiary of BP, as the technical services provider (TSP) for the entire western offshore fields, excluding Mumbai High (MH).

The TSP will review the field performance and identify improvements in reservoir, facilities and wells to enhance production from western offshore fields, the country's largest exploration and production (E&P) firm said. "The TSP has indicated a substantial potential increase of around 10.8 per cent in crude oil (from baseline production of 46.25 million tonnes (mt) to 51.26 mt) and around 31.5 per cent increase in gas production (from 82.68 billion cubic meters to 108.69 BCM) for the 10-year contract period," ONGC added.

In terms of O+OEG (oil + oil equivalent of gas), the increase works out to around 24.1 per cent (from 128.93 million tonnes of oil equivalent (MTOE) to 159.96 MTOE).

**FIXED FEE**

The increase is expected to be visible from FY27 with full scale visibility expected from FY30.

The TSP will receive a fixed fee for the first two years, followed by a service fee based on a percentage share of the revenue from net incremental hydrocarbon production, after recovering incremental costs.

"With this, ONGC aims to realise the enhanced potential of the entire western offshore fields," the Maharatna company said.

Mumbai Offshore Basin is ONGC's most prolific hydrocarbon-producing basin.

# Norms for re-appointment of directors on UCB boards tightened

**Press Trust of India**
Mumbai

An individual cannot serve as a director continuously for more than 10 years on the board of urban co-operative banks, and the re-appointment can happen only after a compulsory three-year cooling-off period, according to the RBI.

Amending the provisions, the Reserve Bank of India on Monday said there have been instances where directors resorted to circumventing statutory provisions to continue on the boards of the UCBs. In certain cases, the RBI said directors resigned briefly from office and got reelected/co-opted to the board within a short period, thereby continuing to be on the Board for an extended period beyond the legally permissible tenure.

The Reserve Bank of India (Urban Co-operative Banks - Governance) Amendment Directions, 2026, have come into force with immediate effect.

CHENNAI
businessline.
TUESDAY - MAY 26 - 2026

the hindu businessline.
TUESDAY - MAY 26, 2026

# Crushing problem

*Duty hikes to discourage cooking oil use avoidable*

**Even as policymakers grapple with rising crude oil prices, domestic prices of cooking oil are shooting up sharply on the back of supply constraints and rising import costs. April CPI (Consumer Price Index) numbers showed a 9.2 per cent year-on-year spike in oils and fats, after a 7 per cent increase in the preceding months. There seems to be little relief in sight. India continues to import over 60 per cent of its edible oil requirement and global prices are being propelled upwards by multiple factors.**

Crude oil shortages are prompting key palm oil producers such as Malaysia and Indonesia to tighten bio-diesel mandates, shrinking their exports and triggering an 18 per cent price rise in palm oil year-to-date. Sunflower and soyabean oil prices have also risen by 13-19 per cent on higher fertilizer prices, rising freight and shipping disruptions due to the Iran conflict. The rupee's slide against other currencies is adding to the cost of imports. There are no easy fixes to this problem. In a bid to coax farmers to expand their oilseed acreage in the upcoming kharif, the Centre has announced increases of 3-8 per cent in Minimum Support Prices (MSPs) for the 2026 kharif season. However, oilseed output shrank by 6 per cent in the last kharif season despite 8-9 per cent increases in MSPs. Farmers are said to have switched from soyabean to maize in a bid to cash in on assured demand for maize from ethanol processors.

A tweaking of import duties on edible oil imports to encourage domestic oil production, didn't work either. Last May, the Centre slashed import duties on crude edible oil from 20 per cent to 10 per cent while retaining the duty on refined oils at over 35 per cent, to prop up profit margins for edible oil refiners. Despite this though, India imported 166.5 lakh tonnes of edible oil in FY26, 3 per cent more than the previous year. The continued influx of palm oil imports, preferred by less affluent consumers for its affordability, kept India's import dependence high. Some reports now suggest that the Government is considering an increase in import duties on edible oils to conserve foreign exchange. This would be unfair to consumers, who are already dealing with budget constraints. Given that MSP increases and duty tweaks have not improved domestic output, imports are unavoidable to meet demand.

The view that steep cooking oil prices would be good for consumers' health as they will cut back on cooking oil use, lacks nuance. Lower income households may not be able to afford even the minimum requirement, while affluent consumers may not mind paying more for oil-heavy foods. In the near term, lowering the steep customs duty on refined oils may be the only way to offer relief to consumers. In the long run, it must become more lucrative for farmers to grow indigenous oilseeds such as sunflower, coconut, mustard and sesame, so that consumers can be weaned away from palm oil.

## POCKET

RAVIKANTH


LINE & LENGTH.

TCA SRINIVASA RAGHAVAN

# It's China that needs the West, not the reverse

The Chinese economy is a derivative of the America-EU one. If the latter runs out of money, so will China. America is the patron, the West is the client

GETTY IMAGES

Now that President Xi Jinping of China has told his American counterpart, Donald Trump, that the US is a declining power, how long will it take America to become a 'been there, done that' country? Long, very long I think.

It took the British empire over 70 years and the Soviet empire just five. The French took around 20 years. Much earlier the Spaniards took around 200 years. Yes. 200. But it wasn't really an empire.

But empires don't collapse because one, or some, of their leaders make utter fools of themselves. They collapse because they run out of money. That's all. There are no exceptions to this truth.

So what needs asking is who will run out of money first: the US plus EU or China? The answer is that when a car runs out of petrol, it stops. Likewise, if they run out of money, so will China. America is the patron, the West is the client.

The Chinese economy is a derivative of the America-EU one, an utterly mismanaged one that depends on its rival making mistakes, like Trump has been doing.

But he will go and his successor will start fixing these mistakes. That isn't that hard to do. And it will work because the problem is not America. It's Donald Trump. His biggest shortcoming is that he can't be trusted.

But can China be trusted? I just read some data that says China hasn't delivered on 75 per cent of the promises it had made to other countries since 1950. Yes, 1950.

### A TEMPORARY SITUATION

So that's where we stand now. China thinks it has become *numero uno*. But America is just waiting impatiently for a new president.

By the way, my interest in China goes back to 1973 when my brother was posted there in the Indian embassy. Basically, it seems clear that Chinese society is a very suspicious one. Everyone suspects everyone else. It's hard to say why.

Coming back to US-China competition, the economics of American dominance is far superior to China's portrayal of it, especially by its admirers. It's simply not true that China will quickly supplant the US. Not a chance except in some places that the US no longer needs.

The reason is that until Trump came along, the world trusted America but now it's hesitating and Chinese loudspeakers are amplifying that hesitation. But, rest assured, once a new president takes office, the world will once again turn to America. There's not a hope in hell that in the interim China will become trustworthy and the world will embrace it.

The Chinese problem is cultural. In China trust is not extended to people you don't know because the formal instruments of trust like contracts and agreements don't matter as much as personal relationships and the resulting networks. In this regard China is still primitive.

**China, in order to become Number One lacks what it needs: goodwill towards others** and towards it. It needs the world but behaves as if the rest of the world needs it

This may well be the preferred Chinese way of doing things but at the international level it has made countries very wary of China. And that's what makes it hard to displace the US for many years still.

### THE TRUST THING

Even today, when Trump is rampaging, if you asked the prime minister of a country who he or she would trust, only a few would say China. It has a long, long way to go before countries start trusting it.

This is because for the Chinese, and especially the Communist party of China, the power to coerce is more important than cooperation. You only have to look at the history of it all. It's replete with the zero-sum approach. The Chinese take no prisoners.

This is not to say that America doesn't coerce. It does but, generally, until Trump came along, it tended to err on the side of generosity and cooperation. That liberal impulse, which was so strong, has been temporarily sidelined by Trump. It will return.

In the end, though, it boils down to the size of an economy. American GDP is $30 trillion. Chinese GDP is $20 trillion, smaller than the economy of the European Union which is $22 trillion. America plus Europe are two-and-a-half times the size of the Chinese economy. Indeed, the Chinese economy is probably much smaller than it would have the world believe just as, because of counting errors, India's is much bigger than the world thinks, maybe $6 trillion. We leave out 60 per cent of economic activity and the Chinese double count a lot.

Before getting down to write this article I also looked at the data about the Soviet economy in the 1980s. There, too, the assessments were fantastic. But in 1991 the USSR collapsed. This is worth bearing in mind while discussing Chinese strengths.

China, in order to become Number One lacks what it needs: goodwill towards others and towards it. It needs the world but behaves as if the rest of the world needs it. In a limited, industrial supply chains, way, perhaps this is true — but for the time being only.

# India's AI options are linked to energy costs

India's position reflects ambition and constraint. Amidst rising data centre goals, power availability in States becomes crucial

Aparna Sharma
Gaurav Sharma

Artificial intelligence is often imagined as something that lives in the cloud. In reality, it lives on the ground, drawing vast amounts of electricity, occupying land, and reshaping industrial geography. As India embraces AI, the challenge is no longer just technological ambition, but how the country fits into the physical and economic systems that make AI possible.

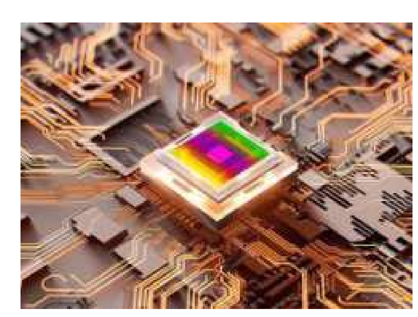
Much of the public debate in India has focused on semiconductors, specifically chips, supply-chain vulnerabilities, and subsidies for chip manufacturing. These efforts are important. But they represent only one part of a much larger system. At scale, AI is an industrial ecosystem operating across five interlinked layers: energy, capital, infrastructure, and geopolitics as much as by algorithms. Energy determines affordability; chips determine who can build systems; infrastructure enables scale; models concentrate control over intelligence; and applications capture economic value. Each layer has distinct economic and strategic implications, and no country dominates them all. India's AI trajectory reflects activity across these layers, marked not by dramatic lag or leapfrogging, but by deliberate choices shaped by scale, affordability, and sovereignty.

For AI-intensive workloads, energy and infrastructure are inseparable. Power requirements rise steeply with scale. Small enterprise data centres consume 1-5 megawatts (MW); large cloud facilities operate at 10-30 MW; hyperscale centres draw 50-100 MW; and frontier AI training clusters increasingly require 100-500 MW or more of continuous power. With one megawatt capable of supplying electricity to roughly 1,000 Indian households, a single AI campus can draw power equivalent to that of an entire district. Electricity is also the dominant operating cost, accounting for 40-60 per cent of expenditure in large data centres. As a result, AI infrastructure gravitates towards locations where power is cheap, reliable, and contractually secured over decades. This is not an IT optimisation problem, but an energy economics problem.

### STRATEGIC INFRASTRUCTURE

Governments worldwide now treat AI data centres as strategic infrastructure. In the US, states offer tax incentives and discounted power; China has created state-backed "AI power zones"; and in the Middle East, campuses are co-located with gas and solar facilities to secure long-term low-cost energy. India's position reflects both ambition and constraint. With 1.5-2 GW of data-centre capacity projected to reach 10-14 GW by the mid-2030s, growth is underway, but uneven 24×7 industrial power has led to clustering in select States. Nuclear energy has therefore re-entered policy discussions to ensure firm power for AI infrastructure.

Chips are the engine and the geopolitically sensitive layer. The US dominates chip design and software ecosystems; Taiwan leads advanced fabrication; South Korea controls memory; and Europe supplies critical manufacturing equipment.



**CHIPS.** The engine and geopolitically sensitive layer of AI GETTY IMAGES

India is a global hub for semiconductor design talent, yet it has almost no presence in advanced manufacturing for AI accelerators. This is not a policy oversight. Leading-edge fabrication plants cost $15-25 billion each, require continuous reinvestment, and take years to stabilise, risks that only a handful of economies can absorb.

India's strategy prioritises foundational capabilities: mature-node fabrication, assembly and testing, advanced packaging, and reliability engineering, often through partnerships. Though unlikely to yield frontier AI chips soon, these efforts reduce vulnerability and strengthen depth in a strategic supply chain.

The model layer, foundation models, large language models, and multimodal systems are where AI intelligence is created and where concentration is sharpest. Training frontier models demand vast computing power, significant capital, and tolerance for repeated failure, limiting ownership to a small number of organisations, largely in the US, with China developing a parallel ecosystem.

India does not host or control frontier-scale models, but Indian researchers are deeply embedded in global development, contributing to architecture design, optimisation, safety, and deployment. The constraint is not talent, but access to concentrated compute and capital. Domestic efforts are focused on adaptation, Indic-language models, domain-specific systems, and fine-tuning global models for local data and regulatory contexts.

AI applications with factories, banks, hospitals, and governments do not require ownership of chips or frontier models; instead, it rewards domain expertise, integration capability, and scale. In India, AI is used to predict defects, optimise yields, manage fragmented supply chains, detect fraud at a population scale, assist diagnostics, and augment digital public infrastructure. However, reliance on external platforms raises concerns about long-term costs and autonomy. .AI is not a single race but a layered industrial system. India's transition across these layers is shaped by energy economics, capital intensity, global integration, and domestic scale.

*Aparna is Director and Co-Founder, and Gaurav is Director, Centre for Innovation and Trade Economy*

## LETTERS TO EDITOR

Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to 'Letters to the Editor', The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

**Semicon ecosystem**

Apropos 'Creating semicon dependency' (May 25), with the future of technology development inextricably linked to semiconductors and their versatile utility, it is imperative for India to transition from the stage of assembly to chip design and indigenous IP creation and ownership. We need to nurture a fabless ecosystem by encouraging deep tech startups and designing academic programmes that would steer the required R&D. India can move up the semiconductor value chain through a fast track strategy of encouraging fabless companies and nudging universities and research labs to patent their research innovations domestically.

**Kosaraju Chandramouli**
Hyderabad

**Caring for workers' health**

This refers to the 'An unhealthy workforce cannot deliver growth' (May 25). It is the primary responsibility of any government to facilitate affordable and good medical facilities to all the people of the country.

Chronic diseases alone account for approximately 30 days of productive time lost per employee each year. When a large section of the population spends their prime years fighting conditions like diabetes, hypertension and mental disorders, their productivity is bound to be less which leads to reduced GDP growth and higher healthcare spending.

On their part, the working population should take care of their health by eating healthy food, exercising and going for regular medical check-ups.

**Veena Shenoy**
Thane

**Trump's reality show**

The US-Iran peace deal is being played out by Donald Trump in an episodic fashion. One ends with an imminent conclusion only to start next week with caveats and then again to flag a beguiling conclusion. Last weekend it had Trump declaring the deal very nearly done. But his latest statement indicates a new course: a 60-day extension of ceasefire and a directive to his negotiators to go slow. Trump's objectives are clear. A peace deal will be concluded but only just ahead of crucial mid-term elections in the US in November. A deal now would take away his punch line of success reserved for campaigns on the eve of the elections. Clearly, we are in for an extended Hormuz impasse.

**R Narayanan**
Navi Mumbai

**RBI's dividend transfer**

This refers to 'Fiscal dividend' (May 25). The massive dividend transfer by the RBI to the government is welcome news for the Indian economy. The transfer comes at a crucial juncture when the government requires resources for infrastructure, employment generation and social welfare programmes. Such support can help maintain fiscal discipline and reduce pressure on interest rates. Equally important is the RBI's decision to retain substantial funds in its contingency reserves. In an uncertain global environment, a strong reserve buffer safeguards India's financial stability.

**Bal Govind**
Noida

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# Big ideas for Bihar

## Transforming the State into an industry powerhouse

**Manvendra Prasad**

**BIHAR.** Agri-biz potential
RANJEET KUMAR

Bihar has a new captain, though much of the crew remains unchanged. Two decades of Nitish Kumar's stewardship have delivered tangible gains: among the fastest GSDP growth rates in India, near-universal road connectivity, improved power availability, and steady progress in social indicators such as infant mortality.

Yet the gap remains stark. Per capita income is roughly a third of the national average, and on metrics like power consumption, poverty, and literacy, Bihar still ranks near the bottom.

The task now is forward-looking — to convert incremental gains into structural transformation.

If Bihar wants to seriously catch up with the rest of India, it has to move from a policy announcement mindset to a deal-closing, investor-facing State and showcase its execution credibility to earn investor trust. Fortunately, Bihar doesn't need to do everything — it needs to do a few things exceptionally well and signal credibility.

Bihar should resist the allure of capital-intensive "sunrise" sectors like semiconductors and instead back areas where it has clear comparative advantage and strong multiplier effects.

Agriculture and allied value chains are the obvious first bet. Historically an agrarian State, it is endowed with fertile soil and abundant water resources and a large producer base in maize, litchi, makhana, and vegetables along with high potential in fresh water fish production. Bihar has significant opportunities of moving from raw produce to processed and branded exports. Agro-processing is well-suited to the State's context: it is not land-intensive, works with fragmented holdings, and creates significant employment in activities such as grading, packaging, dairy collection, and fish processing.

However, stable downstream linkages — with FMCG firms, retail chains, hospitality, and quick-service restaurants — are essential.

Textiles and apparel, leather, and footwear, and even sports goods manufacturing align well with Bihar's labour surplus. With Bangladesh set to lose its Least Developed Country trade privileges, India has a chance to reclaim its global position in textile exports — and Bihar must actively participate in this resurgence. Given the labour intensity, lower capital requirement and SME dominance in sports goods, Bihar could easily tap into this space with the right policy push and reverse migration of skilled labour from these centres.

**CLUSTER-BASED APPROACH**

Cluster-based industrialisation can anchor this strategy. Bihar should develop focused clusters — agro-processing zones around makhana and maize, textile and apparel parks, and sports goods hubs — supported by common infrastructure, logistics, and worker housing.

Geography adds another lever. With improved road connectivity, its location within eastern India and with proximity to Nepal, Bihar can emerge as a logistics and warehousing hub. Leveraging the Dedicated Freight Corridor and inland waterways, a Ganga economic corridor — integrating logistics, warehousing, and agro-processing — could position the State as a regional distribution backbone.

Planned urban development of Gaya and or Patna into a world-class metropolitan centre, supported by robust municipal governance can be a game changer for the region.

Like Gaya became a spiritual tourism hub especially to Buddhist nations, Patna can aspire to become a higher education hub to support the skills pipeline for industries and create a centre of academic excellence in eastern India, initiating a virtuous cycle of growth and development.

However, for these ideas to fructify land for industry must become easier to access through plug-and-play industrial parks with pre-cleared approvals and reliable utilities. Governance must shift from control to facilitation — from gatekeeping to deal-making.

The opportunity is real. With focused bets, credible execution, and institutional reform, Bihar can replicate the trajectory of States like Andhra Pradesh and Odisha.

*The writer is a public policy and startup advisor*

# Cost of defending the rupee

## The rupee's decline cannot be explained only by BoP flows. It points to speculative activity profiting from deregulation

**MACROSCAN.**

**CP CHANDRASHEKHAR, JAYATI GHOSH**

For the past few months, the decline in the value of the rupee and the RBI's efforts to contain it have become the among most discussed features of the Indian economy. There is no doubt that the decline in the nominal value of the rupee, especially with reference to the US dollar (which has otherwise been declining itself with respect to other major currencies) has been sharp.

Figure 1 shows that this is not a new tendency, and that the rupee has fallen almost continuously since 2018, by nearly 50 per cent. However, the recent decline, since the turn of the year, has been especially sharp.

Indeed, the period since the US-Israel war on Iran has been especially bad for the Indian rupee. The currency has underperformed, not only with respect to its peers in the BRICS countries, but more tellingly even in South Asia. Figure 2 shows how (taking an average of the values in every quarter) between Q4 (Oct-Dec) of 2024, before the war started, and up to Q1 (Jan-Mar) of 2025, the Indian rupee depreciated more than all other South Asian currencies.

Bear in mind that all our South Asian neighbours are experiencing various degrees of political and economic crisis or instability, and the poor performance of the Indian rupee becomes even more telling.

Normally, changes in the overall balance of payments would provide a clear answer as to why this has been occurring — and that too, so dramatically. Either current account deficits would have grown without adequate change in capital inflows, or financial outflows, in the form of capital flight, would have triggered this process of rupee decline. Of course, if both occur together, then a sharp decline is only to be expected.

**COMPLEX ISSUE**

But this is where the issue becomes more complex. An examination of the overall balance of payments data does not suggest such a severe imbalance over the past year that would generate such a change in the value of the currency. In fact, the net balance of payments appears to have been largely stable in 2025.

As Figure 3 indicates, there was a brief period of January-March 2025 when the current account was in net surplus (largely due to the inflow of foreign remittances and the decline in imports, including oil and gold). But this was counterbalanced by net capital outflows in the period. In all other quarters since the last quarter of 2024, the current account has been in deficit while the financial inflows have been positive.

This seems to be counterintuitive. There has been much evidence — and discussion — on the increased extent and pace of private financial outflows, so this seems quite contrary to the observed reality of capital flight that the RBI is now apparently trying to control. But if net capital inflows have been positive, and more than balanced the current account deficit, then how and why is the rupee depreciating in value?

The answer obviously requires further investigation, but one hypothesis is clearly worth exploring. This is the growing role of internal trade in the rupee, through banks, foreign exchange brokers and other such entities, who have been speculating on the possibility of future declines in rupee value and have thereby made their own expectations self-fulfilling. To the extent that such trades do not require the intermediation of the RBI, they would not be reflected in the balance of payments. And large legacy holdings of dollars or other "hard currencies" within the country could be part of this trade.

> **The growing role of internal trade in the rupee, through banks, foreign exchange brokers and other such entities, who have** been speculating on the possibility of future declines in rupee value could be a factor in its decline

**RBI ACTION**

Also, as and when the RBI intervenes in forex markets, its actions also contribute to the "financial flows" that appear in the balance of payments. And such intervention has been strongly evident in the past year. Figure 4 indicates the very large changes in the value of foreign exchange reserves held by the RBI, with a fairly sharp decline of nearly $38 billion in the last quarter of 2024.

Thereafter there were two quarters when forex reserves were built up once again, but since July 2025 there has clearly been a revival of open market operations by the RBI, with rupee purchases designed to stabilise the currency. These would effectively be part of the net financial inflows.

This was so extensive that apparently the RBI recorded a net sale of $53.1 billion of reserves in the financial year 2025-26. This was around $12 billion more than its net sales in the previous financial year. And there seem to be no signs of this abating: as recently as Thursday May 21, the RBI apparently sold at least $2 billion in the open market on one day alone.

So some of what appear to be "market fundamentals" could actually reflect the RBI operating to curb speculative activity in the forex market, in a situation in which domestic financial agents and traders are able to use their deregulated powers to bet on a falling rupee. This helps to explain some of the other measures the central bank has taken. In March, the central bank put a limit of $100 million on net open rupee positions of banks, which are estimated to have grown to significant levels of anywhere between $25-25 billion. But this had little effect as banks then exited their position by offering them to corporate clients. As a result, in early April, the RBI barred banks from offering rupee non-deliverable forwards to resident and non-resident clients and barred companies from rebooking cancelled forward contracts.

Essentially, therefore, the RBI is fighting speculative activity that has become much harder to control after various financial deregulation measures allowed the onshore trading of the rupee. It was only to be expected that such speculation will accentuate and intensify the economic pressures that are already evident and likely to become even worse as global economic uncertainty persists. The need for greater financial regulation has never been more evident.

CHART 1
### Continuous fall
Nominal exchange rate - Rupees per US dollar

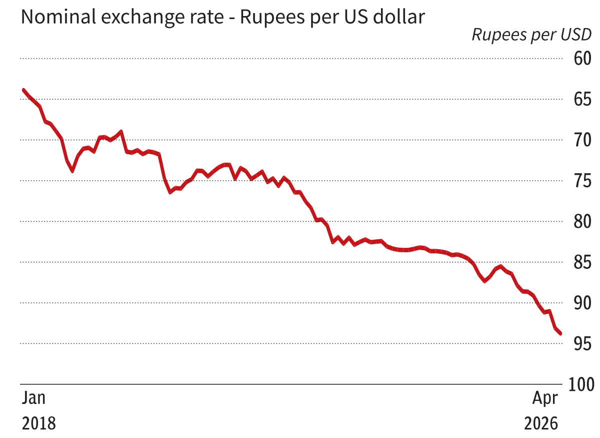



CHART 2
### Weak rupee
Percentage depreciation in US dollar nominal exchange rate, Q4 2024 to Q1 2026

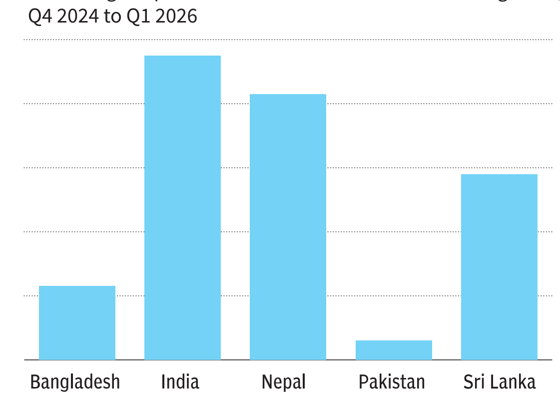



CHART 3
### BoP profile
India's balance of payments ($ billion)

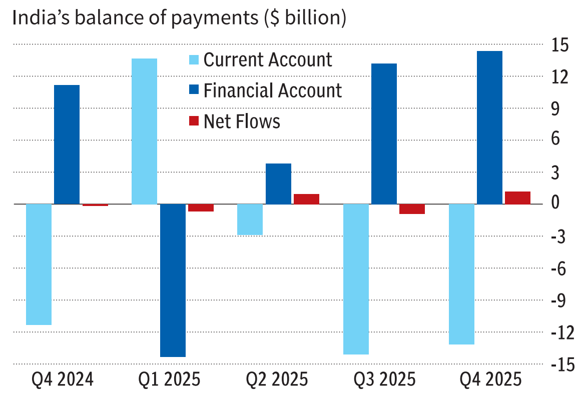
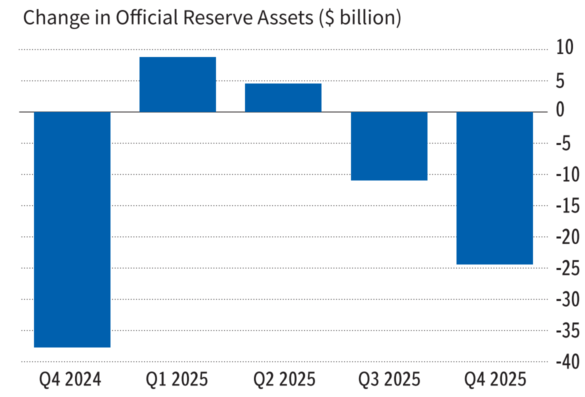



CHART 4
### Forex value
Change in Official Reserve Assets ($ billion)




Source: Federal Reserve of St Louis, IMF

thehindu businessline.

## TWENTY YEARS AGO TODAY.

May 26, 2006

**States to seek higher share of VAT pie**

A higher devolution of service tax collections, powers to levy and collect service tax on 68 services, entire proceeds of value added tax (VAT) on imports, powers to levy VAT on three additional excise duty (AED) items forms part of a compensation package that States will seek from the Centre for phase out of Central Sales Tax (CST).

**Sensex recovers as margins ease**

Easing of margin deposits by half and smooth rollover in the derivatives contracts helped revive market's sentiment on Thursday as share indices closed higher by about one per cent, after opening weak. The key BSE-30 Sensex ended at 10.666.32, up 93.17 points or 0.88 per cent, on a day of volatile trading, which saw the index falling by about 300 points during early trade. The Nifty closed up by about 2 per cent or 62.15 points at 3,177.70.

**Decision on petro price likely next week**

A decision on revision of domestic fuel prices could be expected some time next week. According to official sources, the decision would be a mix of a price increase and duty cuts on oil products.

# Japan PM unveils $19 billion extra budget

**Reuters**

Japan will build up an extra$19 billion in reserves to subsidise fuel costs and help tackle cost of living pressures, Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi said on Monday, while looking to assuage bond market concerns by promising no extra borrowing overall.

The supplementary budget, first reported earlier this month, marks a reversal from Takaichi's previous remarks ruling out the need for extra spending, but comes as a spike in energy prices following the Iran war — along with rising import costs from the weak yen — threaten her persistently high support among the electorate.

The extra budget of some 3 trillion yen ($19 billion) comes after the government decided to use roughly half of its 1trillion yen contingency reserves to fund subsidies aimed at curbing utility bills, increasing the need to replenish reserves amid the risk of a prolonged Middle East crisis.

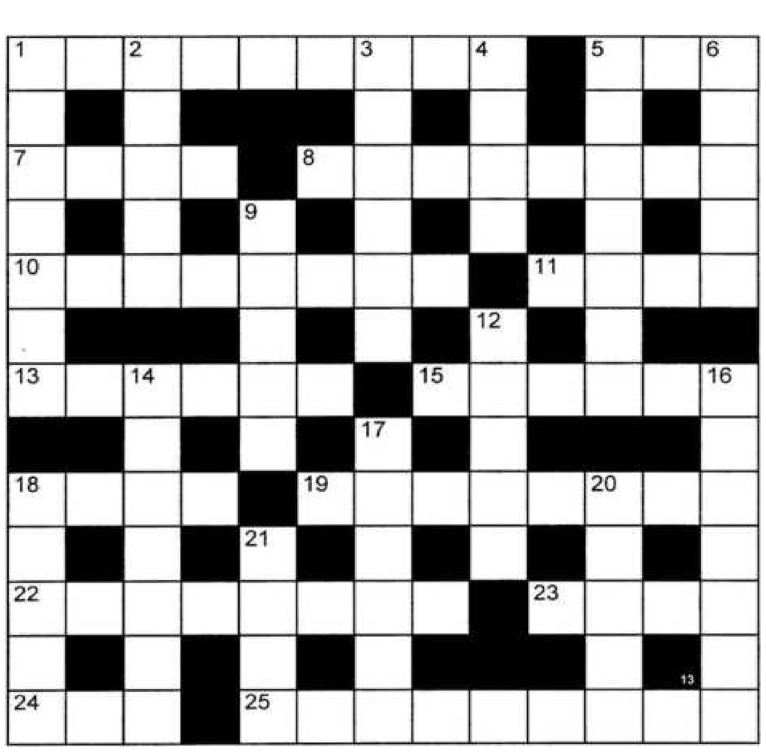
Japan has also been extending separate subsidies to keep gasoline prices steady, a costly step that is quickly using up its contingency reserves as oil prices remain elevated.

Takaichi told reporters the extra spending will be financed by deficit-financing bonds, but added she believes the measure could be implemented "without affecting the government bond market".

The overall amount of bond issuance will remain unchanged from the original plan, she said, as stronger tax revenues, non-tax income and expected underspending are likely to eliminate the need for around 3 trillion yen in deficit bonds that had been scheduled for issuance through June.

"While closely monitoring daily market developments and economic indicators, the government will steadily reduce the debt-to-GDP ratio to ensure fiscal sustainability and maintain market confidence," Takaichi told reporters.

## BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2687




### EASY

**ACROSS**
01. Voracious sea-bird (9)
05. Taxi (3)
07. Coloured part of eye (4)
08. Posture (8)
10. Cherished, of great worth (8)
11. Slightly red (4)
13. Sudden check, unlooked-for refusal (6)
15. Terrible smell (6)
18. Mail (4)
19. Train passageway (8)
22. Worthy of praise (8)
23. Rod, perch (4)
24. Add up (3)
25. Not temporary (9)

**DOWN**
01. Fast sailing-ship (7)
02. Lift (5)
03. Dexterous, cunning (6)
04. Slender (4)
05. Heedfulness (7)
06. Fracture (5)
09. A moment, instant (5)
12. Stern, harsh; naked (5)
14. Cracker, wafer (7)
16. Crops gathered in (7)
17. Water-heater (6)
18. Harbour guide (5)
20. Male of honey-bee (5)
21. Source of light (4)

### NOT SO EASY

**ACROSS**
01. Bird from the moor can't get round it (9)
05. Vehicle for hire starts charging at boarding (3)
07. The fleur-de-lis is to be found around one of the USA (4)
08. Position one takes may be insolent in manner (8)
10. Our spice may be of great value (8)
11. A somewhat socialist small sailing-ship (4)
13. Unexpected rejection with respect to the enthusiast (6)
15. Broken chest contains nitrogen and a bad smell (6)
18. It may be after one's job (4)
19. Passageway or Doric order right for it (8)
22. A lad turning blue deserves one's praise (8)
23. End of Axis seen by one invaded by it (4)
24. Add a dram for the infant (3)
25. The way the railway was meant to last (9)

**DOWN**
01. A tea-ship looked singular in a barber's hands (7)
02. Ear is flapping if there's more money in the pay-packet (5)
03. Scheming with the Dodger (6)
04. It may give a hint of being skinny (4)
05. A warning about an amusing person (7)
06. Snooker score built up in the intermission (5)
09. The instant success of the padded mail-bag (5)
12. Utterly nude and unadorned (5)
14. Unglazed pottery may be a cracker (7)
16. Crop has rash: vet can deal with it (7)
17. A copper for the old fowl (6)
18. Flier has to plan his route around one (5)
20. A non-worker will sound very boring (5)
21. An eye on the electric light bulb (4)

### SOLUTION: BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2686

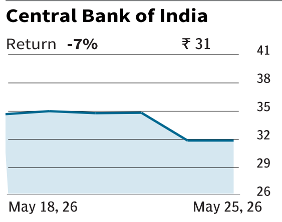
**ACROSS** 1. Paltry 4. Scales 9. Romance 10. Mop up 11. Amok 12. Fall 13. Ear 15. Neat 16. Disc 19. Art 21. Idea 22. Knot 24. Crown 25. Piccolo 26. Letter 27. Adders

**DOWN** 1. Part and parcel 2. Lampoon 3. Ring 5. Complain 6. Lapse 7. Superstitious 8. Medal 14. Patience 17. Console 18. Tempo 20. Trout 23. Acid

CHENNAI
businessline.
TUESDAY · MAY 26 · 2026

## QUICKLY.

### LIC ups its stake to 6.06% in Central Bank of India




**New Delhi:** State-owned insurer Life Insurance Corporation (LIC) has hiked its stake in Central Bank of India to 6.06 per cent, from 3.16 per cent earlier. In a disclosure to stock exchanges, the Central Bank of India said LIC has bought 26.26 crore shares or 2.901 per cent in the public sector lender via market purchase on May 22. Post stake acquisition, LIC's holding in Central Bank of India has increased to 6.06 per cent. Shares of Central Bank of India closed at ₹31.29, down 0.03 per cent over the previous day's close on the BSE. However, LIC shares closed 2.93 per cent higher at ₹837.20. PTI

### SEBI approves 2 Executive Directors at CDSL

**Mumbai:** The Central Depository Services (CDSL) has received approval from the Securities and Exchange Board of India to appoint two new Executive Directors to the board: Amit Mahajan and Nayana Ovalekar. Mahajan will oversee Vertical 1, which encompasses critical operations. Meanwhile, Ovalekar will take on Vertical 2, which covers regulatory, compliance, risk management, and investor grievances. The appointments are subject to ratification by the shareholders of CDSL and will be effective upon their respective dates of joining. The SEBI approval was communicated through letters dated Monday. The stock price of CDSL on Monday closed at ₹1,217.40, up 1.10 per cent, on the NSE. OUR BUREAU

# SEBI moots dynamic options strike price framework to handle swings

**IN REAL TIME.** Exchanges may be required to introduce new option strikes intra-day to ensure trading continuity

**Akshata Gorde**
Mumbai

SEBI has proposed a uniform framework for introducing and managing strike prices of options contracts across exchanges, including a mechanism for intra-day addition of new strike prices during periods of heightened volatility.

The move is aimed at ensuring "predictability and availability of options contracts in case of heightened intra-day volatility for ease of trading in the derivatives segment," the regulator said.

Under the proposal, exchanges will be required to put in place a comprehensive framework for introduction of a minimum number of in-the-money and out-of-the-money options, daily review of strike availability and removal of contracts far away from prevailing market prices. SEBI has proposed that exchanges should have a provision to introduce new strike prices for options contracts intra-day during market hours, in the direction of price movement in the underlying. Such intra-day introduction of strike prices would not require changes in the systems of stock brokers or market participants during live market operations.

**TRADING IMPACT**

A strike price is the fixed level at which an options contract can be exercised. Strike intervals have a bearing on trading activity of market participants in terms of availability of trading products for the participants. "These products need to be loaded in the trading applications/portals of stock brokers on a daily basis and thus, also have a bearing on the systems of stock brokers," SEBI said in a draft paper, inviting public comments by June 15.


**PUT CALL SPREAD.** Exchanges must put in place a framework covering the introduction of a minimum number of in-the-money and out-of-the-money options contracts

"In case of significant intra-day volatility, resulting in price movement beyond the farthest available strike price, the market participants could be inconvenienced because of unavailability of contracts around prevailing price."

**EXCHANGE DISCRETION**

The framework will apply across equity, currency and commodity derivatives segments, though exchanges will have flexibility to decide operational details, such as strike intervals and the minimum number of contracts based on liquidity and participation in each segment.

At present, SEBI's regulatory framework primarily covers long-dated index options, while other segments, including stock, currency and commodity options, follow exchange-specific practices, leading to differences in how strike prices are introduced and managed.

SEBI has proposed discontinuing the existing clause in its December 2024 master circular on stock exchanges and clearing corporations once the new framework is operationalised.

## Nifty tops 24,000 on US-Iran peace hopes, crude plunge

**Anupama Ghosh**
Mumbai

The markets staged a sharp recovery on Monday, driven by a surge in global risk appetite after US President Donald Trump said over the weekend that a peace deal with Iran was "largely negotiated." The prospect of easing West Asia tensions triggered an aggressive unwinding of the war premium in energy markets, pulling crude oil prices sharply lower and reviving broad-based buying across Dalal Street.

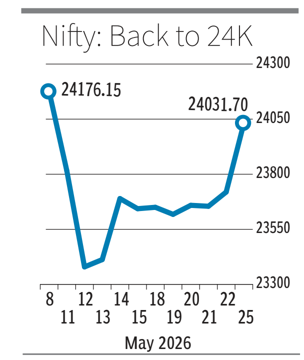
"Sentiment was primarily driven by optimism surrounding a potential US-Iran peace agreement, which triggered a sharp correction in crude oil prices. The outperformance of private banking majors, supportive earnings announcements, and the rupee's further strengthening against the US dollar aided the recovery," said Ajit Mishra, SVP-Research, Religare Broking.

**RUPEE GAINS**

The rupee appreciated for the third straight trading session and ended at an over 2-week high, the rally supported by easing crude oil prices and renewed optimism around a potential US-Iran agreement. It was also supported by RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra hinting, in an interview, that the rupee may be actually undervalued rather than overvalued.

The rupee ended at 95.23, up 46 paise against the dollar. The currency has appreciated 1.8 per cent from the low it had hit last week.

The Nifty 50 closed at 24,031.70, up 312.40 points, after touching an intra-day high of 24,054.45 — its first sustained close above the psychologically significant 24,000 mark in recent sessions. The BSE Sensex settled at 76,488.96, gaining 1,073.61 points. The Bank




Nifty outperformed, surging 1,238.30 points to close at 55,293.65.

Banking and financial stocks led the rally. PSU Bank index surged 3.1 per cent, while private sector heavyweights including HDFC Bank, ICICI Bank and Axis Bank saw strong institutional buying. Other sectors that ended with gains include Auto, Realty, Chemicals, Oil & Gas, Consumer Durables and Cement. FMCG was the sole laggard. Broader markets joined the rally, with Nifty Midcap gaining 0.94 per cent and Nifty Smallcap advancing 1.37 per cent.

Market volatility eased sharply. India VIX fell 6.28 per cent to close at 16.70, reflecting a meaningful reduction in hedging activity and improved risk appetite.

"Sustainability of this momentum will depend on a credible de-escalation in geopolitical tensions and continued stability in crude oil prices," said Vinod Nair, Head of Research, Geojit Investments.

Scheduled monthly derivatives expiries over the next two sessions and an ongoing earnings season are expected to keep stock-specific volatility elevated. Technically, the Nifty's next resistance band sits at 24,150-24,200, with a sustained move above potentially opening the door toward the 24,400-24,600 zone.

The 23,800-23,875 band will serve as key support on any dip, said a brokerage.

## Eicher Motors up 6% post Q4

**Our Bureau**
Mumbai

Shares of Eicher Motors climbed sharply on Monday after the Royal Enfield parent reported its best-ever quarterly earnings on Friday, with most brokerages reaffirming buy calls. Eicher Motors stock ended at ₹7,414, up 6.19 per cent on the NSE.

Goldman Sachs maintained 'Buy' with a revised target of ₹8,400, raised from ₹8,000, calling the Q4 print broadly in line. It said gross margins held flat q-o-q despite 90 basis points of commodity headwind, offset by a 70 bps price hike in January and 20 bps from mix and value engineering. HSBC and Citi echoed the optimism.

HSBC kept 'Buy' with a ₹8,200 target, noting that Royal Enfield's growth trajectory above the industry justifies a premium valuation and that a greenfield expansion beyond the two-million-unit Cheyyar brownfield project has been announced.

Citi, with a ₹8,350 target, pointed to a planned greenfield facility at ₹2,500 crore and a new financing joint venture with Volvo that could support VECV volumes. CLSA held an 'Outperform' at ₹7,651, flagging capacity utilisation nearing 90 per cent and a projected 12 per cent volume CAGR for Royal Enfield by FY26–28.

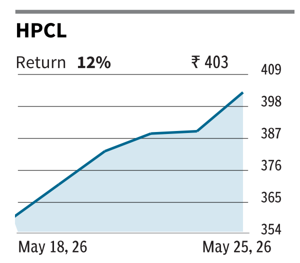
Morgan Stanley retained an 'Equal-weight' at ₹7,763. However, JM Financial maintained a 'Reduce' with a target of ₹7,240.

## OMC stocks jump on price hike, crude oil slipping to $95 per barrel

**Our Bureau**
Mumbai

Shares of state-owned oil marketing companies ended Monday's session with solid gains after Brent crude settled near $95 per barrel — its lowest level in over two weeks — and the government raised domestic fuel prices for the fourth time in less than a fortnight, improving the earnings outlook for state-run retailers.

Hindustan Petroleum Corporation closed 3.52 per cent higher at ₹403.35 on the NSE after touching a session high of ₹412.55. Bharat Petroleum Corporation gained




4.28 per cent to close at ₹308.25, with the session high at ₹309. Indian Oil Corporation ended 3.21 per cent higher at ₹143.95, having hit an intra-day peak of ₹145.30.

All three stocks turned positive for May and are on course to close in the green for the second consecutive month, despite remaining down 13–19 per cent year-to-date in 2026.

Petrol and diesel prices were raised by ₹2.61 and ₹2.71 a litre respectively on Monday — the fourth hike since May 15 — taking cumulative increases to nearly ₹7.5 a litre. The repeated revisions, aimed at narrowing under-recoveries for OMCs, coincided with a sharp retreat in global crude prices, together widening marketing margins for the three companies, which collectively control around 90 per cent of India's fuel retail market.

Brent crude futures and WTI fell close to 5 per cent each to $95.43 a barrel and $91.73 respectively.

## 5 listed REITs distribute over ₹8,900 cr to unitholders in FY26

**Our Bureau**
Mumbai

India's five listed Real Estate Investment Trusts (REITs) have collectively distributed more than ₹8,900 crore to over 4.25 lakh unitholders in FY25-26 because of strong operating performance, portfolio expansion and growing investor participation.

The Indian REIT association said the total gross asset value of the Indian REIT market stood at more than ₹2.72 lakh crore as of March 31, 2026, while the combined market capitalisation of the sector was over ₹1.7 lakh crore as on May 22.

During the March quarter, the five listed REITs — Brookfield India Real Estate Trust, Embassy Office Parks REIT, Knowledge Realty Trust, Mindspace Business Parks REIT and Nexus Select Trust — together distributed over ₹2,566 crore. The sixth REIT — Bagmane Prime Office REIT — was listed on the exchanges earlier this month.

Alok Aggarwal, MD and CEO, Brookfield India Real Estate Trust, and Chairperson of IRA

Alok Aggarwal, Managing Director and CEO, Brookfield India Real Estate Trust, and Chairperson of the IRA, said the industry saw "strong growth in distributions, expansion of high-quality real estate portfolios, and increasing investor participation".

**CUMULATIVE PAYOUTS**

"The cumulative distribution of over ₹8,900 crore in FY26 represents a robust year-on-year growth of over 50 per cent. This significant increase underscores the resilience of the underlying assets, strong operating performance, and the sector's ability to deliver stable and predictable cash flows to unitholders," he said.

The five REITs together manage more than 187 million sq ft of Grade A office and retail real estate across India. Since inception, they have collectively distributed over ₹31,700 crore to unitholders.

REITs, which were introduced in India in 2019 under the regulatory framework of the Securities and Exchange Board of India, have emerged as an alternative investment avenue for institutional and retail investors seeking exposure to rent-yielding commercial real estate assets.

The Indian REITs Association is a non-profit industry body formed under the guidance of SEBI to promote the development of the REIT market in the country.

## JM Fin launches ₹1,000 crore credit AIF

**Our Bureau**
Mumbai

JM Financial Asset Management on Monday launched its second Credit Alternative Investment Fund, JM Financial Select Credit Fund II (SCF II), with a base size of ₹1,000 crore and a green-shoe option of an additional ₹1,000 crore, taking the total potential corpus to ₹2,000 crore.

SCF II is a Category II AIF that will target performing credit opportunities in companies with stable cash flows and strong business fundamentals.

The fund aims to provide structured credit solutions to businesses while delivering risk-adjusted returns to investors.

The strategy will be led by Amit Dharod, Managing Director, Alternative Assets, who joined JM Financial Asset Management last year from Ascertis Credit.

## VT Markets expands to 500+ US stocks

**Our Bureau**
Mumbai

VT Markets, a multi-asset trading platform operating in over 160 countries, has added 39 US stocks and ETFs to its line up, pushing its total US-listed offerings beyond 500 instruments.

The expansion targets high-growth thematic sectors including artificial intelligence infrastructure, commercial space technology, semiconductors, clean and nuclear energy, optical communications and institutional digital assets.

Notable additions include Arm Holdings, AppLovin, ASML Holding, AST SpaceMobile, Constellation Energy, Circle Internet Group, Rocket Lab and Galaxy Digital.

The additions reflect a broader market shift from consumer-facing AI narratives toward the underlying infrastructure driving AI adoption, including optical networking, electricity generation and data centre equipment. Defence spending linked to geopolitical developments also features among the new picks.

**GLOBAL EXPOSURE**

The new line up further includes regional and thematic ETFs covering China, Japan, India, South Korea, Brazil and US treasuries, giving traders exposure to macro and interest rate movements across key global markets.

VT Markets said the expansion responds to growing retail trader demand for targeted sector exposure beyond traditional blue-chip equities, as market momentum broadens across multiple themes in 2026.

The broker offers access to more than 1,000 financial instruments across its platform. The latest additions take effect from Monday.

## BROKER'S CALL.

### Axis Securities

**PRESTIGE ESTATES (BUY)**
Target: ₹1,830
CMP: ₹1,400.70

Prestige Estates Projects' FY26 pre-sales crossed ₹30,000 crore, up 76 per cent year on year, while collections rose 53 per cent to over ₹18,500 crore, reflecting healthy demand and strong execution. Office occupancy remained healthy at 92 per cent, while retail assets operated at nearly full occupancy of 99 per cent, supporting stable recurring cash flows. Leasing momentum in premium assets continues to improve with strong rental traction from GCCs and large corporates. In hospitality, FY26 revenue crossed ₹1,050 crore with EBITDA of around ₹400 crore. Prestige maintains strong growth visibility supported by an extensive project pipeline and a significant unrecognised revenue base. The company added projects worth over ₹50,000-crore GDV during FY26 and has an FY27 launch pipeline of nearly ₹68,000 crore. The management remains optimistic on demand conditions across key markets and guided for 15-20 per cent growth in both pre-sales and collections in FY27 despite a high base. With a large upcoming launch pipeline across Bengaluru, Chennai, Mumbai, NCR and Hyderabad, alongside improving annuity income from office, retail, and hospitality assets, Prestige appears well-positioned for sustained growth, stronger cash flows and gradual improvement in profitability.

We maintain our Buy recommendation on the stock and continue to value the company using a DCF-based valuation to arrive at a TP of ₹1,830/share, implying a 32 per cent upside from the CMP.

### Elara Securities

**PNC INFRATECH (ACCUMULATE)**
Target: ₹257
CMP: ₹212.75

After two years of decline in execution, PNC Infratech is likely to witness a gradual recovery from FY27, supported by ramp-up across key hybrid annuity model (HAM) projects, new order-wins and contribution from solar and mining businesses. Q4FY26 standalone revenue remains flat year on year at ₹1,460 crore, dragged by slower execution in select road, HAM and irrigation projects. PAT fell 17 per cent to ₹100 crore, primarily due to lower operating profitability and absence of one-off gains seen in the base period. The management expects execution momentum to improve over FY27. EBITDA margin guidance remains at about 12 per cent, although near-term profitability could drag given commodity volatility and elevated input cost. The company is witnessing gradual diversification beyond roads, with mining execution scaling up and solar & BESS projects expected to start contributing from FY27 (combined portfolio of ₹5,000 crore). Following completion of the PNC Challakere, the company has monetised 12 road assets with an equity value of ₹2,520 crore vs ₹1,740 crore invested, implying valuation of 1.4x P/BV. While order pipeline, healthy balance sheet and new project opportunity landscape remain supportive, near-term execution and margin trajectory depend on timely mobilisation and stabilisation in commodity prices. We cut FY27E earnings by 11 per cent and retain them for FY28. We introduce FY29E. We maintain Accumulate with an unchanged TP of ₹257 on 13x FY28E P/E.

businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: **blmarketwatch@gmail.com**

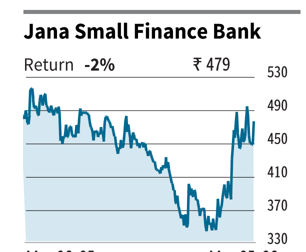
## TODAY'S PICK.

### Jana Small Finance Bank (₹479.85): BUY

**Gurumurthy K**
bl. research bureau

The stock is stuck in a range of ₹426-₹507 for more than a month now. Within that the stock has now started to move up from the lower end of this range. A trendline support is also present above ₹442 which makes this ₹442-₹441 range a very strong support. We expect the stock to make a bullish breakout of this range above ₹507.

Such a break can take Jana Small Finance Bank shares higher to ₹540 in the coming months. Trader can buy Jana Small Finance Bank shares now at ₹480. Accumulate on dips at ₹460. Keep the stop-loss at ₹440. Trail the stop-loss up to ₹488 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹496. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹498 and ₹515 when the price touches ₹510 and ₹525, respectively. Exit the long positions at ₹530.




Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is a risk of loss in trading

## Day trading guide

24115 » **Nifty 50 Futures**

| S1 | S2 | R1 | R2 | COMMENT |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 24020 | 23960 | 24165 | 24300 | Wait for dips. Go long at 24060. Keep the stop-loss at 24005 |

₹787 » **HDFC Bank**

| S1 | S2 | R1 | R2 | COMMENT |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 783 | 780 | 795 | 800 | Go long now and at 784. Stop-loss can be kept at 781 |

₹1168 » **Infosys**

| S1 | S2 | R1 | R2 | COMMENT |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1160 | 1145 | 1180 | 1200 | Wait for dips. Go long at 1163 with a stop-loss at 1155 |

₹304 » **ITC**

| S1 | S2 | R1 | R2 | COMMENT |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 302 | 299 | 305 | 308 | Go long only above 305. Stop-loss can be kept at 304 |

₹285 » **ONGC**

| S1 | S2 | R1 | R2 | COMMENT |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 284 | 281 | 287 | 290 | Take fresh shorts below 284. Keep the stop-loss at 285 |

₹1366 » **Reliance Ind.**

| S1 | S2 | R1 | R2 | COMMENT |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1355 | 1345 | 1380 | 1400 | Wait for dips. Go long at 1358 with a stop-loss at 1345 |

₹972 » **SBI**

| S1 | S2 | R1 | R2 | COMMENT |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 966 | 960 | 982 | 988 | Go long now and at 968. Stop-loss can be placed at 964 |

₹2308 » **TCS**

| S1 | S2 | R1 | R2 | COMMENT |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2300 | 2270 | 2320 | 2335 | Go short on a break below 2300. Keep the stop-loss at 2305 |

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

### Nifty 50 Movers ▲ 312.40 pts.

| | Close(₹) | Pts | PE | Wt(%) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| HDFC Bank | 786.85 | 66.91 | 15.29 | 10.93 |
| ICICI Bank | 1291.80 | 42.87 | 15.96 | 8.38 |
| L&T | 4033.40 | 27.34 | 29.27 | 4.30 |
| State Bank | 969.60 | 18.46 | 10.33 | 3.65 |
| Reliance Ind | 1367.00 | 18.41 | 19.32 | 8.38 |
| Axis Bank | 1311.20 | 16.14 | 15.35 | 3.41 |
| Bajaj Finance | 941.90 | 14.79 | 30.32 | 2.29 |
| Kotak Bank | 392.85 | 13.97 | 20.26 | 2.62 |
| Eicher Motors | 7414.00 | 12.98 | 37.96 | 0.93 |
| M&M | 3139.00 | 11.24 | 20.96 | 2.54 |
| Eternal Ltd. | 247.67 | 8.98 | 653.03 | 1.62 |
| Adani Enter | 2849.70 | 8.27 | 37.00 | 0.74 |
| Titan | 4159.20 | 7.14 | 72.02 | 1.56 |
| Shriram Finance Ltd. | 961.95 | 6.40 | 22.58 | 1.22 |
| Maruti Suzuki | 13170.00 | 5.24 | 28.21 | 1.57 |
| Bajaj Finserv | 1807.40 | 5.21 | 14.71 | 0.95 |
| ITC | 303.95 | 4.73 | 18.39 | 2.66 |
| Tata Motors PV | 373.25 | 4.52 | 4581.80 | 0.71 |
| Bharat Elec | 421.85 | 4.14 | 50.87 | 1.37 |
| UltraTech Cement | 11726.00 | 4.05 | 42.20 | 1.26 |
| Dr Reddys Lab | 1331.40 | 3.22 | 26.73 | 0.74 |
| IntGlobeAvi | 4501.90 | 3.12 | 54.21 | 0.92 |
| SBI Life | 1901.90 | 3.06 | 77.22 | 0.78 |
| Adani Ports | 1802.90 | 2.57 | 32.50 | 1.21 |
| Jio Financial Services Ltd. | 241.74 | 2.54 | 98.39 | 0.72 |
| Wipro | 206.84 | 2.32 | 16.35 | 0.54 |
| Bharti Airtel | 1874.80 | 2.28 | 33.77 | 5.22 |
| Tata Steel | 210.22 | 1.86 | 24.11 | 1.58 |
| Tech Mahindra | 1435.50 | 1.84 | 29.27 | 0.83 |
| Cipla | 1413.90 | 1.80 | 29.58 | 0.72 |
| Asian Paints | 2657.80 | 1.77 | 65.20 | 1.09 |
| NTPC | 390.05 | 1.45 | 15.23 | 1.68 |
| Grasim Ind | 3171.60 | 1.35 | 20.95 | 1.10 |
| PowerGrid Corp | 295.35 | 1.04 | 17.25 | 1.21 |
| Apollo Hosp | 8404.00 | 0.93 | 60.34 | 0.78 |
| HDFC Life | 620.00 | 0.80 | 69.95 | 0.60 |
| JSW Steel | 1289.40 | 0.80 | 12.36 | 1.10 |
| Coal India | 458.00 | 0.72 | 9.08 | 0.94 |
| HCL Tech | 1165.70 | 0.39 | 19.00 | 1.12 |
| Trent Ltd. | 4300.00 | 0.17 | 88.80 | 0.87 |
| TataConsumerProduct | 1187.20 | -0.65 | 75.95 | 0.70 |
| Sun Pharma | 1840.60 | -0.92 | 40.32 | 1.77 |
| Hind Unilever | 2196.50 | -1.37 | 48.77 | 1.77 |
| Bajaj Auto | 10491.00 | -1.41 | 27.73 | 1.05 |
| NestleIndia | 1413.60 | -1.49 | 77.90 | 0.92 |
| TCS | 2308.20 | -2.03 | 16.89 | 2.14 |
| Hindalco | 1099.60 | -3.03 | 15.37 | 1.44 |
| Max Healthcare | 1000.85 | -3.63 | 68.63 | 0.68 |
| ONGC | 284.95 | -4.28 | 7.97 | 1.00 |
| Infosys | 1168.50 | -4.59 | 16.08 | 3.72 |

Pts: Impact on index movement

### Nifty Next 50 Movers ▲ 1,032.80 pts.

| | Close(₹) | Pts | PE | Wt(%) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Adani Power | 233.38 | 164.17 | 34.70 | 3.85 |
| Tata Motors Cv | 395.65 | 74.93 | 48.11 | 3.30 |
| Bpcl | 308.25 | 72.37 | 5.17 | 2.49 |
| Cholamandalam&Fin | 1591.00 | 61.90 | 25.90 | 2.72 |
| Gail (India) | 168.67 | 60.16 | 12.89 | 1.81 |
| Canara Bank | 133.70 | 52.06 | 6.78 | 1.80 |
| Indian Oilcorp | 143.95 | 47.25 | 4.65 | 2.14 |
| Adanigreenenergy | 1411.10 | 46.19 | 116.98 | 1.89 |
| Union Bank | 168.87 | 44.46 | 6.63 | 1.30 |
| Bank Of Baroda | 272.25 | 35.87 | 7.01 | 2.01 |
| Adani Energy Solutions | 1404.30 | 35.65 | 70.50 | 1.94 |
| Punjab Natl Bank | 106.26 | 35.04 | 6.61 | 1.46 |
| Tvs Motor Cmp | 3469.50 | 34.47 | 51.73 | 3.25 |
| Power Finance | 438.90 | 34.32 | 4.31 | 2.55 |
| Indian Hotels Co. | 663.55 | 32.97 | 42.03 | 2.32 |
| Hindustanaeronautics | 4425.90 | 30.80 | 32.47 | 3.35 |
| Torrent Pharma | 4572.60 | 25.51 | 68.12 | 1.91 |
| Zyduslifesciences | 1072.95 | 24.01 | 21.07 | 1.07 |
| Tata Power | 413.55 | 21.98 | 25.82 | 2.76 |
| Shree Cement | 25355.00 | 21.52 | 52.32 | 1.35 |
| Bajaj Holdings | 10642.00 | 19.43 | 12.10 | 1.84 |
| Rural Elec | 342.20 | 18.51 | 5.53 | 1.70 |
| Muthootfin | 3354.40 | 17.47 | 12.70 | 1.43 |
| Solar Industries | 18377.00 | 16.85 | 95.76 | 1.78 |
| Macrotech Developers | 906.85 | 15.98 | 26.40 | 1.02 |
| Hyundai Motor India | 1880.90 | 13.00 | 28.14 | 1.07 |
| Indian Railway Finance Corp | 100.45 | 12.83 | 18.73 | 0.81 |
| Siemens Energy India | 3559.60 | 12.81 | 96.78 | 1.25 |
| Vedanta | 332.50 | 12.23 | 8.20 | 2.25 |
| Tata Capital | 309.55 | 12.01 | 26.87 | 0.53 |
| Hdfc Amc | 2758.10 | 11.16 | 41.34 | 2.24 |
| Cummins India | 5382.00 | 11.06 | 66.55 | 2.90 |
| Dlf | 592.30 | 10.14 | 33.21 | 1.51 |
| Abb India | 6755.00 | 9.70 | 90.59 | 1.41 |
| Ambuja Cements | 441.95 | 9.64 | 19.88 | 1.07 |
| Bosch | 36310.00 | 6.00 | 38.62 | 1.26 |
| Cg Power & Ind Sol | 867.90 | 4.26 | 114.22 | 2.37 |
| Hindus Zinc | 634.50 | 2.75 | 19.38 | 1.10 |
| Jindal Steel | 1212.30 | 2.51 | 36.80 | 1.79 |
| United Spirits | 1284.10 | 1.67 | 50.03 | 1.51 |
| Mazagaon Dock | 2470.20 | 0.24 | 36.16 | 0.75 |
| Pidilitind | 1477.20 | -1.05 | 60.85 | 1.83 |
| Britannia Ind | 5327.00 | -1.50 | 50.58 | 2.50 |
| Samvardhmothersoninternatl | 135.91 | -3.37 | 35.11 | 2.40 |
| Ltimindtree | 3991.60 | -4.24 | 23.75 | 1.48 |
| Godrej Consumer | 1020.40 | -8.06 | 56.09 | 1.64 |
| Avenuesuper | 4097.20 | -8.23 | 89.77 | 2.40 |
| Varun Beverages | 530.70 | -33.81 | 55.93 | 2.90 |
| Siemens | 3667.50 | -35.98 | 82.38 | 1.29 |
| Divis Lab | 6756.50 | -46.82 | 72.35 | 3.42 |

Pts: Impact on index movement

## QUICKLY.

### George is new part-time Chairman of Federal Bank

**Kochi:** The Reserve Bank of India has accorded approval for the appointment of Elias George as the part-time Chairman of the bank for three years. George was serving as an independent director on the board of the bank since September 5, 2023. His distinguished career in the Indian Administrative Service includes serving in various Union Ministries, as well as in Kerala, focusing particularly on infrastructure creation and financing and running public utilities. OUR BUREAU

### Shriram General ties up with Piramal Finance

**New Delhi:** Shriram General Insurance has announced a corporate agency partnership with Piramal Finance to improve access to insurance solutions. Under the partnership, SGI will leverage Piramal Finance's extensive branch network to offer its insurance products across 701 branches of Piramal Finance, a joint statement said. PTI

# 'Challenges to the economy are more on external front'

**WAR IMPACT.** Sitharaman flags rising forex burden due to high oil, fertilizer, gold prices

**Our Bureau**
Mumbai

High and fluctuating global crude oil prices, an unimaginable increase in fertilizer prices and high gold prices amid the West Asia conflict are creating challenges on the external front as payments for all these commodities have to be made in foreign exchange, said Union Minister for Finance & Corporate Affairs Nirmala Sitharaman.

"To just put it in context, all these three payments have to be in foreign exchange. There is no rupee trading there," she said at an event to celebrate SIDBI's 37th foundation day.

**FOCUS ON 3Fs**

Sitharaman urged the audience, which included Special Secretary in the Department of Financial Services Sanjay Lohiya, chiefs of public sector banks and SIDBI top brass, to understand the context of the three Fs — fuel, fertilizer and foreign exchange — and the foreign exchange is, in this context, purchase of gold.

**MAKING A POINT.** Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman addressing the 37th Foundation Day event of the Small Industries Development Bank of India in Mumbai on Monday PTI

"So, we need to understand this and we also should appreciate that the challenges are more externally driven," she said.

She made the aforementioned statement in the context of Prime Minister Narendra Modi on May 11 giving a call to conserve foreign exchange as far as possible in the backdrop of the West Asia conflict leading to a spike in crude oil prices, which, in turn, had weakened the rupee.

Sitharaman underscored that India's domestic economic situation remains positive and resilient even today. But there are naysayers who jump into the scenario as it were and say, everything is crumbling. There is a section which very quickly wants to deny the achievements of our own people, she said.

"It's not right is one thing, but it is wrong because it is fear-mongering. India cannot afford fear-mongering. We need to give confidence to the people with our words and with our action, and that's what you're seeing at various levels and today you're seeing it through SIDBI as well," Sitharaman said.

Referring to delayed payments (including State PSUs and commercial enterprises) continuing to be a critical challenge for MSMEs, with an estimated ₹8.1 lakh crore in delayed payments affecting working capital and growth, the Minister emphasised that she periodically reviews the public sector undertakings under the government to make sure that they don't exceed the 45-day limit by which they have to pay dues to the MSMEs, and they shall not be sitting over their dues.

Sitharaman emphasised that to shield citizens and businesses from the steep rise in global crude prices, Central excise duty on petrol and diesel was reduced by ₹10 per litre. The government is estimated to take a revenue impact of over ₹1 lakh crore on this score in the year 2026–27 because of this decision.

# No blanket extension on ALMM for solar PV cells beyond June 1: MNRE

**Our Bureau**
New Delhi

The Ministry of New & Renewable Energy (MNRE) said on Monday that no blanket extension of the deadline for applicability of Approved List of Models and Manufacturers (ALMM) List-II for solar PV cells beyond June 1, 2026, is required.

The decision has been taken after detailed examination of representations received from stakeholders and wider consultations held with the industry, it added.

Under the existing framework for ALMM List-II for solar PV cells, net-metering projects and open access projects commissioned prior to June 1, 2026, are exempt from the applicability of ALMM List-II.

**ALMM PROVISIONS**

Projects commissioned after this date will be required to comply with the ALMM provisions. The Ministry had received several representations regarding the timeline of June 1, 2026, with some stakeholders seeking extension of the deadline, and others saying that no extension should be granted.

During the review process, the Ministry also considered the Office Memorandum dated April 29, 2026, issued by the Department of Expenditure which, *inter alia*, advised treatment of the ongoing West Asia situation as war and suggested that time extension for a period of not less than two months and not more than four months may be considered on the basis of specific situations and not through a blanket policy, MNRE said.

"After detailed examination of the representations received and wider stakeholder consultations, it has been decided that no blanket extension of the deadline for applicability of ALMM List-II for solar PV cells beyond June 1, 2026, is required to be provided," it added.



# Sundaram Finance continues to focus on diversification as consolidated net rises 10% in FY26 on higher lending

**Our Bureau**
Chennai

As part of its Sundaram 75 strategic roadmap, the TSF Group's Sundaram Finance is evaluating diversification into other secured products, such as gold loans, accelerating used vehicle financing, grow lending to MSMEs and expand geographically beyond South India.

"We've evaluated gold loans as part of the Sundaram 75 plan. We'll have to take it to our board; at present, we looked at a range of possibilities as adjacencies," Rajiv C Lochan, MD, Sundaram Finance, told mediapersons.

The Sundaram 75 Plan, which the NBFC is now executing as it turns 75 in 2029, is also intended to help build consistency in execution and ensure that SF is able to decouple from macroeconomic shocks, he added.

As for its progress, the 'beyond wheels' portfolio, mainly MSME lending, is now about 15 per cent of their disbursements, and SF has added about 55-60 branches or so, with a large part of these in North India, Lochan said.

He was speaking at the announcement of the annual results of the NBFC.

**NET PROFIT UP**

On a consolidated basis, net profit for FY26 grew by 10 per cent to ₹2,059 crore as compared to ₹1,879 crore in FY25. During FY26, the company provided for ₹75 crore under "exceptional items" towards the impact of the new Labour Codes.

The consolidated results include results of its subsidiaries Sundaram Home Finance, Sundaram Asset Management and Royal Sundaram General Insurance.

Rajiv C Lochan, Managing Director, Sundaram Finance, at a press conference in Chennai BIJOY GHOSH

On a standalone basis, net profit for FY26 stood at ₹1,834 crore against ₹1,543 crore in FY25. Profit for Q4FY26 was ₹608 crore as against ₹546 crore in Q4FY25. The profit came on the back of robust disbursement growth in both Q4 and FY26 as the second half of the fiscal saw a boom in vehicle sales due to GST rationalisation.

Disbursements for FY26 grew by 14 per cent to ₹32,321 crore, its highest ever. Disbursements for Q4FY26 alone grew by 17 per cent to ₹8,051 crore. Assets under management (AUM) grew 16.4 per cent to ₹59,908 crore.

**FUEL PRICE HIKE**

As for the impact of the rising fuel price hikes on their business, Lochan said they are not seeing any stress at the moment, but are monitoring closely by maintaining close customer contact and supporting them, wherever required, with restructuring or moratoriums.

SF's gross and net NPA, as per RBI norms, are 2.14 per cent and 1.27 per cent respectively, against 2.17 per cent and 1.38 per cent as of March 2025.

"Our group companies in asset management, general insurance and home finance have continued to record strong results. We continue to rely on our time-tested approach of steady and sustainable growth with best-in-class asset quality and consistent profitability," said Harsha Viji, Executive Vice-Chairman, Sundaram Finance, said in a statement.

The board declared a final dividend of ₹24 per share (240 per cent).

Shares of Sundaram Finance closed the trading day at ₹4,394 per share, down around 2.2 per cent on the NSE.

# Govt expands Ebola vigil, all incoming passengers to be screened

**Aneesh Phadnis**
Mumbai

All incoming passengers will be screened for symptoms of Ebola virus as the government intensifies its surveillance against the disease.

While passive screening using thermal cameras has been place since the Covid-19 pandemic, the vigil has been increased now.

On May 22, the Directorate General of Civil Aviation had issued an order asking airlines offering direct and indirect connectivity to Uganda and the Democratic Republic of Congo to distribute self declaration forms to passengers.

While the May 22 order has not been amended, instructions were issued to all international airlines operating in Delhi on Monday to distribute these forms, thus expanding the surveillance against the virus.

Passengers are required to mention if they have visited or transited through the affected country in the past 21 days, if he/she has come in contact with any Ebola patient and if they have any disease symptoms.

The form is collected by the Immigration Department and then shared with the Airport Health Organisation doctors.

If a passenger has a travel history to the affected countries, then the information will be shared with the respective district administration for monitoring.

# Pine Labs posts ₹113 crore profit in FY26; bets big on AI, global expansion

**Our Bureau**
Bengaluru

Pine Labs reported its first full year of profitability in FY26, marking a major milestone for the fintech major as it scaled payments, commerce infrastructure and AI-led offerings across India and international markets.

The company posted profit after tax (PAT) of ₹113 crore in FY26, compared to a loss of ₹145 crore in the previous year, while Q4 FY26 delivered a record quarterly PAT of ₹59 crore. Operating cash flows for the year rose eightfold year-on-year to ₹395 crore, with the March quarter alone contributing ₹76 crore — the highest quarterly operating cash flow in the company's history.

Revenue for FY26 grew 19 per cent year-on-year to ₹2,711 crore, while adjusted EBITDA rose 57 per cent to ₹559 crore. EBITDA margins expanded to 21 per cent from 16 per cent a year ago. The company processed $194 billion in gross transaction value (GTV) during FY26, up 50 per cent year-on-year, while UPI volumes surged 68 per cent.

Pine Labs said its platform now enables more than 20 million daily transactions.

"These numbers tell us we are winning transactions, winning merchants and winning in new markets," said Amrish Rau, CEO. "When GTV grows at 50 per cent while revenue grows at 19 per cent, it reflects the platform depth we have built — and it leaves significant monetisation headroom ahead of us."

**AI-LED PUSH**

The company is deepening its AI-led push. It said nearly 89 per cent of its code changes are now contributed by AI agents as it looks to integrate AI across underwriting, merchant services and commerce infrastructure.

# The case for cutting State taxes on petroleum products

**TAX DISPARITIES.** While the Centre reduced excise duty in March, States have not cut VAT or sales tax rates thus leaving prices high for consumers

**Sourashis Banerjee**
Chennai

Retail fuel prices in India have inched up yet again, with petrol becoming costlier by ₹2.61 per litre and diesel by ₹2.71 per litre from May 23, 2026. This is the fourth hike in the last 10 days, bringing the cumulative total close to ₹7.

DEEP DIVE.

Such increases typically raise concerns over inflation and increased transport costs, dampening demand. While the Centre has reduced the excise duty it charges on petrol and diesel by ₹10 towards the end of March, States have not made any similar cuts this year, yet.

Given the large variation in the sales tax and VAT rates charged by States on the sale of petrol and diesel, and the high tax rates in some States, there is room to lower taxes in some regions to provide relief to consumers.

### LEADERS IN ABSOLUTE FUEL TAX COLLECTIONS

A *businessline* analysis of State-wise collection of taxes on petroleum products of the top 11 States and Union Territories, ranked according to their GSDP, reveals that in absolute terms, fuel taxes form a significant chunk of the State's Own Tax Revenue (SOTR).

Data from PPAC for the first nine months of FY26, up to December 2025, show Maharashtra earning the highest sales tax and VAT revenue from petroleum products at ₹27.5 thousand crore. Uttar Pradesh followed with ₹23.2 thousand crore, while Gujarat collected ₹21.6 thousand crore.

The southern States remained major recipients of fuel taxation. Karnataka earned ₹19.5 thousand crore, marginally ahead of Tamil Nadu's ₹19.2 thousand crore. While Andhra Pradesh earned ₹12.2 thousand crore and Telangana earned ₹12.1 thousand crore from fuel taxes, this underlines the continuing importance of petroleum consumption to State finances.

The share of taxes on petroleum products in the SOTR shows a large variation across States and Union Territories. The share appears to be influenced by a variety of factors, including the level of consumption, tax rates, the degree of industrialisation in the region and other sources of tax revenue.

### SHARE IN SOTR

Of the 11 States and UTs analysed, Gujarat gets the highest share of SOTR from petroleum products at 18.6 per cent. Gujarat is home to some of the world's largest refineries and is a highly industrialised State. Even with low tariffs on petrol and diesel, revenue from petroleum product taxes accounts for a significant share of its SOTR.

This contrasts with Delhi, where tax on petroleum products now accounts for only 6.6 per cent of SOTR in FY26. Delhi, on the other hand, is less industrialised and earns more revenue from other sources, such as GST, given its consumption-led economy.

According to Manoj Mishra, Partner at Grant Thornton Bharat, "Petroleum continues to remain one of the most fiscally significant and resilient tax bases given its deep linkage with transport, logistics, manufacturing and overall economic activity. Since State VAT on petroleum products is largely *ad valorem*, higher crude-linked retail prices can continue to support State revenues even during inflationary periods unless States voluntarily recalibrate VAT rates. Therefore, while petroleum's share in SOTR may be declining structurally due to revenue diversification, it continues to remain a critical fiscal stabiliser for States during commodity and inflation shocks."

### LARGE VARIATION

The retail selling price of petrol on May 25 was ₹102.12, ₹111.21, ₹113.51 and ₹107.77 in Delhi, Mumbai, Kolkata and Chennai, respectively. The difference is primarily due to the variation in tax rates charged by the States and UTs.

The top 11 States and UTs analysed for this study can be divided into three buckets based on their levy on petrol and diesel.

States that levy very high taxes, such as Telangana, Andhra Pradesh, Rajasthan, Karnataka, Maharashtra, and Madhya Pradesh, fall into the first bucket.

Telangana charges 35.2 per cent VAT on petrol and 27 per cent VAT on diesel. Andhra Pradesh follows closely with a multi-layered structure that includes 31 per cent VAT on petrol, along with an additional ₹4 per litre VAT and a ₹1 per litre road development cess.

Tax levies on petrol in Karnataka, Rajasthan, Maharashtra and Madhya Pradesh also effectively exceed 30 per cent.

### MIDDLE & LOW

In the second bucket are states with tax rates that are neither too high nor too low.

Tamil Nadu and West Bengal fall in this category. Tamil Nadu follows a mixed structure, charging a 13 per cent *ad valorem* tax plus ₹11.52 per litre specific tax on petrol, and an 11 per cent *ad valorem* tax plus ₹9.62 per litre specific tax on diesel.

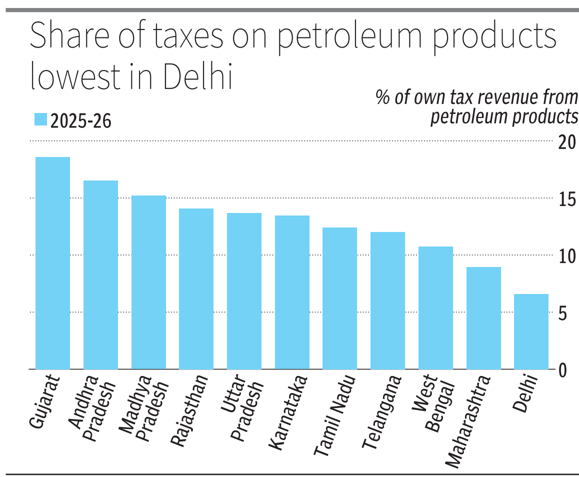
West Bengal levies a higher rate of 25 per cent, or ₹13.12 per litre, as sales tax, in addition to a cess component.

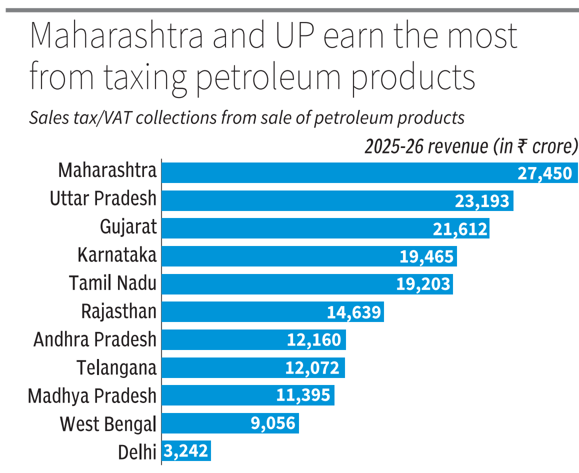
The third bucket includes States which have relatively lower tax rates, below 20 per cent. These are Uttar Pradesh, Gujarat and Delhi.

Uttar Pradesh uses a hybrid formula of percentage tax or fixed per-litre levy, whichever is higher. Gujarat and Delhi continue to maintain relatively lower effective tax rates compared to several southern and western states.

With consumers bearing the brunt of ongoing retail price increases, it may be time for the States to review their fuel tax rates, especially those in the first bucket.

With inputs from intern Anu Keerthana




### Telangana, followed by AP, levies the highest taxes on fuel

*State tax rates levied on petrol and diesel (as on May 1, 2026)*

| State | Petrol | Diesel |
|---|---|---|
| Andhra Pradesh | 31% VAT + ₹4/litre VAT+₹1/litre Road Development Cess and VAT thereon | 22.25% VAT + ₹4/litre VAT+₹1/litre Road Development Cess and VAT thereon |
| Delhi | 19.40% VAT | ₹250/KL air ambience charges + 16.75% VAT |
| Gujarat | 13.7% VAT+ 4% Cess on Town Rate & VAT | 14.9% VAT + 4% Cess on Town Rate & VAT |
| Karnataka | 29.84% sales tax | 21.17% sales tax |
| Madhya Pradesh | 29% VAT + ₹2.5/litre VAT+1% Cess | 19% VAT+ ₹1.5/litre VAT+1% Cess |
| Maharashtra | 25% VAT+ ₹5.12/litre additional tax | 21% VAT |
| Rajasthan | 29.04% VAT+ ₹1500/KL road development cess | 17.30% VAT+ ₹1750/KL road development cess |
| Tamil Nadu | 13% + ₹11.52 per litre | 11% + ₹9.62 per litre |
| Telangana | 35.20% VAT | 27% VAT |
| Uttar Pradesh | 19.36% or ₹14.85/litre whichever is higher | 17.08% or ₹10.41/litre whichever is higher |
| West Bengal | 25% or ₹13.12/litre whichever is higher as sales tax+ ₹1000/KL cess *(20% additional tax on VAT as irrecoverable tax)* | 17% or ₹7.70/litre whichever is higher as sales tax + ₹1000/KL cess *(20% additional tax on VAT as irrecoverable tax)* |

Source: PPAC

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## New Delhi to host Quad meet today

**Our Bureau**
New Delhi

External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar is set to host the Quad Foreign Ministers' meeting on Tuesday, with counterparts from the US, Australia and Japan attending amid the continuing West Asia crisis.

The Ministers are also expected to discuss the agenda for the next Quad leaders' summit, the date for which is yet to be announced.

US Secretary of State Marco Rubio, who is concluding a four-day India visit after the Quad meeting, underlined the growing importance of the grouping, saying the Indo-Pacific would become increasingly significant over time.

### WEST ASIA CRISIS

The Ministers are expected to discuss the West Asia crisis in detail, particularly its impact on the global economy and energy security. Countering China's growing influence in the Indo-Pacific and securing supply chains are also expected to feature prominently in the talks.

Australian Foreign Minister Penny Wong, in a statement issued ahead of her India visit on Monday, described the Quad as "a vital partnership" in uncertain times.

"Four nations working together to shape a peaceful, stable and prosperous future for the Indo-Pacific region," she said.

Wong added that Australia, India, Japan and the US were delivering concrete outcomes in areas such as maritime security, critical minerals, infrastructure development and disaster relief.

"In keeping with the Quad vision for a Free and Open Indo-Pacific, the Ministers will build on discussions held in Washington DC on July 1, 2025. They will exchange views on advancing Quad cooperation across priority areas, review progress on ongoing initiatives and reflect on recent developments in the Indo-Pacific and other international issues of mutual concern," the Ministry of External Affairs had said earlier.

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## WorkEZ planning to add capacity as demand rises

**T E Raja Simhan**
Chennai

WorkEZ, a Chennai-based managed office space provider, is accelerating its expansion across South India, aiming to scale its overall capacity to nearly 35,000 seats over the next two years amid rising demand from global capability centres (GCCs), IT firms and hybrid-work occupiers.

The managed office space provider currently operates around 24,000 seats across Chennai, Coimbatore and Bengaluru, serving sectors such as GCCs, IT services, automobile manufacturing, insurance and BFSI.

"We have around 18 Fortune 500 firms among our clients," said Sunil Reddy, MD and Founder, WorkEZ, without disclosing their names.

### CHENNAI EXPANSION

The number of seats for GCCs range between 100 and 1,000, he said. "We want to perfect our model in the South first and then gradually move North," he told *businessline*.

WorkEZ is adding multiple facilities in Chennai, including centres at Phoenix and SSPDL in Alwarpet, besides a larger asset on the Pallavaram-Tambaram radial road corridor.

The Phoenix facility is expected to go live in two months, while most of the newly-announced centres are scheduled to become operational by September-end.


Sunil Reddy, MD and Founder, WorkEZ BIJOY GHOSH

The Phoenix and SSPDL projects are expected to add around 1,700 seats to the company's portfolio, he said.

According to the firm, GCCs remain the biggest growth driver.

Clients range from firms requiring 100 seats to large occupiers taking over 1,000 seats. The company said demand is shifting towards fully-managed and customised plug-and-play office spaces.

WorkEZ currently earns average revenue of ₹10,500-₹11,000 per seat and reported revenue of around ₹138-₹140 crore in the previous financial year.

It expects to grow revenue by another 30-35 per cent this fiscal.

The Coimbatore facility, expected to become operational over the next 24 months, could increase the company's seating capacity in the city from around 2,000 currently to nearly 8,000 seats, said Reddy.

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## Skye Air targets US entry by 2028

**Aishwarya Kumar**
Bengaluru

Drone logistics start-up Skye Air Mobility is targeting entry into the US market by 2028, and expects to begin testing and regulatory trials with the Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) soon.

In an interaction with *businessline*, Founder and CEO Ankit Kumar said all drones for the US market will be manufactured in India, underscoring the company's export ambitions.

"We see India continuing to remain our base for manufacturing. We will evaluate the timing and nature of future investments as the business scales, but our manufacturing operations will largely remain in India," said Kumar.

The company has partnered with Arrive AI, a Nasdaq-listed firm, and has secured approvals to conduct proof-of-concept (PoC) trials in Indiana's designated drone test zones.


"We are working with Arrive AI to develop use cases, initially focused on healthcare deliveries. Once that is established, we will expand into e-commerce and quick commerce applications. Similar to our model in India with large e-commerce players, we eventually see opportunities to work with major players in the US as well," said Kumar.

### DOMESTIC FOOTPRINT

Skye Air plans to begin its US operations with healthcare deliveries before expanding into e-commerce and quick commerce.

The company is also scaling its domestic footprint, with expansion planned in Mysuru, Mumbai and Pune. E-commerce currently accounts for 95 per cent of its revenue, and the company aims to onboard more than 100 D2C brands this year.

### D2C DELIVERIES

According to market intelligence platform Tracxn, Skye Air reported revenue of ₹3.3 crore and a loss of ₹14 crore in FY25.

Kumar expects direct-to-consumer (D2C) deliveries to emerge as a key growth driver. "In terms of revenue, D2C is likely to generate nearly twice what e-commerce contributes for us, while e-commerce volumes continue to be maintained," he said.

Skye Air currently works with brands such as Freedo and Bombay Shaving Company, to enable deliveries within 2-4 hours, and aims to onboard more than 100 D2C brands this year.

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## LTM partners with SSP Group to modernise IT infra using AI technology

**Our Bureau**
Bengaluru

LTM has entered a strategic partnership with the UK-based SSP Group, a leading operator of food and beverage outlets in travel locations worldwide.

Through this AI-powered partnership, LTM will deliver modernised, end-to-end IT infrastructure support and enhanced application maintenance services to the SSP Group.

As part of the engagement, LTM will also leverage its advanced AI capabilities, including its BlueVerse ecosystem, to help SSP manage operational risks and drive business efficiency and agility.

### SCALABLE SOLUTIONS

The collaboration will focus on enabling data-driven decision-making, accelerating innovation through automation, delivering scalable solutions that enhance customer experience and driving cost optimisation through AI automation and simplification.

"As we continue to advance our IT capabilities, having a trusted partner like LTM with deep domain expertise and a focus on AI-led innovation will help us accelerate our transformation, enhance efficiency, improve support operations and deliver greater value to our customers," said Jon Wood, Chief Digital and Technology Officer, SSP Group.

### GLOBAL NETWORK

In the long run, LTM will support SSP's transition to an intelligent and streamlined IT infrastructure that supports its global network.

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# QUICKLY.

### Cyient raises $30 m at $500 m valuation

**Hyderabad:** Cyient Semiconductors, an arm of Cyient Ltd, has raised $30 million at a valuation of $500 million from Edelweiss India Alternatives Ltd and affiliated co-investors. The transaction includes an equity investment of about $10 million at a valuation of $500 million and $20 million in structured debt designed to support long-duration growth of the company. OUR BUREAU

### Schneider Electric sees India data centre boom

Schneider Electric expects its India data centre business to outpace broader operations in the country over the next four to five years, driven by surging demand for AI-ready infrastructure, according to a senior executive. Data centres currently account for 15 per cent to 20 per cent of Schneider Electric's India business and are growing at a double-digit pace, with the firm expecting the segment to become a much larger share, Sumati Sahgal, Vice-President for Secure Power and Data Centres, Greater India Zone, said. REUTERS

# West Asia conflict: Austerity measures to impact diesel, petrol demand growth

**FUEL SUPPLY SECURITY.** The retail prices of petrol and diesel have not been raised since April 2022

**Rishi Ranjan Kala**
New Delhi

The austerity measures activated by the government to preserve economic stability, rein in inflation and ensure energy security are putting pressure on demand growth for key transport fuels, diesel and petrol.

Global real time data and analytics provider Kpler said that recent austerity measures suggest Indian policymakers are increasingly prioritising macroeconomic stability, inflation management, foreign currency preservation and fuel supply security over near-term transportation fuel growth.

**FUEL GROWTH**

While the measures are unlikely to trigger outright demand destruction, they are expected to materially slow India's transportation fuel growth trajectory during the second half of the year, it anticipates.

Revisions to India's annual transport fuel demand growth

(kbd)

| | Gasoline | Jet/ Kero | Gasoil/ Diesel |
|---|---|---|---|
| Annual demand (kbd, May 2026) | 1,035 | 217 | 1,991 |
| Revised 2026 demand after government measures (kbd) | 1,010 | 212 | 1,970 |
| Annual demand growth (kbd, May 2026) | 63 | 11 | 63 |
| Revised 2026 demand growth after government measures (kbd) | 38 | 6 | 42 |
| Annualised revision (kbd) | -25 | -5 | -20 |

kbd - thousand barrels per day Source: Kpler

Elif Binici, Kpler's Lead Analyst-Modeling, expects India's 2026 refined products demand growth has been revised downwards by roughly 77,000 barrels per day (b/d) from the previous estimate of 1,28,000 b/d to around 78,000 b/d.

"The revisions primarily reflect weaker expected growth in gasoline and diesel demand as higher costs, weaker mobility trends and recent government-led fuel conservation efforts increasingly feed into domestic transportation activity," he told *businessline*.

At the centre of the issue is the growing financial stress facing state-run oil marketing companies, he said.

**PRICE HIKE**

The retail prices of petrol and diesel were not raised since April 2022.

However, the government has in the current month raised prices three times — once by ₹3 per litre and twice by 90 paise a litre. (Kpler's forecast was before the third price rise was announced on May 23.)

The government's austerity measures came amid rising supply concerns with panic buying and precautionary stockpiling reportedly leaving some retailers temporarily short of fuel.

**RETAIL PRICES**

"Retail prices are likely to continue increasing progressively, although a sudden ₹25–30 per litre spike still appears unlikely," Binici said. He explained that the two price rises will help modestly reduce OMC under-recoveries, though the adjustments remain well below the estimated break-even levels.

Based on current fuel demand levels and estimated loss allocations between gasoline and diesel, implied break-even retail prices remain substantially above current pump prices, he said.

"Under current assumptions, gasoline breakeven levels are estimated near ₹125 per litre versus current retail prices of around ₹103/ a litre, while diesel breakeven levels are estimated around ₹115-120 per litre versus current prices near ₹94," he said. Following the first hike in retail prices of diesel and petrol, the Oil Ministry had said that OMC losses declined from ₹1,000 core per day to ₹750 crore daily.

**AUTO FUELS**

"Largest downside is assumed within the two-wheeler-dominated commuting segment, which represents roughly 50 per cent of Indian gasoline demand and is expected to be most sensitive to fuel-saving behaviour, weaker urban mobility and government conservation messaging," he added.

Kpler also expects moderation in discretionary passenger vehicle usage, which accounts for roughly 25 per cent of gasoline demand.

# Quantum computing to hit scale in 2028-29: Dell Tech

**Our Bureau**
Mumbai

Comparing the entry of quantum computing to the Y2K era, Dell Technologies predicted the technology to scale meaningfully by 2028-29.

During the Dell Tech World 2026 event, John Roese, Chief Technology Officer, said companies hinting at the 2028-29 time frame for quantum utility.

Earlier, in December 2025, Roese had predicted quantum to become a bigger disrupter than the entry of ChatGPT, owing to the mathematical sophistication it will bring in. "I don't want to say this is the date but there is a bit of a convergence probably in the 2028-29 time frame where some of these things get scaled enough to do something interesting. Companies are no longer saying it's a decade out or giving random 2-5 years but saying dates more openly," he said.

According to Michael Dell, Comapny CEO, Dell intends to lead the industry in PQC (post quantum cryptography) compliance and close quantum encryption.

The company's 18th generation server product line will be PQC-compliant from day one, he said.

The company aired the possibility of quantum-live systems in 2029 as Roese said he felt "very comfortable" with teams inching closer to resolving the engineering challenges in some of these modalities.

Dell hinted at a new domain of processing with the entry of quantum computing, stating, "It's pretty hard to even imagine what this is going to look like if you're stuck in the classical computing construct. It's like Y2K, except you don't know when it's coming."

**HYBRID STRATEGY**

The company's strategy is to work on hybrid classical quantum computing rather than the current classical computing, calling the manifestation of a quantum computer "an additive market".

"We have very clear identified problems to get to quantum utility, which means we have some usefulness out of these systems, not universal usefulness," said Roese.

# AI smart glasses gain momentum, but India adoption may take time

**Aishwarya Kumar**
Bengaluru

**Audio-based AI smart glasses are expected** to account for about 91 per cent of shipments

Smart AI eyewear is emerging as the next frontier in wearables after smartwatches and smart rings. While products such as the Ray-Ban Meta smart glasses have popularised the category globally, adoption in India is expected to remain gradual as high prices continue to limit mass-market appeal.

The category received a fresh boost this week when Google unveiled its Android XR-powered AI glasses at its developer conference, Google I/O 2026, highlighting partnerships with Samsung and eyewear brands Gentle Monster and Warby Parker.

Under the collaboration, Samsung will handle hardware development, while Gentle Monster and Warby Parker will focus on eyewear design and optical support. Google will provide the Android XR operating system, integrating its Gemini AI assistant and Internet services.

**FORMAL ENTRY**

The move marks Google's formal entry into a market currently dominated by Meta.

According to Smart Analytics Global (SAG), Meta commands nearly 80 per cent of the global AI smart glasses market. However, Google's ecosystem advantages could intensify competition and accelerate category growth.

**SHIPMENTS GROW**

Linda Sui, Founder and Principal at SAG, has forecast that global AI smart glass shipments will grow 85 per cent year-on-year in 2026 to exceed 15 million units.

Audio-based AI smart glasses are expected to account for about 91 per cent of shipments.

SAG estimates that Google's AI smart glass shipments could cross 2 million units globally in 2026, assuming no major supply constraints or launch delays.

The research firm believes Google's combination of Gemini AI, Android integration, Samsung's hardware expertise and established eyewear partners could create a credible challenger to Meta's early lead.

Despite the global momentum, industry executives believe India's adoption curve will be slower.

"It has already been the case that smart AI eyewear first emerged as an urban premium product category with Meta Ray-Ban smart glasses, followed by more affordable variants from brands such as Aeoss," said Abhilash Kumar, Lead Research Advisor (Director) at SAG.

**MAINSTREAM BRANDS**

However, he noted that most mainstream brands continued to position smart eyewear as a premium wearable category, suggesting that mass-market adoption may still take time.

Industry observers argued that consumer acceptance will depend not only on technology but also on factors such as comfort, styling, prescription compatibility and privacy safeguards. For Indian eyewear companies, the opportunity lies in making the technology relevant to everyday use rather than positioning it purely as a gadget.

"Eyewear can become one of the most natural interfaces for AI because glasses are already part of people's everyday lives," said Nirmal Lobo, Chief Sales and Marketing Officer, eyewear division, Titan Company Ltd .

**EARLY ADOPTION**

According to Lobo, early adoption is likely to be driven by practical applications, such as calls, audio experiences and AI assistance. Over time, however, smart eyewear could evolve into a more contextual and personalised computing interface.

Titan is already evaluating opportunities across different price segments through brands such as Fastrack and Titan EyeX, reflecting its view that long-term scale will come from broader adoption rather than a *niche* premium audience.

The company also believes trust will be critical.

As AI-powered glasses collect and process more user data, privacy and transparency will become key factors influencing consumer acceptance.







# Rossell adds US client amid semicon push

**Aishwarya Kumar**
Bengaluru

Rossell Techsys is accelerating its diversification beyond aerospace and defence, onboarding major US semiconductor equipment customers and positioning itself to benefit from what CEO Senthil Balasubramanian described as the industry's "mother of all ramps" over the next three to four years.

The aerospace and defence electronics manufacturer reported a 62 per cent year-on-year rise in revenue from operations to ₹142.35 crore in Q4 FY26, while profit after tax stood at ₹7.47 crore. Growth was driven by continued momentum across its aerospace, semiconductor and space businesses, supported by programme ramp-ups, repeat orders and deeper engagement with global OEMs and tier-1 customers.

**ONBOARDING**

"During the year, we onboarded one of the major manufacturers in the semiconductor equipment industry and are currently in the process of onboarding a second major US-based manufacturer," Balasubramanian told *businessline*.

According to him, Rossell's aerospace and defence credentials helped it gain traction with customers in adjacent sectors, such as semiconductors and space.

The company currently derives about 70 per cent of its revenue from aerospace and defence and 30 per cent from non-aerospace segments, including space and semiconductors.

**RAPID EXPANSION**

Going forward, Rossell expects the mix to move closer to 60:40, with semiconductors and space accounting for a larger share of revenue.

He said demand in the semiconductor industry is being fuelled by the rapid expansion of AI infrastructure and data centres globally.

"Based on discussions with partners and market intelligence, the current phase is being described as the mother of all ramps," he said, adding that the upcycle could continue for the next three to four years.

Rossell specialises in the design and manufacture of electronic wire harnesses.

The company also provides aftermarket maintenance, repair and overhaul services for these systems.

CHENNAI
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TUESDAY - MAY 26 - 2026

## QUICKLY.

**Gold climbs as peace hopes push oil, $ lower**

Gold rose more than 1 per cent on Monday as hopes of a peace deal to end the Iran war sent the dollar and oil prices lower, easing fears of inflation and a higher for longer interest rates. Spot gold was up 1.2 per cent at $4,561.51 an ounce by 1319 GMT. US gold futures for June delivery gained 0.9 per cent to $4,563.60. REUTERS

**Crude oil at 2-week low as US, Iran deal gains pace**

**London:** Crude oil prices fell about 5 per cent to two-week lows as optimism grew that the US and Iran were moving closer to a peace deal. Brent crude futures were down $5.04 at $98.50 a barrel at 1327 GMT. US WTI futures were down $4.82 at $91.78. Both contracts traded at their lowest since May 7. REUTERS

**US-Iran peace deal hopes lift copper**

Copper prices rose as the dollar and oil fell on hopes of a potential peace deal between the United States and Iran, easing fears of inflation and a global economic slowdown. Three-month copper on the LME rose 0.9 per cent to $13,635 a tonne by 0845 GMT. The most-traded copper contract on the Shanghai Futures Exchange gained 1.1 per cent to 105,650 yuan ($15,548.76) a tonne. REUTERS

# More farmers turning to agri gold loans for faster credit

**MAKING HAY.** Surge in prices of the yellow metal is aiding the trend, says Kotak Mahindra Bank's Shripad Jadhav

**Subramani Ra Mancombu**
Chennai

Agriculture gold loans are witnessing a growth of above 40 per cent, with more farmers opting for them. It has become one of the ways to get credit faster with the surge in the yellow metal's value aiding the trend, said Shripad Jadhav, Business head, Retail agriculture and gold loans, Kotak Mahindra Bank.

"Because the value of the commodity has gone up, availing of gold loans has also gone up. Earlier, what people used to get was ₹40,000-50,000; now they are able to get ₹1-2 lakh. Hence, they are pledging gold," said Jadhav in an online interaction with *businessline*.

While the lending in the industry is around ₹316 lakh crore, the share of agri-gold loans is about ₹4.5-5 lakh crore. A majority of agri-gold loans are with banks, either private or nationalised ones.

**RBI CLARITY HELPS**

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has come up with a lot of clarity in its circular for agri-gold loans, which came into force from April 1.

Earlier, farmers had to mortgage their agricultural land to avail themselves of crop loans. There are quite a few benefits to the availing of agriculture gold loans. First, the processing time is low, with the farmer depositing the gold and getting the credit immediately.

Also, this does not need documentation and other cumbersome procedures.

The RBI's focus on agricultural credit is especially on small and marginal farmers. These farmers have difficulty in mortgaging their land because they are small land parcels, and are have multiple owners. There are a lot of legal issues in land mortgage, and there is shared cropping and common tenancy.

"These issues don't crop up in gold loans," said Jadhav.

Gold is held as reserve in rural areas in a large way.

> Earlier, what people used to get was ₹40,000-50,000; now they are able to get ₹1-2 lakh. Hence, they are pledging gold
>
> **SHRIPAD JADHAV**
> Business head, Retail agriculture and gold loans, Kotak Mahindra Bank

The yellow metal is the best option for farmers to get credit from organised lenders, he said, adding that the interest rates were lower at 9-11 per cent per annum, while repayment terms are in line with that of agricultural loans.

**EASING THE PROCESS**

This has been taking place over the past 2-3 years.

"This is augmented by the availability of lenders because a majority of the banks have started doing this, and they are aggressively promoting it," said the Kotak Mahindra Bank official.

Digitalisation of the process had made things easy for farmers to take loans for agricultural purposes, he said, adding that the RBI had been pushing this over the past 2 years.

It has also regularly come out with circulars to protect consumers.

"This started with Covid, when the RBI increased the loan-to-value (LTV) from 75 per cent to 90 per cent. This is particularly valid for investment purposes, and agriculture is part of investments," said Jadhav, adding that there is no margin monitoring for this.

**RISING TICKET SIZE**

This has resulted in the LTV ticket size increasing from ₹50,000-60,000 to ₹2-2.5 lakh, leading to customer and value growth, he said. The demand for agricultural loans has particularly picked up since 2024, from when gold prices begin to soar.

Stating that credit had been a barrier for small and marginal farmers, he said agricultural gold loans helped farmers leverage the precious stuff they have at home. This is helping them to buy implements or equipment or prepare their lands and purchasing or renting tractors or with harvests. With farmers being able to buy machinery, they are looking for more work to reap higher profits.

Earlier, the gold loan industry was confined to the South, but now it is growing at a faster pace in the other parts.

"Earlier, gold was carrying a stigma as one for emergency loans. That stigma is going off now from consumers' minds," said Jadhav. With norms tightening for unsecured credit, many marginal and small medium enterprises (MSMEs) and shopkeepers are shifting to flexible offerings in gold, where they have the option of only paying the interest. Banks such as Kotak Mahindra have come up with special products for MSMEs.

On repayments by farmers, he said they don't want to lose an object with which they have an affinity. "They are putting in all effort to repay. The repayment options are easy for them," he said, adding that in contrast, micro-finance had witnessed de-growth.

# South-West monsoon loses vigour before entering Kerala

**Vinson Kurian**
Thiruvananthapuram

Arrival of the South-West monsoon appears to be slipping slightly if signals from the Bay of Bengal and the Arabian Sea are any indication.

Sri Lanka, the immediate prior port of call before the monsoon reaches Kerala, said on Monday morning that the season is only "gradually establishing across the island".

The update suggests that the onset over the island is now delayed beyond its normal date of around May 22. From here, the monsoon could take up to a week to reach Kerala.

Myanmar's Department of Meteorology and Hydrology, too, indicated a lull in the monsoon's northward progress. Its advance into central Myanmar is now expected to be delayed by two to four days, according to the latest projections. In this manner, loss of pace upstream now appears to be echoing farther west and south-west, disrupting the monsoon's progression toward Sri Lanka and, subsequently, Kerala.

The Sri Lankan Met Department has said it sees an increase in rainfall over the south-western parts of the island-nation during the next few days.

**UNFAVOURABLE WINDS**

Fairly strong monsoon-friendly winds about (30-40 km/hr) can be expected at times over western slopes of the central hills, Northern, North-central, North-western and Southern provinces and in Triconamalee district.

But the winds are currently unfavourable as they blow unorganised and weak across the Kerala coast, just to the north.

Given these signals, it now appears likely that the onset over Kerala could fall towards the latter half of the India Meteorological Department's (IMD) onset window of May 26 with a margin of plus or minus four days.

A likely low-pressure area developing over the extreme east Bay of Bengal during this period could draw the monsoon flows away, though it may help the monsoon establish with a delay over Sri Lanka first.

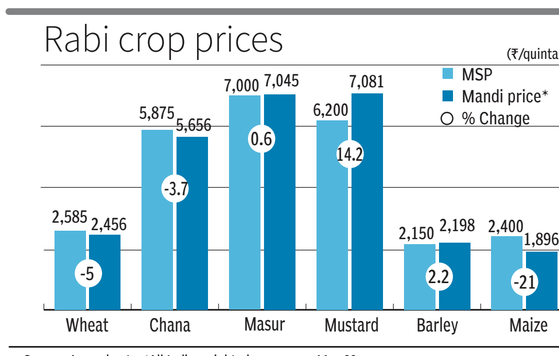
# Mixed trend in *mandi* prices of rabi crops

**Prabhudatta Mishra**
New Delhi

The average *mandi* (agriculture market yard) prices of two of main five rabi crops — wheat, chana (gram), mustard, masur (lentil) and barley — during the current main harvesting season, which started in April and will continue until June-end, were ruling 4-5 per cent below the respective minimum support prices (MSPs).

Prices of three other crops were up to 14 per cent higher than the benchmark government-set rates.

While the higher than MSPs for rabi crops are good for farmers, in the current situation when there have been increases in the rates of other items in recent weeks, better rates in agricultural markets are seen to help growers who solely depend on agricultural crops.




Source: Agmarknet *All India weighted average on May 22

According to *mandi* price data maintained by the Agmarknet portal, among the cereals group, the average all-India farm-gate wheat was ₹2,456/quintal on May 22, down by 5 per cent from its MSP of ₹2,585. Barley rate was average ₹2,198/quintal, up 2 per cent from ₹2,150 MSP.

The price of maize, which is also grown in the rabi season, was down by 21 per cent at ₹1,896/quintal from ₹2,400 MSP.

In the pulses category, the average *mandi* price of chana (gram) was 4 per cent below its MSP at ₹5,656/quintal of ₹5,875. But masur rate was reported at ₹7,045/quintal, a tad above its MSP of ₹7,000.

The rabi season's main oilseed mustard continues to be on the higher side by registering a 14 per cent surge at an average of ₹7,081/quintal from the MSP of ₹6,200.

Government sources maintained that up to 5 per cent below MSP should be seen as normal market behaviour and should not warrant artificial intervention. "The demand-supply should be allowed to play in the market sometimes to correct a surplus situation in any crop, as buying those under the official procurement system will have its challenges in disposing of the commodity," a government official said.

"We have seen in the past also for some commodities, market prices during and immediately after harvesting season are lower than the MSP. However, for some commodities, it is higher than the MSP," said DK Pant, Chief Economist at India Ratings & Research.

# mooMark, Akiba Farm in pact for gelato push in India

**Our Bureau**
Bengaluru

mooMark Pvt Ltd, a wholly owned subsidiary of Stellapps Technologies, has signed a strategic memorandum of understanding (MoU) with Japan's Akiba Farm Holdings to develop a premium gelato business and expand dairy innovation collaboration between India and Japan.

mooMark operates a digital dairy ecosystem with end-to-end traceability from farm to factory.

Its technology platform supports dairy digitisation across more than 42,000 villages in 17 States, covering over 3.5 million registered farmers in an association built over the past 15 years.

The partnership combines mooMark's technology-driven, traceable dairy supply chain with Akiba's expertise in premium gelato craftsmanship and artisanal dairy production.

**MINI LABS**

As part of the collaboration, the companies will set up a dedicated innovation mini-lab for premium dairy product development.

The partnership will also introduce Japanese Total Mixed Ration (TMR) feeding protocols — scientifically balanced systems aimed at improving cattle nutrition, milk yield and sustainability. Starting with pilot trials, the programme will gradually expand across mooMark's smallholder farmer network, supported by its digital monitoring systems.

"By combining mooMark's technology-enabled, fully traceable dairy network with Akiba Farm Holdings' expertise in premium dairy craftsmanship, we aim to build a quality-first model for cross-border dairy innovation," said Ranjith Mukundan, CEO, mooMark Pvt Ltd.

Hidetake Akiba, Representative Director, Akiba Farm Holdings, said India represents one of the world's fastest-evolving dairy markets with a strong potential for premium and value-added dairy products.

# Gold ETF investors hit the exit button again after a week

**Subramani Ra Mancombu**
Chennai

Investments in physically-backed gold exchange-traded funds turned negative again this week, with the US and Chinese investors leading exits from the funds, data from the World Gold Council (WGC) showed.

It is for the second consecutive week that inflows in Asia, particularly China, were negative.

Outflows from the US and China were over $600 million at $635 million and $623 million, respectively.

The WGC data showed that inflows last week into the ETFs were $1.09 billion, while outflows were $2.17 billion.

For the year-to-date period, net investments were down to $18.46 billion from $19.54 billion the previous week.

Losing sheen (as of May 22, 2026)

| Inflows/ outflows | Flows (in $b) |
|---|---|
| Global inflows | 1.09 |
| Global outflows | 2.17 |
| North America | -0.62 |
| Europe | 0.22 |
| Asia | -0.63 |
| Other | -0.04 |

Source: WGC

Exits from the ETFs resumed as gold prices dropped below $4,600 an ounce last week, and the yellow metal has lost nearly 3 per cent in the month.

Gold ETFs have been witnessing higher outflows after the Iran war broke out.

Gold hit a record high of $5,608 an ounce on January 29. Since then, it has been on a downward trend, shedding 19 per cent. On Monday, gold was quoted at $4,560 an ounce.

Last week, outflows in North America were $617.5 million and in Asia, they were $629.4 million.

Europe saw inflows to the tune of $211 million, while other regions witnessed an outflow of $43.3 million.

**US OUTFLOWS SURGE**

Apart from the US and China, other countries to see investors exiting were Australia ($28.1 million), France ($20.2 million), South Korea ($12.1 million) and Turkiye ($15.2 million).

Data on Indian investments were not available.

Year-to-date, net investments in the US continued to be negative, rising to $1.56 billion from $925.2 million.

In the UK, inflows continued to be positive at $2.13 billion, while they were up at $1.90 billion in Switzerland.

Investments in China were down to $8.20 billion (down from $8.83 billion last week).

In China, net investments were $1.26 billion, while they were $0.93 billion in the Special Administration Region of Hong Kong.

**WHY THE FALL**

In terms of tonnage, ETFs hold 4,130.7 tonnes of the yellow metal, compared with 3,540.5 tonnes a year ago. However, they were down from 4,319.4 tonnes the previous week.

The precious metal has traversed southwards since the Iran war broke out on fears of inflation, hike in interest rates and rising bond yields.

Since 2024 till January 29 this year, the yellow metal witnessed a continuous rally on hopes of a rate cut by the US Fed, the US trade dispute with other countries and geopolitical crises.

# Good Food Institute seeks focus on underutilised crop varieties

**Our Bureau**
Mangaluru

A white paper, titled 'R&D priorities in crop optimisation for smart protein applications', by the Good Food Institute (GFI) India points to a wider basket of indigenous crops, including underutilised varieties, as a major opportunity due to their nutritional and agronomic potential.

The list of highly nutritious but underutilised crops included horse gram, winged bean, grass pea, lupin, bambara groundnut, and several indigenous millets and legumes. Many are naturally rich in protein and micronutrients, require lower agricultural inputs and are more resilient to adverse climate conditions.

Padma Ishwarya S, Senior Scientist at GFI India and author of the white paper, highlighted the potential of these crops for emerging applications to produce low-cost sustainable plant proteins, including alternatives to conventional animal-based proteins, where most products today still rely on a narrow basket of crops such as pea, soybean and wheat.

**ON-FARM DATABASE**

The National Gene Bank at the ICAR-National Bureau of Plant Genetic Resources, New Delhi, currently conserves more than 4.52 lakh accessions of various crops and maintains a database of on-farm genetic diversity conservation efforts being carried out by farmers themselves.

A media statement said as India pushes for crop diversification to achieve nutritional security and agricultural resilience, it must think beyond the handful of familiar cash crops. The country was recently crowned the world's largest rice producer, yet it remains dependent on imports for indigenous crops like pulses and oilseeds, while many others have all but vanished from plates.

The result is a food system that delivers calories without adequate nutrition, and a farm economy that remains vulnerable to climate stress and market shocks. Today, over half of the population's protein intake comes from cereals, which are often missing essential amino acids like lysine, it said.

The recommendations include increasing investment into breeding and genomics research, leveraging AI and machine learning tools to accelerate crop trait discovery, and building processing and supply chain infrastructure for India's smart protein sector. The government must continue to support cross-disciplinary research and development and public-private partnerships that bring together agricultural scientists, food technologists and industry players, it said.

# Go short on natural gas contract now at ₹274

**Gurumurthy K**
bl. research bureau

Natural gas prices have come down in the past few days. The natural gas futures contract traded on the Multi-Commodity Exchange touched a high of ₹303.4 per mmBtu on Wednesday last week, and tumbled about 10 per cent from there.

It is currently trading at ₹274.

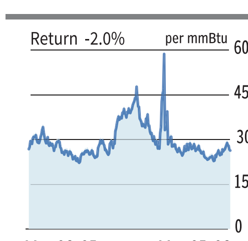
**COMMODITY CALL.**

The fall below ₹280 is a negative, which indicates that the upmove in place since late April this year has reversed.

The region around ₹280 will now act as a good resistance.

As long as the contract stays below ₹280, the bias will remain negative. The contract could fall to ₹255 in the short term.

To avoid this fall, the contract has to rise above ₹280 first, and then get a subsequent break above ₹290. Only then will the upside remain open to see ₹300 and higher levels. But such a strong rise looks less likely.




**TRADE STRATEGY**

Traders can go short now at ₹274. Add more shorts on a rise at ₹278. Keep the stop-loss at ₹284.

Trail the stop-loss down to ₹271 as soon as the contract falls to ₹268.

Revise the stop-loss down to ₹267 and ₹264 when the price touches ₹265 and ₹261, respectively.

Exit the shorts at ₹258.

# Global crude steel output falls 1.9% in April; India posts growth

**Gayathri G**
Chennai

Global crude steel production fell for the fourth straight month in April, dragged down by lower output in China, the Middle East and Russia, even as India consolidated its position as the world's second-largest steel producer with a continued growth in output.

World crude steel production across 69 countries stood at 153.4 million tonnes (mt) in April 2026, down 1.9 per cent year-on-year, according to data released by the World Steel Association.

China, the world's largest producer, manufactured 83.6 mt of crude steel during the month, a decline of 2.8 per cent from a year earlier. Its output in the January-April period fell 4.1 per cent to 331.1 mt, reflecting continued weakness in its property and construction sectors.

India produced 13.8 mt of crude steel in April — up 3.9 per cent year-on-year, while output during the first four months of 2026 rose 9.4 per cent to 58.7 mt.

**INDIA RETAINS 2ND SPOT**

The country remained the second-largest steel producer globally after China and continued to outperform global trends, supported by infrastructure spending and strong manufacturing activity.

The United States posted one of the strongest gains among major producers, with output rising 9.4 per cent to 7.2 mt. Germany and Turkiye also recorded robust growth of 9.5 per cent and 9.4 per cent respectively.

Among the regions, Asia and Oceania, which account for the bulk of global steelmaking, saw production decline by 1.3 per cent to 114.2 mt.

The sharpest contraction came from the Middle East, where output plunged 27.6 per cent to 3.7 mt, amid geopolitical disruptions and weaker demand conditions.

Production in Russia and other CIS countries, including Ukraine, fell 13.4 per cent year-on-year to 6 mt in April, while North America bucked the global trend with a 6.9 per cent increase to 9.4 mt.

For the January-April period, global crude steel production declined 2 per cent year-on-year to 613.3 mt, indicating continued pressure on the industry from uneven demand recovery and geopolitical uncertainties.

## QUICKLY.

### Centre clears ₹9,968 cr to Telangana for rural infra

**Hyderabad:** Telangana has been allocated ₹9,968 crore as part of the 16th Finance Commission grant to States for developing infrastructure in local bodies, including panchayats and zilla parishads. The Centre has also released guidelines on the utilisation of funds in the provision of drinking water, sanitation, streetlights and rural roads. The funds should not be utilised for payment of salaries, pension and wages, the Centre said. OUR BUREAU

### IIT-Madras unveils maritime research facility

**Chennai:** The Indian Institute of Technology, Madras, launched the 'Circulating Water Tunnel Facility', an advanced hydrodynamic testing facility, on Monday with CSR funding of ₹4.5 crore from Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Ltd. The advanced ocean engineering research facility was inaugurated last Wednesday at IIT-Madras' satellite campus in Thaiyur, near Chennai. OUR BUREAU

# Govt worried as States impose curbs on subsidised fertilizer retailers' biz

**THE IMPACT.** Move hits market availability of key non-subsidised nutrient inputs, leads to overuse of chemicals

**Our Bureau**
New Delhi

The Centre is considering ways to mitigate the impact of some States banning sales of non-subsidised fertilizers by the retailers of subsidised fertilizers — urea, DAP, MOP and complex. The Centre is worried that a drop in availability of non-subsidised nutrient inputs may push up sales of chemical products, which it wants to reduce.

The State governments are targeting "tagging," by fertilizer retailers — a practice where retailers force farmers to buy premium biological products alongside subsidised, essential inputs such as urea and DAP.

"It is wrong to put a ban on all non-chemical inputs as a fertilizer company cannot create a separate distribution network overnight. Tagging is bad, but this kind of ban is not the solution.

**MARKET RESTRICTION.** To eliminate "tagging," several States have simply prohibited these outlets from stocking non-chemical alternatives altogether

States could have prohibited sales of some other products like pesticides by these outlets," said an official source.

However, the Centre fears this blunt regulatory fix will backfire by inadvertently cutting off supply of non-subsidised nutrients, because major crop-nutrition companies rely on their existing dealer networks.

By creating a sudden scarcity of green alternatives, the ban will force farmers to rely heavily on chemicals, directly undermining the Centre's mandate to slash its massive fertilizer subsidy bill and alter the core vision of Pradhan Mantri Kisan Samriddhi Kendras, as comprehensive, one-stop agri-input hubs. With over 2,00,000 centres of PMKSK already established by companies across rural India since its launch in 2022, the objective of the government was to convert existing fertilizer retail shop into "One-Stop Shop" for farmers.

However, after Uttar Pradesh issued an order in January 2026, prohibiting sales of other products by retailers of subsidised fertilizers, Maharashtra and Madhya Pradesh, too, have issued similar orders. State officials defended the move, saying forced tagging of products with urea, DAP, MOP and complex was a major concern and hundreds of complaints were received from farmers.

**ROOT CAUSE**

Industry leaders attribute the source of the problem to the Centre's policy on capping profit margin not only of companies, but also of dealers. "It is impossible to run a shop profitably with only 2 per cent margin if retailers are asked to sell only subsidised products," an industry leader said.

In a different context, NITI Aayog Member KV Raju on Monday pointed out that distribution is a key challenge in the adoption of non-chemical crop inputs.

"But how much is available, how much we can do in this year? How to enable more production of these alternative sources? How to build the network of distribution," he asked, referring to the challenges India is facing in the highly import-dependent fertilizer sector.

The Fertilizer Association of India (FAI) has requested the States to reconsider the ban order as the sowing season starts from June 1.

It said that the order, though intended to curb "tagging", had hit the use of non-subsidised fertilizers, such as micronutrients, bio-fertilizers, water-soluble fertilizers and specialty products considered essential for balanced crop nutrition, the FAI said.

# PE, VC investments halve to $2.7 billion in April

**Our Bureau**
Mumbai

Private equity and venture capital (PE/VC) investments in India fell to about $2.7 billion across 97 deals in April 2026, halving both year-on-year and sequentially, as a slowdown in large-ticket transactions weighed on investor activity, according to the latest report by EY India and IVCA.

Infrastructure and real estate investments together stood at $699 million across six deals in April, down sharply from $2.37 billion across 11 deals in March 2026 and about $1 billion across 20 deals in April 2025.

Real estate accounted for $633 million of the April investments, while infrastructure contributed $230 million. Among the largest deals during the month was ICICI Prudential Alternative Investments' $283 million buyout of RMZ office assets in Bengaluru and Pune — Eco-World 21 and RMZ Edge.

Another major transaction was 360 One's $157 million investment in International Tech Park Chennai.

**INFRA, A DRAW**

Despite the broader weakness in the market, infrastructure continued to remain a key support for overall PE/VC activity in balancing volatility.

"Since 2021, the infrastructure sector has been the largest sector for PE/VC investments, with $54.2 billion invested across 435 deals," the report said.

Renewables and roads and highways remained the most attractive infrastructure segments, cumulatively accounting for 57 per cent of overall infrastructure investments since 2021, with investments of $20.8 billion and $10.3 billion, respectively. Renewables also led by deal count with 172 transactions during the period.

Large deals continued to dominate infrastructure investments. "The sector saw a significant increase in large deals and recorded $46.8 billion across 117 large deals — 86 per cent of overall investments within the sector in value terms since 2021," the report said.

**EXITS STABLE**

Exit activity, however, moderated during the month. PE/VC exits totalled $730 million across 15 deals in April 2026, compared with $2.5 billion across 17 exits in March 2026, though they were slightly higher than $619 million across 16 exits in April 2025.

Secondary exits accounted for the largest share of exits at $430 million across four deals, contributing 59 per cent of total exit value.

The largest exit during the month was CapitaLand's sale of its stake in International Tech Park Chennai for $326 million to Mindspace Business Parks REIT and 360 One. Fundraising activity also weakened sharply during the month, with total PE/VC fundraises falling to $646 million across six funds, down 62 per cent from $1.7 billion raised in March 2026 and 41 per cent lower than April 2025 levels. The report said this was the lowest monthly fundraising figure since December 2024.

The largest fundraise of the month was Circulate Capital's $220 million first close for its Asia II Fund, which will be used to scale circular supply chains and recycling businesses across South and Southeast Asia.

# Kashmir's first cherry parcel train of the season leaves for Mumbai

**Gulzar Bhat**
Srinagar

The season's first cherry parcel train pulled out from Jammu railway station for Mumbai on Monday, offering Kashmir's growers a faster route to markets across India for the highly perishable fruit.

The consignment, carrying around 12 tonnes of freshly picked cherries, was loaded on a parcel van attached to Train No 19028, the Jammu Tawi–Bandra Terminus Vivek Express, and is expected to reach Mumbai in about 33 hours, railway officials said. "Indian Railways is committed to helping orchardists in Jammu and Kashmir secure better prices and access markets nationwide," said Uchit Singhal, Senior Divisional Commercial Manager, Jammu.

**RED HARVEST.** Kashmir accounts for over 90% of India's cherry production, with annual output likely at 12,000-14,000 tonnes

**The Railway authorities plan to transport more than 640 tonnes of cherries to Mumbai during the current season**

He said special logistical arrangements had been made for the movement of cherries and that adequate parcel vans and resources had been earmarked to meet traders' demand during the season.

Kashmir accounts for more than 90 per cent of India's cherry production, with annual output estimated at 12,000-14,000 tonnes. The fruit has a short shelf life, making rapid transportation critical for growers seeking to maximise returns.

The railway authorities plan to transport more than 640 tonnes of cherries to Mumbai during the current season.

**PILOT EFFORT**

The Jammu Division of Northern Railway has earmarked 28 parcel vans for services to Bandra Terminus, each capable of carrying about 23 tonnes.

The initiative builds on last year's pilot effort, when 14 parcel vans carrying cherries were dispatched from Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Katra railway station to Bandra Terminus.

"The cherry parcel train is a welcome step for growers as it will help us send our produce to markets much faster and reduce losses caused by delays on the road," said Abdul Rashid, a grower from Srinagar.

However, he said, "Farmers in different parts of the Valley would benefit even more if direct parcel train services are introduced closer to the production belts."

# 'AP govt will extend loans up to ₹1 crore to entrepreneurs'

**Our Bureau**
Hyderabad

The Andhra Pradesh government will extend loans of up to ₹1 crore to encourage aspiring entrepreneurs as part of initiatives to promote the micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs), Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu said.

He was speaking at the MSME Summit organised by the State government in Vijayawada on Monday after formally laying the foundation stone for 38 MSME Parks across the State as part of a plant to develop 175 MSMEs parks in all mandals of the State.

For balanced regional development, Visakhapatnam is being developed into a global data centre hub, with major industries including steel, aluminium and rare earth minerals expected to strengthen the region's industrial base while Amaravati would emerge as a Quantum Valley with plans to manufacture quantum computing equipment, he said.

**DEFENCE CORRIDOR**

The stretch from Puttaparthi to Bengaluru would evolve into a defence corridor. He announced that a fifth-generation fighter jet testing facility would be established in Rayalaseema soon.

The State government was investing ₹40,000 crore to transform Rayalaseema into a horticulture hub and develop destinations such as the Suryalanka Beach and Gandikota into world-class tourism attractions, Naidu said, adding: "Our government follows the model of signing, grounding and opening industries."

# Karnataka CM to meet with senior Congress leaders in Delhi today

**Our Bureau**
Bengaluru

Karnataka Chief Minister Siddaramaiah will meet with senior Congress leaders, including Rahul Gandhi, AICC President Mallikarjun Kharge and AICC General Secretary KC Venugopal in New Delhi today.

"The meeting is purely political," sources told *businessline*.

The discussions are expected to focus largely on the long-pending Cabinet reshuffle in Karnataka.

The meeting comes three years into the Congress government's five-year term and amid an alleged power tussle between Siddaramaiah and Deputy Chief Minister DK Shivakumar.

Congress general secretary in charge of Karnataka Randeep Singh Surjewala, addressing the media on Monday, said, "I've often said that in our party, the High Command is supreme. Their decision will be made keeping in mind the 2028 elections, and we've said time and time again that all the party leaders are united."

According to a report in *The Hindu*, the Chief Minister received a late-evening call on May 24 to meet the Congress high command.

The development came after he sought a meeting with Rahul Gandhi during the swearing-in ceremony of Kerala Chief Minister VD Satheesan.

The report noted that Siddaramaiah had been advocating a Cabinet reshuffle for the past six months, a move widely seen as an attempt to strengthen his position. Over a dozen Ministers could be dropped citing performance, caste balance and regional representation, which are expected to influence the exercise.

**RUMBLINGS WITHIN**

When asked recently in Chamarajanagar about his prospects of becoming Chief Minister, Shivakumar said that only "time and *muhurta*" would provide the answer.

Pressure for a Cabinet reshuffle has been mounting from within the party. Several MLAs and Ministers have publicly and privately sought changes in the Ministry, with some even setting deadlines for the exercise.

Earlier this year, a group of first-time Congress legislators reportedly wrote to Gandhi and Kharge seeking representation in the State Cabinet ahead of a possible reshuffle.

# TN govt waives co-op crop loans

**Our Bureau**
Chennai

The Tamil Nadu government on Monday announced a full waiver of cooperative bank crop loans up to ₹50,000 for marginal farmers and up to ₹5,000 for large farmers, according to a release.

Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay announced this after a review meeting held at the Secretariat regarding the waiver of crop loans for farmers.

The crop loan waiver will benefit 14.22 lakh borrowers who took crop loans from cooperative banks between May 1, 2025, and February 28, 2026. It will enable the farmers to access new loans for the coming season.

The scheme will entail an additional expenditure of ₹2,044 crore for the Tamil Nadu government.

# 'DP World's Mundra terminal may give a $9.2 b boost to the GDP by 2035'

**Our Bureau**
Mumbai

A study by Oxford Economics estimates that DP World's container terminal at Mundra could boost India's GDP by $9.2 billion by 2035, the port operator said in a release on Monday.

Commissioned in 2003 as India's first greenfield container terminal within a non-major port, it has handled more than 19 million containers till date. "Today, the Mundra International Container Terminal connects India with 73 global ports and handles ultra large containers vessels supported by multimodal rail connectivity across Gujarat, Rajasthan, Haryana, Punjab and Delhi. This has enhanced supply chain efficiency, enabling Indian businesses to compete more effectively in global markets," DP World said.

While the terminal contributed $128.9 million to India's GDP in 2024, enhanced shipping connectivity is estimated to drive an additional $6.4 billion in exports and $9.2 billion GDP impact by 2035.

"When infrastructure is built for scale, efficiency and connectivity, it becomes a powerful driver of both economic growth and social progress. At DP World Mundra, we are enabling faster, more reliable trade while creating better jobs, building skills and expanding opportunities for businesses and communities," said Hemant Kumar Ruia, DP World's Country Manager (India).

# TenderCuts eyes retail stores expansion to drive growth, boost online sales

**Rohan Das**
Chennai

Chennai-based omnichannel meat and seafood brand TenderCuts will anchor its growth around physical retail stores, according to Sasikumar Kallanai, Co-Founder and CEO, TenderCuts.

Speaking to *businessline*, Kallanai said that the company plans to expand its store footprint to about 50 from 18 in the next 12-18 months.

The expansion will be restricted to Chennai as the brand seeks to densify demand in a stronger market and target specific micro markets in the city rather than venture into new markets.

"Over the past few years, we have positioned ourselves as a offline retail-first omnichannel brand. This is not a category where the usual D2C growth and expansion-at-all-cost mindset works. Consumers are value conscious which means your model in turn must be capital efficient," he said.

Sasikumar Kallanai, Co-Founder and CEO, TenderCut

**ATTRACT CUSTOMERS**

Kallanai believes that going forward physical stores will be the main customer acquisition engine, where new customers can experience the product and touch and feel the brand's offerings.

Subsequently, online can become the demand centre, where acquired customers can repeat purchases.

TenderCuts posted revenues of ₹70 crore in FY26, and Kallanai expects the company to grow by 100 per cent for the current fiscal.

He added that currently TenderCuts's revenue mix included 60 per cent online and 40 per cent physical stores but the company intends to split it evenly in the next few quarters.

"Value added products like ready to eat convenience foods are seeing strong growth as well. These products currently contribute around 10 per cent of sales, and we expect it to grow 20 per cent over the next 12–18 months," he said.

As for expansion to other southern cities, Kallanai said that the company sees Bengaluru and Hyderabad as other high potential markets.

# Three AIADMK MLAs resign, join TVK

**Our Bureau**
Chennai

In a boost to the ruling Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) in Tamil Nadu, three MLAs from the AIADMK resigned on Monday and joined the TVK.

The legislators — Maragatham Kumaravel (Madurantakam constituency), Jayakumar (Perundurai) and Sathyabama (Dharapuram) — met Assembly Speaker JCD Prabhakar and submitted their resignation letters.

Soon after, the three met senior TVK leader Aadhav Arjuna and formally joined the party.

The resignations will trigger byelections in the three constituencies along with Tiruchirapalli (East), where too Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay had also contested from Perambur, which he retained.

With inputs from intern Mahalakshmi

# West Asia crisis, Strait of Hormuz lockdown boost Cochin Port's bunkering business

**V Sajeev Kumar**
Kochi

The ongoing West Asian crisis and the resulting disruption in shipping activity through the Strait of Hormuz are opening up new business opportunities for the Cochin Port and Colombo in the bunkering segment.

Data from Cochin Port show that bunker fuel supply rose to 4.63 lakh tonnes in FY26, up from 3.54 lakh tonnes in FY25.

Monthly volumes also recorded a notable increase, touching 41,000 tonnes in February, 51,000 tonnes in March and 34,000 tonnes in April, compared with an average of around 30,000 tonnes during the same period last year.

Kochi has emerged as a leading bunkering hub in South Asia due to its proximity to the busy East-West international shipping route.

The port offers competitive fuel pricing, simplified customs procedures and relatively lower taxes, making it attractive to global shipping operators.

**EXPLORING OPTIONS**

Bunkering and allied services involve supplying ships with marine fuel, lubricants and essential provisions, such as food and fresh water.

Industry sources pointed out that the Port of Fujairah in the Gulf was traditionally a preferred global bunkering destination.

However, tensions in West Asia and the blockade of the Strait of Hormuz have forced shipping companies to look for alternative refuelling locations, benefiting Kochi and Colombo.

Public sector oil marketing companies operating in Kochi have reportedly gained substantial bunker business during the first quarter of the current fiscal, particularly during February and March when regional tensions were at the peak. Demand has since moderated as the situation stabilised.

At present, Cochin Port can handle two-three vessels per day for bunkering operations at outer anchorage. Any additional demand may result in ships waiting offshore. The port mainly supplies VLSFO, HSFO (fuel oil) and LSHFHSD (diesel), the sources said. While Colombo remains a competitor because of the availability of bunkers, the monsoon season could tilt the balance in Kochi's favour.

Sources said that Colombo faces operational limitations due to an insufficient number of barges during rough weather conditions. In contrast, Kochi has three river sea vessel barges capable of operating even in monsoon weather, providing the port with a strategic advantage.

CHENNAI
businessline.
TUESDAY - MAY 26 - 2026

## QUICKLY.

**Air India Express damages runway lights in Muscat**

**Mumbai:** An Air India Express aircraft has been grounded in Muscat for the past 10 days after it damaged runway edge lights during its takeoff roll. The Oman Transport Safety Bureau is investigating the incident involving the Boeing 737 aircraft. According to the Aviation Safety Network website, the incident took place on the night of May 15, when a Kannur-bound Air India Express aircraft incorrectly lined up for takeoff. The pilots commenced the takeoff roll and destroyed a number of edge lights in the process. "Following a loud bang and a master caution indication, the crew rejected takeoff and stopped on the runway. The aircraft became disabled with a hydraulic leak from the system and a flat tyre. Passengers and crew disembarked onto the runway," said the website. Air India Express said it is engaging with OTSB in investigating the incident. ANEESH PHADNIS

# Pronto's use of wearable cameras in home services raises privacy issues

**UNDER THE LENS.** Artificial intelligence-linked recordings by the start-up draw attention of MeitY

**Jyoti Banthia**
Bengaluru

The controversy around AI-linked recordings by home-services start-up Pronto has snowballed into a larger debate over how India's fast-growing consumer internet sector is handling data generated inside private homes, particularly as companies increasingly experiment with AI systems designed to understand and automate real-world tasks.

**GROWTH STRATEGY.** The company views AI-linked initiatives as a potential long-term business opportunity, said sources

### DATA PROTECTION

The matter has now drawn the attention of the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY), which has taken cognisance of the issue amid growing concerns around how recordings inside homes are governed under India's evolving privacy and data protection framework, according to people aware of the matter.

However, sources close to the development said the company had not received any formal communication from the Ministry so far.

"The company hasn't taken this decision in haste. The decision only involves a very small subset of users and is not targeted at the larger user base. If the Ministry or any other government department would like to take a closer look at the books, the company will be happy to engage," said sources close to the company.

The issue erupted after details emerged around a limited pilot programme involving wearable cameras used during household services such as cleaning and kitchen-related work.

The backlash has since widened into questions around how consumer internet companies and AI firms could eventually use real-world activity data generated inside homes.

People tracking the sector said the controversy reflects a much larger shift underway globally, where AI companies are increasingly seeking access to real-world human activity datasets to train systems capable of understanding physical workflows and repetitive tasks.

For home-services start-ups, activities such as cleaning, utensil washing and kitchen work could eventually help improve worker training, operational efficiency and workflow intelligence.

Industry executives and analysts say recordings from real-world environments are emerging as valuable datasets for future AI systems.

Sources close to the matter said the company views AI-linked initiatives as a potential long-term business opportunity as well.

"Partnerships with global AI labs could eventually open up another stream of revenue, help improve payouts for partners on the platform, and keep pricing competitive," sources added.

### INVESTOR INTEREST

The debate also comes as India's instant home-services sector scales rapidly on the back of rising investor interest and user adoption.

### ACTIVE USERS

Combined monthly active users across platforms such as Urban Company, Pronto and Snabbit crossed 10 million earlier this year, according to industry estimates.

Pronto and Snabbit also raised fresh capital in recent months to expand their rapid home-services offerings.

Yet, policy experts and industry observers say India's existing privacy architecture remains ill-equipped to govern how AI-linked recordings inside homes are ultimately stored, reused or processed. Even where companies claim recordings are temporary, optional or deleted after a fixed period, consumers currently have little independent visibility into how such safeguards are enforced in practice or whether portions of that data continue to inform AI systems after deletion.

## 'Still-evolving data protection framework leaves grey areas around consent and privacy'

**Meenakshi Verma Ambwani**
New Delhi

Legal and policy loopholes in the use of human-generated data for AI training are increasingly being exploited by companies, with experts warning that India's still-evolving data protection framework has left grey areas around consent, privacy and the commercial use of recordings captured inside homes and workplaces.

The latest controversy surrounding domestic services start-up Pronto's use of in-home recordings for AI training has brought the issue into sharp focus, but the practice itself is part of a much wider trend, in which companies have begun collecting first-person human activity data to train robotics and embodied AI systems.

### DATA PROTECTION ACT

Pronto claimed that its pilot reaches 0.1 per cent of its customers and is in compliance with the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023. Meanwhile, the backlash has prompted other players such as Urban Company and Snabbit to publicly distance themselves from any similar practices.

A spokesperson for Snabbit said: "Any technology innovation in this space must be aligned with strong governance standards and the trust expectations of Indian consumers and workers. Snabbit's position is clear that customer trust and privacy come first, and we would not pursue any technology or process that compromises those principles."

Experts said the issue exposes a major regulatory vacuum. Sonam Chandwani, Managing Partner, KS Legal, said: "Indian law presently does not contain a dedicated regulatory framework specifically governing AI training through domestic recordings, which is why the issue is being viewed as a grey area. However, the absence of a direct prohibition does not imply unrestricted legality. Companies engaging in such practices would still be required to satisfy existing standards relating to consent, transparency, lawful purpose, proportionality, storage limitation and data security under Indian privacy and consumer law frameworks."

### LEGAL AMBIGUITY

She pointed out that the principal legislation governing the area is the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023. "The legal issue is not merely whether a consumer clicked agree on an application, but whether the consumer was adequately informed that recordings from inside their home may be captured, stored, analysed or used for AI model development. The expectation of privacy inside a home is substantially greater, and any collection or commercial exploitation of such data would require a correspondingly higher level of disclosure, necessity and proportionality," Chandwani added.

Tanisha Khanna, Partner, Trace Law Partners, said the current regulatory position leaves substantial room for companies to legally use certain forms of data for AI model training. "India's Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, will be brought into force in May 2027. Till such time as it is notified, there are no enforceable statutory obligations on most personal data collection and processing activities, including at-home recordings," she said.

Khanna added that even after the law comes into effect, its protection may not fully extend to anonymised or non-personal datasets.

# ICMR inks 41 public health tech transfer deals with industry

**PT Jyothi Datta**
Mumbai

Public health technologies from the Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR), covering vaccines, diagnostics and biomedical solutions, have been transferred to industry partners for commercialisation.

### MATERIAL TRANSFER

Of the total 41 deals, 39 involved technology transfers and two material transfer agreements, an ICMR representative told *businessline*.

The 39 deals cover 27 technologies that were formalised with eight companies, and two deals involving biomaterials formalised with one company, according to data available.

The transfer involved early stage technologies, the representative said, that would be further developed, manufactured and commercialised. The technologies included advanced diagnostics, vaccines, medical devices and biomedical solutions addressing critical public health priorities, said a note from the Health Ministry.

Among the technologies transferred were glycoconjugate and recombinant vaccines for typhoid and paratyphoid, as well as diagnostic technologies for diseases such as Japanese Encephalitis, tuberculosis and mpox, the note added.

Marking a first of sorts, the note said: "Well-characterised biomaterials, including inactivated Kyasanur Forest Disease (KFD) and Chandipura viruses were also transferred to industry partners, strengthening India's biomedical research and manufacturing ecosystem."

KFD is an infectious disease in the Western Ghats region in States such as Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Kerala, Goa and Maharashtra, the Health Ministry said earlier this year, adding that ICMR was working on an improved vaccine to tackle the disease. The biomaterial transfer from ICMR's NIV institute for the KF virus isolate and Chandipura virus isolate was to Ubio Biotech.

Other companies that received technologies included GeneBio Healthcare, Vanguard diagnostics, Huwel Lifesciences, Meril Diagnostics, Molbio, Krishgen Pudgala, TechInvention Lifecare and J Mitra & Co.

The health technology that was transferred ranged from a process for differentiating species of Plasmodium to CRISPR-Cas-based TB detection system and RNAi Agent for inhibition of chikungunya virus, among others.

About 100 technologies in diagnostics, therapeutics and medical devices developed by ICMR institutes, researchers and start-ups were showcased at a biomedical and technology transfer facilitation event organised in New Delhi by the ICMR under the Health Ministry's Department of Health Research.

# Torrent Pharma aims to launch liver drug 'resmetirom' in India

**Avinash Nair**
Ahmedabad

After an early lead in semaglutide generics, Torrent Pharmaceuticals is now positioning itself for what could be a more differentiated play — bringing the US-approved liver disease drug 'resmetirom' to India once the patent barriers ease.

Torrent Pharmaceuticals Managing Director Aman Mehta said the Ahmedabad-based company is running a phase-3 clinical trial in India for the drug, which has already been approved in the US under the brand 'Rezdiffra' by Madrigal Pharmaceuticals.

"We are currently conducting a phase-3 clinical trial for resmetirom in India," Mehta told investors.

"Assuming the trial completes successfully within our projected timelines, we may be among the first to launch this in the India market after patent expiry. This is presently projected to be a largely-sized opportunity for us," he added.

> We are currently conducting a phase-3 clinical trial for resmetirom in India
>
> **AMAN MEHTA**
> Managing Director, Torrent Pharmaceuticals

### FATTY LIVER DISEASE

Resmetirom is the first approved therapy in the US specifically for metabolic dysfunction-associated steatohepatitis (MASH), earlier known as NASH — a progressive fatty liver disease linked to obesity, diabetes and poor metabolic health.

Mehta said there is currently no innovative treatment available in India for this condition, suggesting a potential opening for early entrants once regulatory and patent-related constraints ease. While he did not share a definitive launch timeline, he indicated that the entry could be possible within 12-18 months after patent expiry, subject to successful clinical outcomes and approvals.

Alongside its pipeline push, Torrent has also made an early start in the fast-growing semaglutide market with two branded launches — Semalix (oral) and Sembolic (injectable).

Semaglutide has seen rapid generic activity in India, following patent expiry dynamics in key markets.

Mehta said the launch had seen strong initial traction, and helped the company secure a leading position among early generic entrants.

Based on Pharmatrac data for April cited by the company, Torrent held a 38 per cent share among generic players in the semaglutide market, including 28 per cent share in injectables and 100 per cent share in oral formulations at that time.

However, he acknowledged that the competitive landscape is evolving. As of May 21, another competitor has entered the oral segment, which is expected to impact near-term share dynamics.

### EARLY ENTRY

Despite this, Torrent believes its early entry across both dosage formats has helped it build prescription momentum. "Early availability in both oral and injectable formats has given us a strong start," said Mehta, adding that first-mover advantage typically plays a key role in chronic therapy markets where physician adoption builds over time.

## PADMA BHUSHAN FOR KOTAK

**PROUD MOMENT.** President Droupadi Murmu conferring the Padma Bhushan on Kotak Mahindra Bank founder Uday Suresh Kumar Kotak during the civil investiture ceremony at the Rashtrapati Bhavan in New Delhi on Monday PTI

# Corporate India rewrites B-School hiring as variable pay surges to 40%

**Amit Vijay Mohile**
Mumbai

With barely six months left before final placements for the 2026-27 cycle begins, Rishab Sharma, a final-year MBA student at one of India's top business schools, is scrambling to learn supply-chain analytics, procurement operations and artificial intelligence, as corporate India prioritises specialists to manage disruptions triggered by the West Asia crisis.

**WINDS OF CHANGE.** The MBA hiring market is moving from a volume-brand model to a value-skill model

The shift is unfolding even as headline salaries continue to rise across India's top campuses. ISB Hyderabad reported a 11 per cent increase in average compensation this year at ₹37.29 lakh, while SPJIMR placed its largest-ever batch of 356 students at an average package of ₹33.75 lakh.

But recruiters said the structure of those salaries is changing sharply beneath the surface. Variable pay, which accounted for roughly 15-20 per cent of compensation packages until recently, has now climbed to as much as 40 per cent in several sectors, as companies grapple with fuel-price uncertainty, inflationary pressures and slowing demand visibility.

### SPECIALIST MBA

For nearly two decades, the promise of India's elite MBA system rested on a simple formula: A top campus degree and a broad-based management profile were often enough to secure a high-paying corporate role.

Recruiters said that model is now changing as companies shift focus from expansion-led hiring to execution, operational stability and measurable business outcomes.

Nikhil Barshikar, Founder and CEO of Imarticus Learning, said firms are increasingly prioritising professionals capable of converting macroeconomic disruptions into operational strategy.

"A supply-chain manager who can immediately translate geopolitical disruptions into procurement strategy or a finance professional who understands AI-driven risk modelling... those are the people companies are paying a premium for," he said.

Munira Loliwala, a senior HR industry specialist working across B-school and CXO hiring, said companies are becoming more cautious about fixed compensation and linking payouts closely to measurable outcomes.

"The MBA hiring market is moving from a volume-brand model to a value-skill model," she said. "Companies are paying disproportionately for people who can directly improve cost structures, productivity and business resilience."

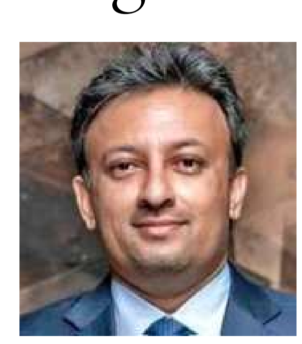
Umesh Kothari, Assistant Dean at the SP Jain School of Global Management, said the MBA ecosystem is evolving into a more skills-driven landscape.

"The future MBA leader will not just manage businesses; he will lead transformation. They will be specialists in navigating uncertainty, scaling innovation and building resilient organisations in a rapidly evolving global economy," he said.

# 'We are the largest Indian oncology player'

**Avinash Nair**
Ahmedabad

Rising cases of cancer in India are reshaping the demand for oncology drugs, and Zydus Lifesciences says it has emerged as the country's largest oncology player, built on a fast-expanding portfolio of biologics and oral cancer therapies. Now, it is mounting an aggressive push into US specialty cancer care.



Sharvil Patel, MD, Zydus Lifesciences

"The growth has been there in the oncology market with more government schemes getting implemented. We are seeing a higher incidence of cancers," said Managing Director Sharvil Patel.

### PATIENT SUPPORT

The company said its oncology business had scaled rapidly in recent years, supported by early entry into complex biologics and targeted therapies, along with structured patient support programmes that had improved access across treatment lines.

"So, we have been able to serve a significant number of patients, and with strong medical and patient support programmes, we are seeing very strong traction for our brands, which has led to better growth. Now we are the largest Indian oncology player in the market," Patel told investors recently.

### ONCOLOGY PORTFOLIO

Zydus' India oncology portfolio spans biologic therapies such as 'Pertuzumab' and 'Nivolumab', along with a growing base of oral cancer medicines, including 'Abiraterone', 'Dasatinib', 'Imatinib', 'Lenalidomide' and 'Niraparib'.

The portfolio covers both solid tumours and blood cancers, reflecting the company's push across multiple oncology segments, rather than a single therapy area.

The scale built in India is now being used as a base for Zydus' broader global specialty ambitions, particularly in the US, where the company already has a strong generics footprint.

### TOP PLAYERS

In the US, Zydus ranks among the top three generic players, supported by a diversified portfolio developed through in-house capabilities as well as partnerships.

"In the US market, we are ranked among the top three in the generic space, backed by a rich and differentiated product portfolio built in house and through partnerships," said Patel.

The company is now using this platform to expand into specialty pharmaceuticals, with a focus on rare diseases, biosimilars and biologics manufacturing capabilities.

"As we pivot towards specialty, we are driving growth through multiple levers. Sentynl pediatrics rare disease portfolio is broadening access to innovative therapies. In biosimilars, we have in-licensed two large molecules and strengthened capabilities with newly acquired US manufacturing facilities. We shall maximise the utilisation of these facilities through continued bought out supply and onboarding of new partners. Together, these initiatives position us strongly to accelerate in the specialty play," said Patel.

### BEYOND GENERICS

A key part of this strategy is Sentynl Therapeutics, which strengthens Zydus' presence in rare diseases and pediatric therapies in the US, adding a dedicated specialty channel beyond generics.

Alongside this, the company is expanding its biosimilars pipeline through in-licensed large molecules and strengthening manufacturing capabilities in the US to support both internal production and third-party partnerships.

In June 2025, Zydus also announced its entry into the global biologics contract development and manufacturing organisation space through the acquisition of Agenus Inc's biologics manufacturing facility in California.

For BSE/NSE live quotes, scan the QR code or click the link https://bit.ly/2FpossK

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| Company | Prev | Close | Open | High | Low | Qty | 52 WH | 52 WL | PE | BSE Cl |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Anlon Health | 13.91 | 13.78 | 13.99 | 14.19 | 13.70 | 869.18 | 172.75 | 12.91 | - | - |
| AntelopusSel | 695.60 | 730.35 | 695.95 | 730.35 | 677.00 | 235.86 | 789.90 | 357.00 | - | - |
| AnthemBiosci | 777.10 | 765.35 | 777.10 | 786.40 | 761.25 | 393.83 | 873.50 | 579.15 | - | - |
| Antony W Hdg | 466.25 | 473.45 | 473.95 | 483.95 | 470.05 | 72.09 | 693.00 | 372.50 | - | - |
| Anup Engg | 1977.60 | 1977.70 | 1970.10 | 2048.60 | 1965.60 | 26.72 | 2954.90 | 1422.30 | - | - |
| Anupam Ras. | 1366.10 | 1371.10 | 1390.00 | 1390.00 | 1341.30 | 490.98 | 1415.00 | 946.30 | - | - |
| Apar Ind | 12782.00 | 12480.00 | 12832.00 | 13079.00 | 12412.00 | 93.23 | 13144.75 | 6800.00 | 51 | 12485.65 |
| Apcotex Ind [2] | 496.80 | 494.90 | 506.25 | 533.90 | 486.05 | 257.01 | 559.65 | 310.15 | 26 | 494.35 |
| Apex | 448.95 | 461.90 | 457.50 | 473.90 | 453.55 | 687.79 | 514.20 | 202.90 | 46 | 461.85 |
| APL Apollo [2] | 1880.50 | 1898.60 | 1900.00 | 1908.90 | 1875.00 | 622.45 | 2300.90 | 1493.00 | 96 | 1898.70 |
| APOLLO [1] | 355.05 | 408.20 | 360.00 | 419.80 | 360.00 | 89965.10 | 420.00 | 136.70 | 121 | 410.80 |
| Apollo Hosp. [5] | 8362.50 | 8404.00 | 8430.00 | 8443.00 | 8375.00 | 364.95 | 8490.30 | 6680.00 | 80 | 8404.85 |
| Apollo Pipes | 516.35 | 521.20 | 525.65 | 530.00 | 515.05 | 230.84 | 554.00 | 252.10 | - | - |
| Apollo Tyres [1] | 371.80 | 388.35 | 376.00 | 392.90 | 375.00 | 3668.82 | 540.30 | 365.35 | 13 | 388.40 |
| Aptech Ltd | 96.22 | 112.00 | 97.20 | 115.46 | 97.20 | 9826.90 | 172.00 | 69.50 | 30 | 112.10 |
| Aptus V Hsg | 260.35 | 262.55 | 261.75 | 267.40 | 261.75 | 525.43 | 364.00 | 193.03 | - | - |
| Aqylon Nexus | 59.48 | 62.29 | 60.60 | 62.45 | 58.82 | 3902.02 | 2247.00 | 39.26 | - | - |
| Archean Chem | 534.90 | 544.75 | 535.00 | 548.40 | 530.20 | 164.60 | 727.60 | 483.00 | - | - |
| Arfin IndiaL | 94.65 | 96.38 | 94.51 | 97.80 | 93.72 | 2704.60 | 106.20 | 31.43 | - | - |
| Arih Super | 242.65 | 243.35 | 243.45 | 253.80 | 240.55 | 49.82 | 468.15 | 188.50 | - | 242.50 |
| Arisinfra So | 119.29 | 123.61 | 121.80 | 127.54 | 119.50 | 4048.38 | 208.50 | 82.18 | - | - |
| Arkade Dev | 113.16 | 119.07 | 114.35 | 119.80 | 114.35 | 245.52 | 213.69 | 92.62 | - | - |
| Arman Fin | 1705.80 | 1717.40 | 1710.00 | 1799.00 | 1704.10 | 53.52 | 1903.15 | 1256.10 | 42 | 1718.05 |
| Arrow green | 477.25 | 456.15 | 460.15 | 477.00 | 430.55 | 166.53 | 816.15 | 342.00 | 16 | 457.90 |
| Artemis Med | 273.03 | 287.92 | 284.65 | 292.00 | 280.12 | 381.12 | 297.50 | 203.35 | - | - |
| Arvind Fash [4] | 451.00 | 465.60 | 451.00 | 471.00 | 448.80 | 311.99 | 579.05 | 366.60 | - | 465.25 |
| Arvind Ltd | 480.35 | 482.25 | 485.00 | 489.00 | 480.10 | 261.35 | 498.20 | 275.00 | 45 | 482.00 |
| ArvindSmart | 618.50 | 608.90 | 620.00 | 625.10 | 606.00 | 42.64 | 756.00 | 490.35 | 61 | 608.55 |
| Asahi Ind. [1] | 856.05 | 853.05 | 856.05 | 866.00 | 850.20 | 43.58 | 1072.95 | 689.80 | 72 | 853.20 |
| Ashapura [2] | 675.35 | 677.10 | 680.00 | 686.75 | 667.10 | 599.50 | 924.70 | 360.25 | 48 | 677.90 |
| Ashiana ho [2] | 373.05 | 379.80 | 373.50 | 382.00 | 372.55 | 65.56 | 389.00 | 250.60 | 31 | 378.45 |
| ASHIKA CREDIT | 372.80 | 363.00 | 374.20 | 375.00 | 361.00 | 159.92 | 410.95 | 353.70 | - | - |
| Ashok Ley [1] | 158.21 | 164.08 | 160.10 | 165.80 | 160.10 | 30680.95 | 215.35 | 115.00 | 26 | 164.05 |
| Ashoka [5] | 123.44 | 123.27 | 124.19 | 125.40 | 122.96 | 1287.22 | 230.70 | 101.00 | 17 | 123.40 |
| Asian Energy | 370.15 | 358.25 | 375.00 | 376.80 | 352.10 | 579.89 | 391.65 | 230.00 | - | - |
| Asian granit | 62.33 | 62.61 | 62.33 | 64.64 | 62.33 | 2921.88 | 79.08 | 49.11 | - | 62.92 |
| Asian Paints [1] | 2639.80 | 2657.80 | 2672.00 | 2684.10 | 2653.20 | 815.62 | 2985.50 | 2116.00 | 63 | 2656.40 |
| ASK Auto. | 455.30 | 452.20 | 457.95 | 460.00 | 451.30 | 71.63 | 578.50 | 375.30 | - | - |
| Asso Alcohol | 801.45 | 887.60 | 807.10 | 896.35 | 807.10 | 225.26 | 1277.00 | 660.65 | - | - |
| ASTECFE | 771.80 | 752.90 | 775.00 | 775.35 | 750.00 | 37.11 | 990.87 | 512.35 | - | 755.85 |
| ASTERDM | 756.60 | 746.90 | 767.60 | 767.60 | 742.00 | 414.42 | 776.15 | 519.80 | 118 | 746.15 |
| Astra Micro [2] | 1174.90 | 1235.60 | 1190.00 | 1254.00 | 1187.20 | 1924.07 | 1254.50 | 835.90 | 80 | 1237.10 |
| Astral Poly [1] | 1541.70 | 1552.30 | 1566.00 | 1566.60 | 1540.50 | 434.84 | 1767.95 | 1262.75 | 67 | 1552.50 |
| Astrazeneca [2] | 8587.50 | 8800.00 | 8609.00 | 8895.00 | 8554.00 | 9.29 | 10653.05 | 7630.00 | 106 | 8795.40 |
| Atal RealTe | 29.50 | 29.99 | 29.71 | 30.10 | 29.21 | 6392.91 | 30.10 | 14.66 | - | - |
| AtherEnergy | 883.80 | 921.40 | 891.65 | 925.00 | 876.45 | 3724.91 | 989.40 | 301.00 | - | - |
| Atlanta Elec | 1668.80 | 1703.80 | 1676.10 | 1752.20 | 1676.10 | 184.89 | 1901.80 | 707.60 | - | - |
| ATUL AUTO [5] | 485.05 | 490.05 | 485.05 | 495.65 | 485.05 | 123.05 | 554.20 | 381.00 | 25 | 489.95 |
| ATUL. | 7034.50 | 7039.50 | 7099.00 | 7099.00 | 7000.00 | 14.18 | 7793.00 | 5563.00 | 35 | 7020.05 |
| AU SFB | 977.90 | 999.30 | 987.00 | 1007.50 | 986.10 | 1494.10 | 1079.65 | 682.50 | 28 | 998.85 |
| Auri GrowInd | 0.31 | 0.31 | 0.31 | 0.32 | 0.31 | 8697.08 | 1.00 | 0.20 | - | - |
| Aurionpro So | 819.00 | 822.95 | 820.20 | 838.00 | 819.00 | 124.62 | 1663.15 | 720.10 | 41 | 824.35 |
| Aurob Ph [1] | 1463.50 | 1454.60 | 1455.20 | 1465.00 | 1428.00 | 2684.47 | 1550.00 | 1017.00 | 35 | 1453.45 |
| Aurum Prop | 179.49 | 178.31 | 180.88 | 181.90 | 176.53 | 123.81 | 225.70 | 151.90 | - | - |
| Authum Inv | 510.75 | 502.85 | 515.00 | 520.85 | 493.00 | 359.18 | 3318.70 | 400.00 | - | - |
| AUTOMOTIVE S | 493.60 | 513.70 | 496.70 | 516.80 | 496.05 | 32.01 | 656.50 | 377.10 | 28 | 511.60 |
| Avalon Tech | 1473.00 | 1511.20 | 1480.00 | 1534.70 | 1465.10 | 602.73 | 1534.70 | 777.30 | - | - |
| Avantel | 162.27 | 171.70 | 164.50 | 172.70 | 163.10 | 5340.52 | 215.00 | 117.05 | - | - |
| Avanti Feeds [1] | 1306.80 | 1346.70 | 1322.10 | 1373.00 | 1321.80 | 563.66 | 1592.30 | 614.05 | 32 | 1346.35 |
| AvenueSai | 13.84 | 13.97 | 14.00 | 14.23 | 13.87 | 8601.49 | 23.64 | 12.92 | - | - |
| Avro India | 10.37 | 11.39 | 10.60 | 11.40 | 10.12 | 754.46 | 202.00 | 10.00 | - | - |
| Awfis Space | 343.55 | 360.60 | 344.05 | 376.75 | 340.30 | 831.15 | 718.95 | 229.05 | - | - |
| Axis Bank [2] | 1285.40 | 1311.20 | 1300.40 | 1314.50 | 1293.90 | 5671.46 | 1418.30 | 1041.30 | 17 | 1311.70 |
| AXISCADES [5] | 1994.40 | 2045.00 | 2024.10 | 2087.50 | 1989.00 | 129.09 | 2210.00 | 933.00 | 272 | 2044.85 |
| Axita Cott. | 7.76 | 7.80 | 7.76 | 7.85 | 7.71 | 227.95 | 13.42 | 7.70 | - | - |
| Aye Finance | 140.43 | 145.26 | 145.00 | 149.45 | 142.30 | 2261.88 | 161.50 | 142.65 | - | 145.15 |
| Azad Engg | 2039.60 | 2040.70 | 2049.90 | 2104.70 | 2026.20 | 288.93 | 2350.00 | 1360.00 | - | - |
| **B** | | | | | | | | | | |
| BAJAJ AUTO | 10549.50 | 10491.00 | 10700.00 | 10770.00 | 10431.00 | 564.52 | 10799.25 | 7879.45 | 30 | 10491.30 |
| Bajaj Cons [1] | 571.75 | 561.80 | 578.00 | 581.00 | 545.05 | 1042.90 | 581.20 | 168.35 | 38 | 562.85 |
| Bajaj Elect [2] | 336.05 | 338.10 | 340.45 | 340.45 | 334.80 | 183.11 | 710.00 | 332.95 | - | 338.20 |
| Bajaj Fin [1] | 916.55 | 941.90 | 926.10 | 944.00 | 924.45 | 7065.53 | 1102.45 | 788.40 | 35 | 942.00 |
| Bajaj Finser [1] | 1766.00 | 1807.40 | 1785.00 | 1811.80 | 1783.00 | 456.68 | 2194.65 | 1598.15 | 202 | 1807.20 |
| Bajaj HCare | 305.55 | 302.50 | 305.55 | 310.40 | 301.10 | 87.89 | 608.90 | 272.35 | - | - |
| Bajaj Hindus [1] | 18.53 | 18.54 | 18.67 | 18.75 | 18.41 | 3537.48 | 29.62 | 14.89 | - | 18.50 |
| Bajaj Holdng | 10483.00 | 10642.00 | 10650.00 | 10741.00 | 10535.00 | 33.29 | 14873.20 | 8597.50 | 42 | 10615.65 |
| Bajaj HsgFin | 83.07 | 83.30 | 83.47 | 83.88 | 82.91 | 4474.23 | 128.45 | 72.65 | - | - |
| Bajel Proj. | 180.63 | 181.38 | 182.70 | 183.55 | 180.67 | 154.32 | 263.90 | 135.10 | - | - |
| Balaji Amine [2] | 1822.50 | 1920.90 | 1874.00 | 1956.00 | 1840.60 | 597.02 | 1956.80 | 905.15 | 38 | 1920.25 |
| Balaji Tele. [2] | 91.71 | 94.08 | 92.68 | 96.70 | 92.68 | 286.56 | 139.99 | 70.00 | 19 | 94.18 |
| Balkrish Ind [2] | 2208.30 | 2219.10 | 2229.40 | 2248.90 | 2210.10 | 94.16 | 2800.20 | 2016.00 | 35 | 2216.85 |
| BalmerLawrie | 180.85 | 183.39 | 181.05 | 188.92 | 181.05 | 256.16 | 238.00 | 148.35 | 13 | 183.45 |
| BalramChini [1] | 535.10 | 532.95 | 535.10 | 539.95 | 530.30 | 213.17 | 627.00 | 393.40 | 31 | 532.65 |
| Balu Forge | 475.75 | 466.70 | 477.00 | 484.20 | 462.20 | 727.46 | 784.00 | 341.05 | - | - |
| Banco Prod [2] | 614.70 | 624.75 | 617.95 | 629.75 | 617.95 | 161.92 | 879.60 | 503.00 | 25 | 624.75 |
| Bandhan Bk | 194.61 | 196.97 | 196.51 | 199.58 | 195.20 | 11447.06 | 212.55 | 134.30 | 26 | 196.95 |
| Bank of Maha | 80.04 | 81.17 | 81.00 | 82.20 | 80.71 | 11362.50 | 85.93 | 50.56 | 9 | 81.22 |
| BASF India | 3489.60 | 3515.00 | 3519.90 | 3552.10 | 3500.00 | 18.52 | 5399.90 | 2906.90 | 36 | 3515.95 |
| Bata India [5] | 688.20 | 696.20 | 692.00 | 703.50 | 689.40 | 136.09 | 1300.05 | 605.55 | 47 | 696.20 |
| Bayer Crop | 4382.50 | 4368.80 | 4410.00 | 4445.00 | 4315.30 | 13.51 | 6539.95 | 4276.85 | 29 | 4373.45 |
| BCL Ind. | 34.87 | 35.01 | 35.70 | 37.00 | 32.35 | 2269.57 | 49.30 | 25.53 | - | - |
| BDL [5] | 1312.50 | 1326.10 | 1321.00 | 1331.70 | 1309.00 | 670.81 | 2096.00 | 1090.00 | 84 | 1325.75 |
| BellaCasaFa | 237.45 | 250.70 | 233.00 | 274.95 | 233.00 | 22.74 | 497.35 | 220.25 | - | - |
| Belrise Inds | 216.36 | 210.64 | 216.01 | 217.50 | 204.60 | 12433.78 | 228.80 | 89.15 | - | - |
| BEML [5] | 1830.30 | 1823.80 | 1848.50 | 1879.90 | 1814.60 | 322.16 | 2437.43 | 1361.10 | 59 | 1825.20 |
| BergerPaints [1] | 501.15 | 504.85 | 507.00 | 511.75 | 501.80 | 222.67 | 604.60 | 391.50 | 52 | 506.10 |
| Best Agroli | 17.78 | 18.19 | 18.60 | 18.85 | 17.90 | 971.71 | 533.70 | 12.30 | - | - |
| Cello World | 382.25 | 380.50 | 383.40 | 388.80 | 378.00 | 336.03 | 673.80 | 378.00 | - | - |
| CemIndia Pro | 862.80 | 879.95 | 871.00 | 897.70 | 869.65 | 497.21 | 982.80 | 503.30 | - | - |
| Central Bank | 31.27 | 31.27 | 31.29 | 31.33 | 31.11 | 34693.38 | 41.18 | 31.10 | 6 | 31.29 |
| CENTRAL MINE | 234.17 | 244.66 | 236.93 | 245.70 | 232.52 | 5374.43 | 263.65 | 150.16 | - | - |
| Century Enka | 521.80 | 506.20 | 521.80 | 526.00 | 504.00 | 186.14 | 574.00 | 371.30 | 11 | 507.70 |
| Centuryply [1] | 766.65 | 778.05 | 792.95 | 825.00 | 770.40 | 2169.54 | 856.65 | 618.65 | 61 | 779.10 |
| CERA SANI [5] | 5708.00 | 5729.00 | 5800.50 | 5828.00 | 5702.50 | 7.50 | 7271.40 | 4463.00 | 35 | 5726.80 |
| CESE [1] | 177.22 | 185.59 | 180.00 | 186.49 | 180.00 | 8424.08 | 204.40 | 138.05 | 29 | 185.50 |
| CG Power& [2] | 865.70 | 867.90 | 874.90 | 884.40 | 864.80 | 2222.36 | 887.50 | 525.50 | 102 | 868.15 |
| CGCL [1] | 190.65 | 189.30 | 192.10 | 192.99 | 188.44 | 1679.29 | 213.85 | 150.60 | 22 | 189.55 |
| CHALET | 795.05 | 794.90 | 808.00 | 808.50 | 784.30 | 91.17 | 1080.00 | 690.00 | 26 | 794.65 |
| Chaman Set. | 266.70 | 298.00 | 271.15 | 316.40 | 268.25 | 899.32 | 395.75 | 203.75 | - | - |
| Chambal Fert | 454.70 | 463.45 | 458.00 | 469.50 | 456.10 | 1451.72 | 602.45 | 400.00 | 10 | 463.40 |
| Chemcon Spl | 184.15 | 192.35 | 190.00 | 194.00 | 185.52 | 166.74 | 295.00 | 125.00 | - | - |
| Chempl.San | 237.42 | 243.89 | 243.65 | 246.44 | 237.85 | 291.39 | 477.75 | 211.03 | - | - |
| Choice Intl | 676.75 | 689.30 | 682.85 | 693.40 | 679.50 | 655.68 | 860.50 | 568.70 | - | - |
| CholaFinH [1] | 1598.40 | 1624.70 | 1600.10 | 1664.10 | 1600.10 | 141.91 | 2299.00 | 1305.00 | 433 | 1627.40 |
| CholaIn&Fin [2] | 1539.80 | 1591.00 | 1566.00 | 1600.00 | 1548.50 | 1668.26 | 1831.80 | 1299.80 | 26 | 1590.30 |
| CIE Auto.Ind | 451.15 | 461.45 | 456.00 | 465.00 | 453.95 | 331.78 | 526.00 | 381.10 | - | - |
| Cipla [2] | 1399.20 | 1413.90 | 1406.00 | 1420.00 | 1398.50 | 668.92 | 1672.20 | 1165.55 | 31 | 1413.50 |
| CityUnion [1] | 248.55 | 249.90 | 251.80 | 253.05 | 249.20 | 897.95 | 319.95 | 184.00 | 14 | 249.70 |
| Clean Max En | 1120.00 | 1095.50 | 1143.50 | 1145.20 | 1091.00 | 141.12 | 1398.60 | 727.10 | - | - |
| Clean S Tech | 756.70 | 745.45 | 759.00 | 763.85 | 743.00 | 303.49 | 1600.00 | 652.00 | - | - |
| CMS Info Sys | 306.40 | 310.55 | 308.90 | 314.00 | 305.00 | 429.56 | 541.15 | 261.90 | - | - |
| COAL INDIA | 456.55 | 458.00 | 460.00 | 462.55 | 456.00 | 8441.22 | 490.90 | 368.55 | 15 | 458.00 |
| CochinShip [5] | 1532.10 | 1529.00 | 1539.70 | 1557.00 | 1523.90 | 740.06 | 2547.25 | 1186.55 | 63 | 1528.65 |
| CoffeeDayEnt | 24.50 | 25.25 | 24.87 | 25.50 | 24.42 | 1191.96 | 51.49 | 21.05 | - | 25.23 |
| Coforge | 1387.10 | 1398.00 | 1398.00 | 1415.20 | 1376.60 | 1369.56 | 8699.00 | 1008.10 | - | - |
| CohanceLifeS | 418.55 | 434.85 | 422.00 | 440.00 | 422.00 | 1431.26 | 1121.15 | 266.70 | - | - |
| COLGATE PA [1] | 2156.90 | 2097.00 | 2185.70 | 2195.70 | 2080.60 | 1433.77 | 2519.35 | 1781.60 | 42 | 2095.80 |
| COMFORT I | 6.66 | 6.48 | 6.66 | 6.99 | 6.40 | 549.93 | 9.19 | 6.40 | - | - |
| Concord Bio | 1153.30 | 1131.90 | 1176.40 | 1180.00 | 1130.00 | 104.88 | 2150.40 | 987.00 | - | - |
| Concord Env | 273.10 | 280.50 | 273.10 | 294.95 | 272.00 | 131.99 | 659.90 | 235.00 | - | - |
| CONFI P [1] | 57.51 | 61.22 | 57.78 | 61.99 | 56.76 | 2945.45 | 67.02 | 27.00 | 25 | 61.29 |
| Container [5] | 505.90 | 512.05 | 509.00 | 513.50 | 506.90 | 720.29 | 652.52 | 421.80 | 31 | 512.30 |
| Control Pri | 617.35 | 622.50 | 628.00 | 652.15 | 619.70 | 42.59 | 918.55 | 517.50 | 13 | 621.65 |
| CORDS CABLE | 196.34 | 235.60 | 199.82 | 235.60 | 197.41 | 739.37 | 235.80 | 126.45 | 18 | 235.80 |
| Coromandl [1] | 1819.40 | 1841.50 | 1825.20 | 1854.10 | 1817.60 | 468.48 | 2720.00 | 1786.00 | 26 | 1842.45 |
| Corona Remed | 1684.60 | 1701.20 | 1718.00 | 1719.90 | 1681.00 | 40.73 | 1949.40 | 1336.60 | - | - |
| Cosmo First | 771.10 | 768.15 | 776.20 | 792.00 | 761.00 | 119.46 | 1307.20 | 560.80 | - | - |
| CPCL | 1016.60 | 1030.60 | 1023.90 | 1043.40 | 1021.60 | 523.41 | 1159.00 | 603.30 | 5 | 1030.60 |
| Craftsm.Auto | 8702.00 | 8692.50 | 8850.00 | 8919.00 | 8625.50 | 33.66 | 9738.00 | 5100.00 | - | - |
| CREDITACC | 1274.60 | 1303.80 | 1288.00 | 1325.00 | 1284.70 | 298.52 | 1566.00 | 1096.25 | 27 | 1304.90 |
| Credo Brand | 89.26 | 86.48 | 89.87 | 90.79 | 86.00 | 303.17 | 189.00 | 63.06 | - | - |
| CRISIL [1] | 4085.50 | 4026.70 | 4121.00 | 4121.00 | 4001.00 | 39.61 | 6329.95 | 3689.00 | 49 | 4027.00 |
| Crizac Ltd [2] | 203.63 | 223.99 | 206.58 | 223.99 | 205.00 | 786.77 | 387.50 | 174.00 | 24 | 224.15 |
| Crompton [2] | 294.75 | 293.50 | 296.80 | 298.25 | 292.55 | 1618.15 | 364.35 | 217.50 | 54 | 293.35 |
| CSB Bank | 361.25 | 365.50 | 364.00 | 367.95 | 362.80 | 199.53 | 574.70 | 322.10 | 10 | 365.30 |
| Cummins [2] | 5353.00 | 5382.00 | 5419.00 | 5419.50 | 5337.50 | 284.89 | 5472.60 | 2915.90 | 66 | 5378.95 |
| Cupid Ltd [1] | 120.31 | 124.69 | 121.00 | 124.95 | 121.00 | 13549.23 | 133.90 | 17.65 | - | 124.65 |
| Cybertech | 147.71 | 147.83 | 150.00 | 150.00 | 145.87 | 91.89 | 274.80 | 95.30 | 20 | 147.80 |
| CYIENT [5] | 901.70 | 918.05 | 910.00 | 925.00 | 902.65 | 365.57 | 1376.90 | 751.00 | 32 | 917.95 |
| Cyient DLM | 418.30 | 437.85 | 424.00 | 441.85 | 418.00 | 392.83 | 505.50 | 265.20 | - | - |
| **D** | | | | | | | | | | |
| D B CORP | 206.13 | 206.87 | 208.90 | 209.28 | 206.00 | 38.81 | 290.80 | 185.05 | 11 | 207.10 |
| Dabur [1] | 451.05 | 447.20 | 453.40 | 455.75 | 446.25 | 879.39 | 576.80 | 401.05 | 53 | 447.15 |
| Dalmia Sug [2] | 342.05 | 339.65 | 345.00 | 347.40 | 338.10 | 74.22 | 455.50 | 262.75 | 12 | 339.85 |
| DAM Cap Adv | 160.88 | 152.74 | 158.11 | 159.00 | 152.00 | 1286.31 | 303.50 | 119.22 | - | - |
| Data Pattern | 3969.70 | 4096.00 | 4020.00 | 4148.00 | 3970.00 | 1081.06 | 4303.00 | 2131.00 | - | - |
| DATAM GL [5] | 784.85 | 779.35 | 790.10 | 795.95 | 766.80 | 162.25 | 1119.95 | 588.00 | 47 | 771.65 |
| Davang.Sugar | 4.40 | 4.10 | 4.59 | 4.59 | 3.98 | 123494.65 | 5.50 | 3.03 | - | - |
| DBL | 429.90 | 435.55 | 430.00 | 439.70 | 428.50 | 132.61 | 587.90 | 381.75 | 30 | 435.90 |
| DCAL [2] | 195.37 | 199.83 | 199.90 | 205.29 | 195.52 | 735.17 | 321.15 | 129.00 | - | 199.70 |
| DCB Bank | 181.34 | 182.57 | 182.85 | 185.40 | 181.35 | 784.56 | 205.75 | 119.40 | 8 | 182.70 |
| DCM Shriram | 41.41 | 39.69 | 41.13 | 41.98 | 39.10 | 240.84 | 63.10 | 31.90 | - | - |
| DCMSHRIR [2] | 1111.90 | 1090.30 | 1121.90 | 1121.90 | 1085.00 | 60.23 | 1501.70 | 946.15 | 20 | 1090.30 |
| DCW [2] | 47.02 | 47.89 | 47.48 | 48.29 | 47.37 | 557.24 | 87.27 | 37.15 | 29 | 47.89 |
| DCX Systems | 202.04 | 210.92 | 204.09 | 213.76 | 203.00 | 2048.12 | 339.30 | 153.30 | - | - |
| DDev Plastik | 237.70 | 237.10 | 242.25 | 245.75 | 234.00 | 360.91 | 360.00 | 185.15 | - | - |
| Deccan Cem [5] | 595.50 | 607.90 | 605.05 | 609.95 | 588.00 | 23.89 | 1183.95 | 536.05 | 27 | 608.30 |
| DECCAN GOLD M | 142.87 | 148.26 | 144.00 | 150.21 | 142.85 | 1258.02 | 159.00 | 114.80 | - | - |
| Deep Ind | 468.90 | 471.85 | 469.10 | 484.00 | 467.65 | 291.73 | 578.00 | 330.00 | - | - |
| Deepak Fert. | 1473.90 | 1456.50 | 1487.90 | 1503.40 | 1445.40 | 477.38 | 1776.95 | 865.45 | 57 | 1457.15 |
| DEEPAK NI [2] | 1739.80 | 1745.90 | 1746.60 | 1764.20 | 1740.10 | 101.75 | 2128.50 | 1280.40 | 120 | 1747.20 |
| Delhivery | 447.60 | 455.45 | 449.10 | 460.20 | 449.10 | 3126.16 | 490.00 | 342.85 | - | - |
| DELTA CORP [1] | 72.76 | 73.26 | 73.25 | 74.00 | 72.20 | 1469.99 | 98.86 | 48.67 | 16 | 73.25 |
| DEN NETWORK | 26.95 | 27.53 | 27.09 | 27.69 | 27.09 | 367.30 | 42.80 | 22.75 | 11 | 27.54 |
| Denta Water | 280.95 | 285.50 | 284.90 | 291.00 | 279.20 | 294.67 | 479.60 | 222.00 | - | - |
| Devyani.Eng | 114.40 | 116.04 | 114.98 | 117.23 | 114.55 | 643.05 | 191.00 | 91.55 | - | - |
| Dhampur Sug | 145.46 | 145.33 | 146.00 | 146.79 | 144.61 | 128.39 | 167.00 | 110.20 | 14 | 145.20 |
| Dhanalak Bnk | 33.71 | 33.50 | 33.76 | 34.50 | 33.30 | 1561.82 | 34.95 | 19.50 | 13 | 33.54 |
| Dhanuka A [2] | 1172.30 | 1172.40 | 1190.10 | 1194.70 | 1162.00 | 82.86 | 1960.00 | 889.95 | 18 | 1172.90 |
| Diamond Pwr | 193.50 | 196.59 | 196.50 | 199.00 | 193.91 | 3489.34 | 204.80 | 97.70 | - | - |
| Diffusion En | 323.35 | 323.35 | 325.00 | 334.00 | 320.00 | 70.20 | 418.20 | 216.80 | - | - |
| DigitideSol | 84.94 | 86.01 | 85.19 | 87.67 | 85.19 | 138.09 | 279.69 | 69.90 | - | - |
| Divgi Torq. | 710.50 | 743.20 | 718.00 | 748.00 | 701.95 | 48.12 | 807.40 | 519.00 | - | - |
| Divi's Lab [2] | 6887.00 | 6756.50 | 6750.00 | 6945.00 | 6690.00 | 874.05 | 7077.70 | 5637.50 | 67 | 6759.75 |
| DIXON [2] | 11722.00 | 11824.00 | 11850.00 | 11888.00 | 11602.00 | 578.59 | 18471.50 | 9605.05 | 95 | 11826.40 |
| DK Enterpri | 277.15 | 278.85 | 278.50 | 286.70 | 277.15 | 54.28 | 350.00 | 191.35 | - | - |
| DLF [2] | 586.70 | 592.30 | 592.00 | 596.40 | 589.15 | 2007.54 | 887.50 | 489.30 | 41 | 592.35 |
| DLINK IND [2] | 461.20 | 462.20 | 462.00 | 468.75 | 454.35 | 147.32 | 588.90 | 365.70 | 16 | 462.65 |
| DMART | 4117.00 | 4097.20 | 4150.00 | 4154.90 | 4077.60 | 284.29 | 4916.30 | 3528.65 | 83 | 4094.75 |
| Dodla Dairy | 1062.80 | 1091.60 | 1078.70 | 1097.90 | 1061.90 | 25.48 | 1525.00 | 964.10 | - | - |
| Dolat Algo | 75.12 | 75.72 | 75.13 | 76.58 | 74.40 | 419.12 | 111.05 | 65.00 | - | - |
| DOLLAR [2] | 277.05 | 272.30 | 285.00 | 285.00 | 268.50 | 339.04 | 430.00 | 220.60 | 15 | 272.80 |
| DOMS Ind | 2203.90 | 2205.00 | 2225.00 | 2231.00 | 2194.00 | 31.37 | 2770.00 | 2023.90 | - | - |
| Dr AgarwalHe | 479.35 | 479.70 | 483.90 | 484.40 | 474.65 | 54.57 | 568.00 | 327.00 | - | - |
| Dreamfolks | 76.27 | 77.00 | 76.27 | 78.45 | 76.00 | 38.16 | 291.50 | 56.00 | - | - |
| Dredging Cor | 1064.75 | 1072.95 | 1066.90 | 1102.45 | 1019.00 | 589.93 | 1245.90 | 561.70 | 631 | 1073.45 |
| DrReddy'sLa [1] | 1307.20 | 1331.40 | 1320.00 | 1340.50 | 1298.70 | 4659.78 | 1377.95 | 1149.00 | 34 | 1332.10 |
| Dwar Sugar [1] | 44.50 | 43.37 | 44.50 | 44.54 | 43.20 | 830.84 | 53.10 | 32.14 | 26 | 43.54 |
| DYNACONS SYS | 1734.40 | 1895.10 | 1792.80 | 1924.80 | 1766.00 | 533.09 | 1925.65 | 781.50 | 29 | 1892.65 |
| DYNAMAT.TECH | 11170.00 | 11306.00 | 11301.00 | 11630.00 | 11165.00 | 30.51 | 12870.00 | 6335.00 | 147 | 11313.50 |
| Dynamic Cab. | 300.05 | 323.00 | 305.90 | 325.40 | 300.05 | 473.66 | 1036.00 | 236.80 | - | - |
| **E** | | | | | | | | | | |
| E2E Netwrk | 3578.40 | 3701.80 | 3699.00 | 3757.30 | 3551.10 | 257.64 | 3894.70 | 1833.60 | - | - |
| Easy Trip Pl | 8.03 | 8.00 | 8.06 | 8.10 | 7.97 | 9119.64 | 11.44 | 5.77 | - | - |
| Eclerx Ser | 1577.70 | 1588.10 | 1580.50 | 1621.00 | 1570.60 | 242.12 | 2492.98 | 1376.00 | 33 | 1586.80 |
| Ecos (I) Mob | 131.88 | 137.03 | 133.00 | 138.00 | 133.00 | 214.28 | 358.40 | 103.94 | - | - |
| EDELWEISS [1] | 110.11 | 111.96 | 111.25 | 112.89 | 110.49 | 3073.52 | 130.65 | 91.85 | 24 | 111.95 |
| EFC (I) Ltd | 190.93 | 184.08 | 191.50 | 191.50 | 182.50 | 364.20 | 357.00 | 171.55 | - | - |
| Eicher Motor [1] | 6981.50 | 7414.00 | 7237.00 | 7432.00 | 7215.00 | 1354.54 | 8232.80 | 5224.85 | 40 | 7413.40 |
| EID Parry [1] | 778.95 | 789.85 | 785.90 | 794.00 | 781.40 | 112.67 | 1246.45 | 751.75 | 401 | 790.30 |
| EIH [2] | 318.80 | 321.05 | 320.00 | 324.45 | 317.80 | 155.81 | 434.35 | 271.35 | 29 | 321.05 |
| Eimco Elecon | 1605.60 | 1601.00 | 1615.00 | 1634.00 | 1585.00 | 12.11 | 3001.10 | 1413.70 | 24 | 1601.50 |
| Elec.Mart In | 120.65 | 116.77 | 119.66 | 119.80 | 113.44 | 2311.80 | 168.50 | 84.90 | - | - |
| Elecon Eng [1] | 533.25 | 547.45 | 538.00 | 550.00 | 527.85 | 876.35 | 716.55 | 352.00 | 35 | 547.15 |
| Electro Cast [1] | 78.13 | 82.37 | 79.00 | 83.20 | 78.65 | 3558.64 | 138.70 | 60.13 | 32 | 82.39 |
| ELECTROTHERM | 773.85 | 771.00 | 773.85 | 791.90 | 750.00 | 58.89 | 1280.00 | 550.45 | - | 767.85 |
| Elgi Equipm [1] | 560.15 | 567.90 | 562.35 | 573.00 | 561.00 | 289.33 | 608.25 | 408.95 | 49 | 567.95 |
| Elin Elec. | 118.30 | 120.78 | 118.50 | 125.50 | 118.30 | 270.58 | 234.00 | 93.65 | - | - |
| ELITECON INTE | 31.40 | 31.60 | 31.42 | 32.23 | 31.24 | 1686.70 | 46.40 | 28.58 | - | - |
| EllenBarrind | 282.55 | 265.35 | 282.50 | 282.50 | 257.50 | 981.73 | 637.70 | 175.00 | - | - |
| Elpro Intl | 172.30 | 166.65 | 176.99 | 177.50 | 162.50 | 138.01 | 177.50 | 86.00 | - | - |
| Emami Ltd [1] | 402.90 | 404.05 | 404.00 | 409.00 | 402.10 | 265.34 | 634.65 | 385.35 | 21 | 404.45 |
| Emcure Phr | 1713.60 | 1738.30 | 1713.60 | 1740.90 | 1705.00 | 75.78 | 1830.00 | 1228.90 | - | - |
| Emmvee Photo | 264.30 | 290.25 | 268.50 | 290.70 | 265.25 | 11654.37 | 299.50 | 171.51 | - | - |

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CHENNAI
businessline.
TUESDAY - MAY 26 - 2026

| Company | Prev | Close | Open | High | Low | Qty | 52 WH | 52 WL | PE | BSE Cl |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Phoenix Mill [2] | 1790.30 | 1809.60 | 1798.00 | 1816.30 | 1782.90 | 262.43 | 1965.00 | 1403.00 | 219 | 1808.20 |
| PhysicsWall | 109.62 | 110.99 | 110.38 | 112.50 | 109.75 | 1789.74 | 161.99 | 77.72 | - | - |
| PI INDUS.LTD [1] | 2781.00 | 2849.00 | 2794.90 | 2858.00 | 2786.80 | 297.40 | 4329.00 | 2700.00 | 28 | 2848.10 |
| PiccadilyAgr | 568.30 | 598.35 | 570.15 | 609.75 | 570.15 | 241.33 | 805.50 | 515.00 | - | - |
| Pidilite [1] | 1478.40 | 1477.20 | 1500.00 | 1508.40 | 1473.10 | 593.43 | 1575.00 | 1259.45 | 63 | 1476.85 |
| Pine Labs | 142.84 | 146.20 | 145.50 | 147.60 | 137.51 | 24633.39 | 284.00 | 137.51 | - | - |
| Piramal Fin | 1959.50 | 1942.90 | 1969.00 | 1976.00 | 1925.00 | 334.12 | 2073.20 | 1260.00 | - | - |
| Piramal Phr | 175.63 | 179.46 | 176.10 | 180.70 | 175.25 | 2936.24 | 220.85 | 132.30 | - | - |
| Pitti Engg [5] | 942.10 | 934.65 | 950.00 | 950.00 | 928.70 | 25.58 | 1069.85 | 677.20 | 36 | 934.90 |
| Pix Transm | 1623.40 | 1520.30 | 1550.00 | 1550.00 | 1464.00 | 78.26 | 1706.00 | 1220.10 | - | - |
| PLASTIBLEND [5] | 169.81 | 176.83 | 174.11 | 177.41 | 174.00 | 78.67 | 232.00 | 121.00 | 12 | 176.70 |
| PlatinumInd | 221.78 | 227.59 | 223.50 | 232.00 | 223.50 | 69.79 | 342.40 | 183.50 | - | - |
| PN Gadgil Jw | 525.70 | 528.05 | 537.50 | 537.50 | 520.00 | 301.04 | 736.40 | 503.00 | - | - |
| Pnb Gilts | 79.35 | 79.28 | 79.40 | 82.23 | 78.24 | 1210.55 | 119.84 | 58.75 | 8 | 79.36 |
| PNB Housng | 1059.60 | 1085.60 | 1064.80 | 1098.80 | 1063.10 | 1182.45 | 1141.85 | 730.00 | 12 | 1085.40 |
| PNC Infra [2] | 215.32 | 212.86 | 214.51 | 217.04 | 210.99 | 447.40 | 331.80 | 157.95 | 16 | 212.75 |
| PNGS Reva Di | 407.65 | 403.95 | 400.00 | 417.60 | 397.85 | 198.90 | 476.75 | 324.25 | - | - |
| Pokarna Ltd [2] | 834.10 | 854.60 | 845.90 | 888.00 | 840.00 | 91.80 | 1147.35 | 692.55 | - | 856.80 |
| Poly Medicu [5] | 1598.20 | 1547.20 | 1600.00 | 1634.20 | 1515.00 | 167.45 | 2447.50 | 1184.00 | 45 | 1538.35 |
| Polycab Ind. | 9263.50 | 9398.50 | 9320.00 | 9424.00 | 9296.00 | 252.13 | 9424.00 | 5760.00 | - | - |
| Polyplex | 961.45 | 913.55 | 980.00 | 993.00 | 908.05 | 257.63 | 1396.80 | 743.00 | 48 | 913.10 |
| PonawallaFin | 399.75 | 398.90 | 405.00 | 407.00 | 397.15 | 1386.50 | 570.40 | 361.20 | - | - |
| Pondy Oxides | 1482.20 | 1507.50 | 1502.00 | 1556.00 | 1476.10 | 360.07 | 1619.00 | 689.00 | - | - |
| Power Finan | 430.55 | 438.90 | 438.00 | 443.65 | 435.20 | 4616.15 | 486.45 | 330.05 | 7 | 439.15 |
| Power grid | 294.30 | 295.35 | 298.50 | 298.50 | 294.15 | 5896.82 | 324.80 | 250.05 | 17 | 295.25 |
| Power Trad | 193.77 | 191.93 | 195.00 | 197.95 | 189.93 | 1201.07 | 229.40 | 149.90 | 14 | 192.00 |
| POWERICA | 551.70 | 555.20 | 558.40 | 570.00 | 547.70 | 465.99 | 581.90 | 365.10 | - | - |
| POWERMECH | 2544.70 | 2547.10 | 2594.90 | 2599.00 | 2531.50 | 81.26 | 3415.45 | 1718.00 | 27 | 2546.50 |
| PRADEEP M | 393.65 | 421.70 | 398.80 | 432.50 | 391.25 | 87.14 | 432.50 | 357.05 | - | - |
| Praj Ind.ltd [2] | 390.25 | 393.65 | 392.40 | 395.55 | 384.05 | 1085.52 | 538.40 | 273.05 | 46 | 393.55 |
| Prakash Ind. | 143.59 | 141.29 | 142.70 | 144.50 | 140.61 | 528.29 | 191.00 | 110.00 | 8 | 141.30 |
| Prakash Pipe | 194.43 | 201.21 | 198.90 | 202.43 | 195.92 | 88.43 | 473.90 | 163.21 | - | - |
| Precam | 165.20 | 154.24 | 157.50 | 162.02 | 153.15 | 787.60 | 263.30 | 104.05 | 43 | 154.40 |
| Precision Wr [1] | 415.15 | 442.60 | 448.00 | 467.50 | 435.00 | 5306.26 | 467.10 | 166.90 | 52 | 442.00 |
| Precot Mer. | 732.60 | 762.55 | 770.00 | 805.85 | 741.50 | 42.61 | 805.85 | 300.05 | - | - |
| Premier Enr | 983.40 | 985.00 | 996.00 | 1005.00 | 977.00 | 3295.13 | 1136.40 | 660.00 | - | - |
| Premier Expl [2] | 595.50 | 714.60 | 600.55 | 714.60 | 596.80 | 6076.63 | 714.70 | 378.80 | 82 | 714.70 |
| prestige Est | 1388.50 | 1401.40 | 1413.70 | 1421.20 | 1392.20 | 1227.15 | 1812.40 | 1090.45 | 330 | 1400.70 |
| Pricol Ltd [1] | 556.65 | 567.20 | 566.75 | 573.45 | 561.15 | 329.84 | 694.95 | 415.25 | 33 | 567.10 |
| Prince Pipe | 273.45 | 271.45 | 279.15 | 282.25 | 270.30 | 1023.01 | 387.70 | 205.00 | - | - |
| Prism Cement | 118.80 | 117.52 | 119.50 | 119.91 | 117.45 | 521.31 | 172.15 | 115.70 | - | 117.60 |
| [illegible] | | | | | | | | | | |
| Reliance | 1354.50 | 1367.00 | 1366.80 | 1371.10 | 1357.00 | 6750.07 | 1611.20 | 1290.00 | 42 | 1366.85 |
| Religare ent | 240.32 | 236.60 | 243.00 | 246.30 | 235.54 | 951.15 | 314.15 | 197.00 | - | 236.70 |
| Remsons Ind [2] | 92.48 | 93.48 | 92.20 | 95.00 | 90.41 | 242.50 | 157.00 | 77.70 | 26 | 93.60 |
| Renaiss.Glo | 101.36 | 103.87 | 101.85 | 107.00 | 101.33 | 291.06 | 147.90 | 85.00 | - | - |
| REPCO HOME | 388.55 | 396.20 | 389.05 | 397.00 | 386.65 | 140.05 | 463.60 | 333.90 | 6 | 396.20 |
| Respon Ind [1] | 165.85 | 174.50 | 168.45 | 175.93 | 167.20 | 176.83 | 251.00 | 117.80 | - | 175.50 |
| RestaurBrand | 67.70 | 68.06 | 68.20 | 68.46 | 67.70 | 1004.38 | 87.65 | 57.15 | - | - |
| Revathi Equi | 669.30 | 799.45 | 677.00 | 803.15 | 677.00 | 18.87 | 1300.00 | 491.10 | - | - |
| Rhetan TMT L | 29.08 | 29.54 | 29.20 | 29.60 | 29.08 | 4657.19 | 31.46 | 20.32 | - | - |
| RHI Magnesit | 394.25 | 403.15 | 395.05 | 409.20 | 394.55 | 182.91 | 537.70 | 323.05 | - | - |
| Rico Auto [1] | 119.96 | 119.76 | 121.90 | 123.00 | 119.10 | 1077.79 | 142.30 | 65.93 | 47 | 119.75 |
| Rishabh Ins | 517.40 | 549.90 | 524.00 | 563.40 | 517.60 | 765.86 | 563.40 | 272.30 | - | - |
| Ritco Logi. | 262.17 | 263.88 | 264.75 | 274.80 | 262.92 | 86.09 | 317.10 | 167.10 | - | - |
| RITES | 203.95 | 207.30 | 204.88 | 208.90 | 204.80 | 528.10 | 316.15 | 175.10 | 25 | 207.25 |
| RK Forgings [2] | 555.05 | 571.95 | 556.80 | 575.80 | 556.80 | 216.92 | 691.90 | 460.15 | 111 | 571.40 |
| RMDrip&Spr | 18.83 | 18.96 | 19.38 | 19.38 | 18.60 | 610.50 | 807.45 | 17.11 | - | - |
| Rolex Rings | 143.44 | 143.67 | 145.00 | 147.47 | 143.27 | 1129.06 | 1660.00 | 99.79 | - | - |
| Rossari Bio | 524.00 | 538.45 | 525.10 | 547.00 | 520.60 | 226.15 | 766.00 | 375.00 | - | - |
| Rossell Tech | 923.65 | 1018.85 | 924.60 | 1080.00 | 924.60 | 922.94 | 1080.00 | 354.00 | - | - |
| Roto Pumps | 58.17 | 57.66 | 59.29 | 59.37 | 57.15 | 229.45 | 310.25 | 47.50 | - | - |
| Route Mobile | 511.35 | 516.55 | 515.05 | 524.05 | 511.45 | 170.23 | 1158.00 | 410.70 | - | - |
| RPG lifesc [8] | 2293.90 | 2253.70 | 2308.00 | 2327.90 | 2243.00 | 10.26 | 2715.90 | 1731.25 | 33 | 2257.20 |
| RPOWER | 27.08 | 26.73 | 27.39 | 27.58 | 26.60 | 33773.65 | 76.49 | 20.23 | - | 26.72 |
| RPSG Vent. | 907.90 | 932.00 | 907.00 | 941.95 | 905.00 | 42.81 | 1179.00 | 551.90 | - | - |
| RR Kabel | 1947.60 | 1989.10 | 1979.00 | 2007.90 | 1955.10 | 730.19 | 2049.00 | 1165.00 | - | - |
| RSystems Int [1] | 268.90 | 267.40 | 270.00 | 273.60 | 266.40 | 175.59 | 496.95 | 230.15 | 12 | 266.95 |
| RTNPOWER | 9.12 | 9.19 | 9.22 | 9.30 | 9.18 | 7820.30 | 16.94 | 7.50 | - | 9.20 |
| Rubicon Rese | 949.75 | 944.55 | 959.00 | 963.15 | 940.15 | 89.95 | 1015.70 | 570.75 | - | - |
| RUBY MILLS [5] | 227.59 | 273.10 | 233.20 | 273.10 | 230.00 | 545.40 | 271.60 | 169.65 | 19 | 271.60 |
| RUPA & CO [1] | 146.27 | 148.86 | 148.00 | 149.68 | 147.04 | 85.46 | 233.45 | 109.50 | 17 | 148.85 |
| RVNL | 271.10 | 272.45 | 274.15 | 275.85 | 272.00 | 7242.97 | 442.80 | 248.00 | - | - |
| **S** | | | | | | | | | | |
| S&W Solar | 198.04 | 197.05 | 199.68 | 201.76 | 196.35 | 1363.43 | 348.90 | 148.00 | - | - |
| SaatvikGreen | 432.30 | 444.50 | 434.95 | 447.80 | 433.00 | 130.07 | 567.00 | 328.00 | - | - |
| Safari Ind | 1527.00 | 1515.30 | 1539.00 | 1543.40 | 1499.30 | 63.21 | 2507.10 | 1363.10 | - | - |
| Sagar Cemnt [2] | 181.26 | 182.48 | 184.46 | 184.46 | 181.35 | 41.55 | 300.00 | 149.00 | 71 | 182.95 |
| SagardeepAl | 23.67 | 26.93 | 25.50 | 28.40 | 25.50 | 671.53 | 36.00 | 20.81 | - | - |
| Sagility Ind | 41.24 | 41.80 | 41.69 | 41.99 | 41.33 | 8218.37 | 57.89 | 35.83 | - | - |
| Sai Life Sci | 1113.80 | 1175.90 | 1116.90 | 1184.80 | 1108.50 | 851.64 | 1184.80 | 707.00 | - | - |
| SAI PARENTE | 486.70 | 489.80 | 508.00 | 508.00 | 486.00 | 299.43 | 526.30 | 400.00 | - | - |
| Sai Silks | 103.19 | 102.66 | 104.00 | 104.93 | 102.00 | 682.99 | 223.03 | 89.76 | - | - |
| Sakar Health | 761.60 | 801.00 | 766.85 | 837.75 | 740.00 | 244.15 | 837.75 | 306.10 | - | - |
| SAKSOFT [1] | 139.02 | 144.01 | 140.50 | 153.00 | 139.99 | 2186.40 | 254.15 | 108.00 | 25 | 143.85 |
| SALASAR [1] | 6.96 | 7.16 | 7.00 | 7.26 | 7.00 | 3863.64 | 11.53 | 5.60 | - | 7.16 |
| Salzer Elec | 704.50 | 650.45 | 660.00 | 675.00 | 637.00 | 391.14 | 1016.00 | 488.65 | 22 | 649.30 |
| SambhvStee | 106.51 | 107.42 | 108.44 | 110.38 | 107.05 | 1059.59 | 149.40 | 81.42 | - | - |
| Samhi Hotels | 150.08 | 162.51 | 152.77 | 164.40 | 152.61 | 3373.52 | 254.50 | 127.00 | - | - |
| Samman Cap. | 161.46 | 168.56 | 163.60 | 169.18 | 161.75 | 41737.35 | 192.95 | 114.10 | - | - |
| Samvard.Moth | 136.18 | 135.91 | 137.50 | 138.75 | 135.11 | 15957.40 | 162.25 | 89.70 | - | - |
| Sanathan Tex | 406.40 | 403.15 | 408.40 | 413.10 | 400.00 | 16.44 | 560.20 | 352.60 | - | - |
| Sandhar | 622.50 | 705.60 | 638.00 | 733.90 | 626.45 | 6509.64 | 735.00 | 386.25 | 24 | 705.85 |
| Sandur Mang. | 225.66 | 232.42 | 228.00 | 238.80 | 227.43 | 1868.95 | 557.75 | 156.30 | - | - |
| Sangam India | 495.75 | 513.85 | 495.70 | 518.80 | 495.70 | 57.29 | 575.50 | 340.90 | 28 | 512.00 |
| Sanghvi M [1] | 354.85 | 378.60 | 357.80 | 380.00 | 356.10 | 915.21 | 412.90 | 221.00 | 20 | 379.20 |
| Sanofi Cons. | 4735.10 | 4609.60 | 4726.50 | 4740.50 | 4580.00 | 7.01 | 5894.50 | 3975.00 | - | - |
| Sanofi ind | 3163.20 | 3181.90 | 3180.00 | 3199.50 | 3151.60 | 51.53 | 6399.95 | 3151.05 | 22 | 3186.45 |
| Sansera Engg | 2853.80 | 2905.20 | 2870.00 | 2943.90 | 2859.30 | 332.41 | 2950.00 | 1216.30 | - | - |
| Sanstar | 116.79 | 103.97 | 117.30 | 118.48 | 102.60 | 2783.80 | 120.71 | 74.30 | - | - |
| Sapphire Fd | 180.52 | 184.92 | 182.09 | 186.35 | 180.50 | 279.75 | 368.00 | 139.91 | - | - |
| Sarda EnMin [1] | 568.35 | 543.90 | 572.00 | 578.80 | 539.00 | 1460.03 | 639.95 | 420.05 | 20 | 544.50 |
| Saregama (I) [1] | 402.30 | 397.60 | 407.50 | 407.50 | 395.10 | 899.27 | 603.00 | 305.65 | 35 | 398.95 |
| SARLA PER F [1] | 95.07 | 97.83 | 96.40 | 99.48 | 95.00 | 239.14 | 127.90 | 65.01 | 10 | 97.80 |
| SASKEN COMM | 1813.80 | 1924.40 | 1862.00 | 1940.00 | 1792.10 | 286.80 | 1955.30 | 993.05 | 43 | 1929.40 |
| Satia Ind. | 64.54 | 58.88 | 62.20 | 63.00 | 55.00 | 1009.73 | 97.50 | 50.80 | - | - |
| SATIN | 210.08 | 216.25 | 212.00 | 218.93 | 211.77 | 283.59 | 246.00 | 133.50 | 8 | 216.10 |
| SBC Exports | 38.56 | 38.83 | 38.69 | 39.59 | 38.40 | 15171.77 | 39.59 | 14.21 | - | - |
| SBFC Fin. | 91.17 | 93.21 | 92.90 | 94.50 | 91.62 | 780.97 | 123.00 | 79.60 | - | - |
| SBI Cards | 620.20 | 630.30 | 624.40 | 631.80 | 623.20 | 517.16 | 1027.25 | 612.10 | - | - |
| SBILIFE | 1870.70 | 1901.90 | 1881.50 | 1905.00 | 1879.80 | 445.14 | 2132.90 | 1724.00 | 77 | 1901.45 |
| SChand Co [5] | 170.97 | 172.19 | 184.20 | 184.50 | 170.97 | 160.73 | 257.50 | 130.50 | 36 | 172.60 |
| SchlossBanga | 415.75 | 414.35 | 418.00 | 424.95 | 411.50 | 312.47 | 474.40 | 382.50 | - | - |
| SCHNEIDER [2] | 1307.60 | 1364.70 | 1328.00 | 1372.90 | 1317.70 | 339.19 | 1395.00 | 572.60 | 125 | 1365.70 |
| ScodaTubes | 136.50 | 138.50 | 136.80 | 140.00 | 136.80 | 240.48 | 230.85 | 110.00 | - | - |
| SE INVESTM [1] | 50.32 | 49.87 | 50.80 | 50.90 | 49.61 | 4286.15 | 51.50 | 29.40 | 19 | 49.96 |
| SEDEMAC MECH | 1983.30 | 2064.40 | 2011.00 | 2075.00 | 1972.30 | 123.86 | 2175.00 | 1413.10 | - | - |
| Senco Gold | 347.95 | 353.80 | 352.40 | 361.60 | 350.05 | 1069.89 | 404.85 | 276.00 | - | - |
| Senores Phar | 1110.95 | 1153.65 | 1116.45 | 1160.00 | 1115.35 | 269.07 | 1194.40 | 500.00 | - | - |
| SEPC | 7.81 | 7.86 | 7.99 | 8.19 | 7.68 | 29511.37 | 15.80 | 4.65 | - | - |
| Servote.Pwr | 92.80 | 95.33 | 94.12 | 98.50 | 93.95 | 1842.03 | 168.50 | 57.51 | - | - |
| Seshaasai Te | 265.90 | 268.49 | 267.35 | 273.00 | 264.61 | 114.83 | 437.45 | 209.11 | - | - |
| SFL [5] | 638.50 | 635.05 | 645.00 | 655.00 | 630.90 | 382.35 | 768.90 | 460.75 | 56 | 634.00 |
| SG Mart L | 616.40 | 612.55 | 622.00 | 625.10 | 610.10 | 81.21 | 638.10 | 313.10 | - | - |
| SGFinserveLt | 584.80 | 579.20 | 594.45 | 595.00 | 576.65 | 115.28 | 650.00 | 323.00 | - | - |
| Sh Renu Sug [1] | 23.85 | 23.66 | 24.00 | 24.14 | 23.55 | 4483.78 | 35.84 | 22.86 | - | 23.65 |
| Shadowfax Te | 201.28 | 199.86 | 202.40 | 209.43 | 195.22 | 6432.85 | 211.77 | 98.55 | - | - |
| Shaily Eng | 2695.20 | 2751.00 | 2737.10 | 2771.00 | 2662.60 | 202.82 | 2836.90 | 1535.90 | - | - |
| SHAKTI PUMPS | 505.00 | 511.15 | 508.25 | 515.45 | 508.25 | 454.76 | 1047.00 | 457.00 | 26 | 511.30 |
| Shal MetaCo | 5.06 | 5.25 | 5.19 | 5.33 | 5.10 | 3784.41 | 5.88 | 3.01 | - | - |
| SHALBY | 170.93 | 172.78 | 169.10 | 179.80 | 169.10 | 148.67 | 274.50 | 125.70 | 25 | 173.55 |
| Shankara Bui | 1057.90 | 1057.40 | 1077.90 | 1080.00 | 1040.00 | 39.98 | 1244.00 | 636.00 | - | - |
| SHANTI EDU INI | 198.06 | 195.99 | 200.00 | 200.99 | 195.00 | 356.21 | 218.78 | 172.90 | - | - |
| ShantiGolInt | 229.16 | 224.55 | 230.00 | 233.09 | 220.50 | 1374.64 | 274.10 | 155.00 | - | - |
| Sharda Crop | 893.10 | 947.90 | 900.40 | 959.70 | 900.40 | 507.56 | 1297.80 | 648.80 | 13 | 949.60 |
| SHARDA MO [2] | 853.10 | 844.80 | 854.95 | 874.50 | 831.80 | 191.50 | 1258.00 | 701.85 | 15 | 841.55 |
| ShareInd Sec | 141.57 | 139.98 | 144.12 | 144.12 | 139.41 | 473.64 | 211.00 | 115.36 | - | - |
| [illegible] | | | | | | | | | | |

## Exchange Traded Funds

[illegible]

## BSE Stocks

| Company | Pr Cl | Cl | Company | Pr Cl | Cl | Company | Pr Cl | Cl |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 360 One WA [1] | 1112.40 | 1141.85 | ASM Tech | 3281.95 | 3276.00 | Carysil [2] | 1083.30 | 1116.25 |
| A-1 Ltd [1] | 10.16 | 9.66 | Asso.Alcohol | 802.80 | 888.55 | Ceigall Ind [5] | 343.80 | 341.25 |
| Aadhar HFL | 475.35 | 473.85 | Ather Ener [1] | 884.70 | 920.90 | Ceinsys Tech | 905.35 | 903.00 |
| Aarti PhrLab [5] | 714.50 | 733.55 | Atlanta Ele [2] | 1667.35 | 1701.45 | Cello World [5] | 382.35 | 381.15 |
| Aayush Well [1] | 31.92 | 31.87 | Authum Inv. [1] | 510.60 | 500.40 | Central Mine P | 234.15 | 244.70 |
| AB.Sunlife A [5] | 1010.80 | 1015.60 | Avalon Tech [2] | 1473.55 | 1511.90 | Chamanlal [2] | 266.75 | 298.40 |
| Acmesolar [2] | 289.60 | 301.00 | Avantel Ltd [2] | 162.25 | 171.70 | Chemcon Spl | 183.95 | 193.05 |
| Active Clo | 130.25 | 141.05 | Avi Polymer | 16.89 | 16.05 | Chempl.Sanma [5] | 237.60 | 244.90 |
| Adani Wilm. [1] | 195.05 | 193.10 | Avro India [1] | 10.40 | 11.35 | Choice Intl | 677.00 | 689.00 |
| Aditya Birla L | 102.05 | 102.50 | Awfis Space | 344.20 | 359.80 | Clean Max Envi | 1120.60 | 1095.70 |
| Aditya Info [1] | 2415.15 | 2557.80 | Azad Engg [2] | 2039.40 | 2042.35 | Clean Sci& [1] | 758.10 | 746.35 |
| Aditya Vison [1] | 536.30 | 535.75 | Bajaj Health [5] | 305.25 | 304.30 | CMS Info Sys | 306.55 | 310.45 |
| Advait Infr | 2006.80 | 2099.65 | Bajaj HsgFin | 83.08 | 83.31 | Comfort Inte [1] | 6.69 | 6.50 |
| Advent Hot | 144.60 | 152.80 | Bajaj Steel [5] | 408.85 | 410.00 | Concord Bio [1] | 1153.80 | 1133.35 |
| [illegible] | | | | | | | | |

## NSE Trade for Trade

[illegible]

*: Closing price is the average of trade price(s) for the last half an hour;52-Week High/Low figures pertain to BSE.

Shares of face value other than ₹10 is indicated in brackets immediately following the name of the company.

Qty (No of shares traded) is denoted in thousands.

The PE(price-earnings multiple) of each stock is based on the latest declared earnings.

The PE computation takes into account the per share earnings of each company for the latest 12 months.